

THE ECONOMIC TIMES

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VOL. 66 NO. 245 | MUMBAI | 12 PAGES | ₹6.00 ONLY

SATURDAY, 17 OCTOBER 2026

Yes Bank is set to file a review plea in the SC against the court's judgment upholding the Bombay HC order that set aside the write-down of AT1 bonds ▶ P 1

▶ Apple to Cut Production of iPhone 17 for Indian Market as Higher Prices Hit Demand ▶ On D St, IT's Time to Celebrate When Chips are Down: P 1

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Sports World Play

VITALS

FIFA Fines Spain $20,000 for Anti-Muslim Chants At Egypt Friendly

World Cup winner Spain has been fined $20,000 by FIFA after fans chanted an anti-Muslim slogan at a warmup friendly against Egypt in Barcelona. FIFA said Friday the verdict was confirmed in recent days by its appeals body after an initial ruling by three disciplinary judges. The chant came at a game on March 31 and was later condemned by Spain star Lamine Yamal, who is Muslim, as "disrespectful and intolerable." World football's ruling body ordered the federation to pay $20,000 and imposed crowd measures on the team's next home friendly. That is likely to be in June 2027 or March 2028. A section of 15% of the seats in the Spain home stadium must be closed or filled with special interest groups "such as families, students, and anti-discrimination organizations." **AP**

1ST T20I: INDIA VS ZIMBABWE

Deepti and Niki Seal Nervy Win for India



Raipur: India survived a major scare before debutant Niki Prasad and veteran Deepti Sharma combined to guide the hosts to a four-wicket win over Zimbabwe in the first women's T20 international on Friday. Opener Kelis Ndhlovu struck a fluent 42 off 44 balls and Sharne Mayers scored an unbeaten 43 off 33 deliveries as Zimbabwe posted 114-5. India slumped to 19 for 4 in reply before Niki, who remained unbeaten on 39 off 35 balls, and Deepti (49 off 37) rescued the hosts with an 82-run partnership.India eventually reached the target in 15.4 overs to take the lead in the series. **PTI**

BRIEF SCORES **Zimbabwe** 114/5 (Mayers 43* off 33, Ndhlovu 42 off 44; Nandani 2/11) lost to **India** 116/6 (Deepti 49 off 37, Prasad 39* off 35, Gwanzura 3/18) by 4 wickets

Carrick Cools Martinez Storm

United boss says team has moved on after defender apologised for outburst over club's summer transfer business

Michael Carrick said Friday that Manchester United had "moved on" from Lisandro Martinez's outburst aimed at the club's hierarchy, stressing it was "really not a drama for us as a group".

Argentina defender Martinez took aim at the United hierarchy following their 2-0 Champions League loss to Atletico Madrid on Tuesday, saying Carrick had been left with an under-strength squad.

The centre-back criticised technical director Jason Wilcox, saying he had "100 percent" expected more investment during the summer transfer window after United finished third in the Premier League last season.

It is understood Martinez, who issued an apology on Thursday, has been fined for his outburst.

United manager Carrick confirmed during a pre-match press conference on Friday that Martinez would be in his squad for their Premier League match at bitter rivals Leeds on Sunday.

Carrick, under intense pressure after a terrible start to the season, was asked by reporters about Martinez's comments and subsequent developments. "We've moved on from that, it was one of those things," he said. "I think Licha (Martinez) has come out and acknowledged the situation and as a group we've moved on.

"It's really not a drama for us as a group, I think the boys have trained really well. This morning there was a really good feeling around the squad."

Martinez, 28, said in a statement he had held positive talks with the club's leadership and Carrick.

"Everyone knows that I am a passionate person and that I live football with great intensity," he said in a post on Instagram.

"The frustration of the defeat led me to express how I felt at a time and place that perhaps were not the right ones, and for that I want to apologise."



Lisandro Martinez

'EMOTION'

Former United captain Roy Keane has branded the situation at his former club "a bit of a circus".

Carrick was pressed by reporters on the nature of the apology from Martinez, which did not mention Wilcox by name.

"I think he (Martinez) has released his statement and he's realised he's made a mistake," said the United boss. "I think that's enough for all of us to move on with."

He added: "I understand the emotion at times. We ask for passion, we ask for emotion, we ask for fire and we ask for players to care.

"There's a way of doing that and that's already been acknowledged. We need to carry that. We need to carry that intensity and that willingness and that togetherness and that spirit and everything."

United have made their worst start to a league season in 40 years.

They are 13th in the Premier League, with just one win from six matches, but Carrick, a former United and England midfielder, deflected a question about the pressure on him personally.

"I don't need results, we all need results," he said. "It's not about me. Manchester United is a lot bigger than any individual, bigger than me.

"Bigger than any player, anyone else who works at this football club. It always has been, and it's not about me." **AFP**



I understand the emotion at times. We ask for passion, we ask for emotion, we ask for fire and we ask for players to care

MICHAEL CARRICK
Man United manager

WATCHOUT! Tonight

PREMIER LEAGUE **Everton v Chelsea** 5pm; **Brentford** v **Liverpool** 7:30pm; **Man City** v **Ipswich Town** 7:30pm (Star Sports) **LALIGA** **Espanyol** v **Atlético Madrid** 5:30pm; **Real Betis** v **Barcelona** 9:30pm (Fancode) **BUNDESLIGA** **Union Berlin** v **Dortmund** 7pm; **Bayern Munich v Leipzig** 10pm (Sony Ten)

INDIA TOUR OF NEW ZEALAND

Pant, Bumrah in Test Squad; Suthar Dropped



Rishabh Pant **(in pic)** was named in India's squad for next month's two-Test series in New Zealand on Friday, subject to fitness clearance, while pace spearhead Jasprit Bumrah returned to the side.

The Shubman Gill-led Test squad featured few surprises, with selectors retaining the core of the team.

Pant was recently ruled out of the first two India A Test matches against New Zealand with a left side strain but was included in the senior squad pending medical clearance.

There was no place for Manav Suthar, who topped the charts with 16 wickets in Sri Lanka. India opted for spin-bowling allrounders Ravindra Jadeja and Washington Sundar alongside specialist spinner Kuldeep Yadav.

India also named squads for the accompanying five-match ODI series, with Gill set to captain the side in the opening three matches before Shreyas Iyer takes charge for the final two.

Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma retained their places in the ODI squad, while Bumrah was selected only for the Test leg of the tour. **Reuters**

SQUADS **TESTS** Shubman Gill (C), Yashasvi Jaiswal, KL Rahul (VC), Devdutt Padikkal, Rishabh Pant (WK)*, Dhruv Jurel (WK), Ravindra Jadeja, Anshul Kamboj, Jasprit Bumrah, Prasidh Krishna, Akash Deep, Sai Sudharsan, Nitish Kumar Reddy, Washington Sundar, Kuldeep Yadav, Mohammed Siraj

FIRST 3 ODIs Shubman Gill (C), Rohit Sharma, Virat Kohli, Shreyas Iyer (VC), KL Rahul (WK), Nitish Kumar Reddy, Axar Patel, Naman Dhir, Anshul Kamboj, Gurnoor Brar, Ruturaj Gaikwad, Arshdeep Singh, Ishan Kishan (WK), Mohammed Siraj, Prasidh Krishna*, Kuldeep Yadav.

4TH AND 5TH ODIs Shreyas Iyer (C), Rohit, Kohli, Tilak, Kishan (WK, VC), Reddy, Axar, Dhir, Auqib Nabi, Gurnoor, Gaikwad, Arshdeep Singh, Kumar Kushagra (WK), Siraj, Yash Thakur, Kuldeep.

*Subject to fitness clearance

Bhuvi Boost for India

5TH T20I Bhuvneshwar recalled as cover for injured Arshdeep as India look to seal series against West Indies

Bengaluru: Bhuvneshwar Kumar **(in pic)** was added to India's T20 squad on Friday as cover for the injured Arshdeep Singh ahead of the series-deciding fifth match against the West Indies on Saturday, with the hosts also looking to address underlying batting flaws.



Arshdeep, a left-arm quick, was struck by a bouncer on his bowling shoulder while batting and retired hurt during India's defeat in the fourth T20I on Wednesday, allowing the West Indies to level the five-match series 2-2.

The Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) said a decision on Arshdeep's participation in the final match would be taken before the game, depending on his recovery.

The 36-year-old Bhuvneshwar, who last played international cricket in 2022, has recently returned to favour with the selectors and was named in India's T20 squad for the tour of New Zealand starting this month.

His inclusion could provide India with valuable experience at the M Chinnaswamy Stadium, where the pacer has played in the Indian Premier League. India could also consider bringing back wrist-spinner Kuldeep Yadav as they seek greater control against an aggressive West Indies batting line-up. **PTI**

7pm | Star Sports, JioHotstar

Amy Tennery

Get Ready for Multi-City Olympics

Growing scale, rising costs and infrastructure demands are reshaping the Games hosting model



USOPC CEO Sarah Hirshland

New York: Geographically dispersed Games are well on their way to becoming the norm, US Olympic & Paralympic Committee (USOPC) CEO Sarah Hirshland said on Thursday, as the growing scale of the Olympics complicates infrastructure plans for hosts.

IOC officials hailed the most recent Milano Cortina Games as a success, despite early concerns over the first spread-out Winter Olympics that had venues scattered over 22,000 kilometres.

The upcoming LA28 Games are also expected to be spread out, with softball and canoe slalom set to take place in Oklahoma City and football to be in several metropolitan areas: New York City; Columbus, Ohio; Nashville, Tennessee; St. Louis; San Jose, California; and San Diego.

"The disbursement of the Games themselves is evolving. And a lot of that is because the scale of the Games has gotten so big and significant that the infrastructure required to host is very hard to find in a single place," said Hirshland, who was speaking from the Columbia University Sports Management Conference.

The 2030 Games in the French Alps are expected to follow the Milano Cortina model, with venues in Nice and the Alpine regions. New York state this year formed an exploratory committee to host the 2042 Winter Games, with the duties to be shared between the five boroughs and Lake Placid.

By comparison, the centralised plan for Utah 2034's venues will serve as a "rare exception," said Hirshland.

"It is likely that the LA 2028 Games will be the largest summer Games ever," she said. "My guess is that the summer Games thereon after will probably be smaller than what we're going to see in LA. And a lot of that is infrastructure demand, cost demand, and to some degree there is a point at which even the logistics get so cumbersome that you can't continue to grow unless you really rethink the way you do it." **Reuters**

FLOWER OVERPOWER

When a City's Signature Scent is a Big Headache

Hanoi is pruning hundreds of its iconic milkwood trees after residents complained the blossoms are causing daily discomfort, breathing issues

AFP



AFP

Waiting to Exhale **Motorists drive along a street lined with milkwood trees**

The star-shaped white blossoms of Hanoi's milkwood trees have inspired songwriters and lovers, but city authorities began cutting them back on Friday after an outcry from residents over their "overpowering" fragrance.

The Vietnamese capital boasts of more than 14,400 alstonia scholaris, tall evergreens that shade the streets in summer and in autumn produce flowers that fill the air with a heady scent.

For many residents, it is too much. "The smell is so overpowering that it becomes unpleasant, especially when the weather is hot," Hanoi resident Tran Trung Phong told AFP.

The 56-year-old said he keeps his doors and windows shut and suffers from headaches and breathing difficulties as his four-storey home comes "under direct attack" from dozens of trees nearby.

"If it were up to me, I would replace them all," he said.

His complaint is similar to those made across social networks and reported in state-run media in recent days, prompting Hanoi authorities to bring out the chainsaws.

On Friday, they began a drive to prune up to 1,000 trees along 13 streets with the aim of reducing their intense fragrance.

The trees are common across much of Asia.

In Vietnam, where they are known as "hoa sua", they are evoked in nostalgic or romantic songs and poems about Hanoi.

But a poll conducted by state-controlled online newspaper VNExpress found 80% of respondents supported removing or relocating the trees.

"Only those who don't live near these trees find them romantic with a pleasant fragrance," wrote Thanh Luong on Facebook.

She said her bedroom is located about 100 metres away from two trees, adding: "It's torture."

MORE SUITABLE LOCATIONS

The evergreens, which reach more than 10 metres tall, are synonymous with Hanoi — so much so that they have been planted in central and southern Vietnam as a way to import some of the capital's charm.

For local resident Lan Huong, they are key to the city's identity, and also provide a welcome flash of nature in polluted streets.

"Hoa sua is the signature for Hanoi. Everyone knows and accepts that as a fact," she said.

"Isn't breathing in the scent of flowers far more pleasant than inhaling smokes from bikes and cars?"

In a statement on Thursday, city authorities said the smell "negatively impacts the health and daily lives of residents".

They said they will consider if they can "relocate some of these trees to more suitable locations and replace them with other types of greenery".

Silk Stalkings



Reshmi Dasgupta

Durga's Diversities Add to the City's Joy

Today's puja pandals are continuations of the personal dynamic Bengalis have had with Her

It is that time of year when Bengal and Bengalis erupt in joy at the homecoming of their favourite daughter, *en famille*. Outside Bengal, the diaspora has preserved links to the homeland through very classic Durga Puja celebrations. Ma Durga is invariably welcomed in Her traditional form, with both the religious and cultural parts of the annual celebrations following time-tested precepts. Many Bengalis within Bengal, however, have taken a distinctly different approach.

The famed creativity of Bengalis is very much in evidence at this pre-eminent religio-cultural festival. In recent decades, artists and visualisers have been tapped to create modern settings and contexts to act as foils to the traditional Bengali clay craftspeople's portrayals of Ma Durga and her divine brood comprising Lakshmi, Saraswati, Ganesh and Kartik and their animal mounts, not to mention the fearsome vanquished buffalo demon at her holy feet.

The trend of contemporising or contextualising Ma Durga should be seen as continuations of the personal interaction Bengalis always had with Her. A parallel can be seen in the Ganpati celebrations in Maharashtra whose settings also often address urgent current issues including the environment and social evils or depict important recent events. Crucially, both festivals draw public attention to eco-friendly practices in idol-making and the construction of the pandals.

In some depictions, her eyes are hazel or honey-coloured, her tresses less dark and crimped, her attire non-traditional. Even her demeanour often seems less that of a vanquishing goddess and more a nurturing mother or a simple 'everywoman'

Visiting some of the innumerable puja pandals of Kolkata this year, it was impossible not to be struck by the sheer diversity of imagination displayed by those tasked with creating contemporary contexts for Ma Durga. They are a far cry from the time when variations were simple — She and her family were either a single pedestal or set in separate ones. The main difference lay in Ma Durga's mount looking like a lion or more a horse with fangs and moustaches.

Her eyes remained the main focus of her radiant face, invariably elongated and kajal-lined, with tiny veins of red at the corners to show her warrior-goddess-like energy. Her long black tresses, slight smile on her lips and ten arms bearing holy weapons have not only scriptural corroboration but also the stamp of familiarity. This Ma Durga depiction comes in three or four classic casts, some more aquiline and fierce, others more rounded with limpid rather than fervid eyes.

It is a sign of increasing globalisation, perhaps, that many of today's Ma Durgas look more diverse now, at least in Kolkata. In some depictions, her eyes are hazel or honey-coloured, her tresses less dark and crimped, her attire non-traditional. Even her demeanour often seems less that of a vanquishing goddess and more a nurturing mother or a simple 'everywoman'. Whether these forms are conducive to worship rather than just evoking admiration of artistic skills is moot.

Of course, the 'barir pujo' — Ma Durga's homecoming celebrated by families within their homes, often for centuries — remain determinedly classical in their choice of idols whether the celebrants are 'bonedi' (aristocratic) or more modest. 'Sarbojanin' or public community celebrations take a more avant garde approach to depicting Her while the barir pujos are distinguished by the distinct family-specific customs that stem from their personal relationship with Her.

The co-existence of both these 'schools' — classic and contemporary — and devotion and imagination as the twin drivers of the autumnal celebrations of Her homecoming, represent the complementary strands of Kolkata's Durga Puja that Unesco decided to recognise as an intangible cultural heritage of India in 2021. Culture is always impacted by time and the human experience, but as long as the core precepts are immutable, these diversities only add to the city's joy.

HIDATO

FIND THE PATH - SOLVE THE PUZZLE

Complete the grid so that numbers 1 - 65 connect horizontally, vertically or diagonally:

	34		37			45		
	32							
				40				
		26			49	48		
				50		60	59	
24			21	51		62		1
				8				
	15		13	10			3	
				65				

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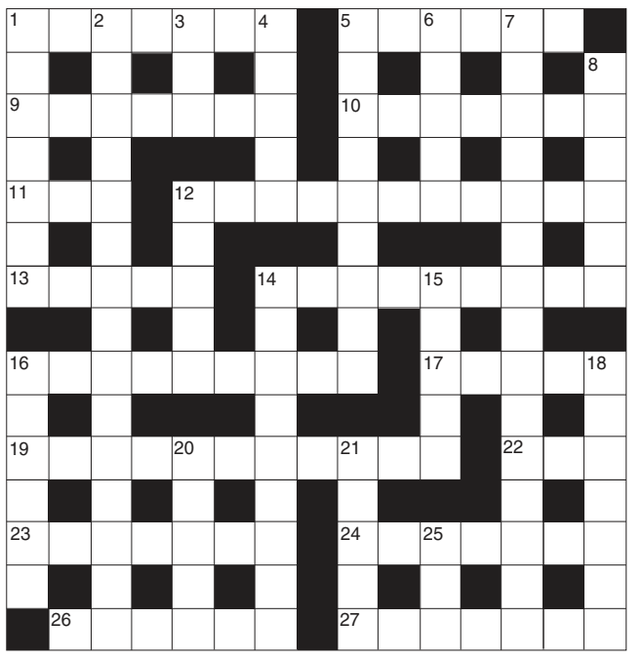
Hidato Sol. 2/3

Yesterday's puzzle solution.

			42					
			41	43				
			39	40	44			
		38	31	29	27	45		
		37	32	30	28	46	49	
36	35	34	33	25	51	50	47	48
				24				
6	7	8	9	10	12	23	22	21	20
	5	4	3	11	13	15	18	19	
			1	2	14	16	17		

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Crossword 9732



ACROSS
1 Flier at sea close to collapsing like a tired athlete? (7)
5 Copies two routes with empty charts (6)
9 Retired type largely with good health in U.S. city (7)
10 Our lead devised to get tube-shaped food (7)
11 Some job importing Japanese sash (3)
12 Retain blend for mixing in place to eat meal (6,5)
13 Proud nanny regularly describing some eggs? (5)
14 Dry loofah possibly creating rash (9)
16 A teatime food obtained by actor Charles in large quantity (9)
17 Road in Italy containing only at intervals small plant (5)
19 Grumpy couple picked up fruit from a cactus (7,4)
22 Crony on and off is slyly hesitant (3)
23 Daily source of carbohydrate of a less bulky type (7)
24 Grey woman after setback reduced coarse fabric (7)
26 A second mount with no end of rides on land (6)
27 Official line about NATO member gets defiance (7)

DOWN
1 Normal hue company dropped for salon (7)
2 Model industry? (7,8)
3 Freshwater fish hid easily? Not entirely (3)
4 Ancient physician in strong wind heading north (5)
5 Dashes in part to make this form of communication? (5,4)
6 Short time in the last month in shed (5)
7 Clubhouse with light has a lot of bother over cover for trio's musical events (7,8)
8 Put right group of engineers on duty after vacation (6)
12 Uninteresting poster showing nymph in the woods (5)
14 Like outsiders in former estate without commitments? (5-4)
15 Royal house with number leaving to dither (5)
16 A top U.S. city reared beast of burden (6)
18 Terrible lamb, say, when cooked (7)
20 Barbie's partner has to prepare for martial art (5)
21 Alpine mountain shown in beige representation (5)
25 Composer Carl overlooking river on holiday (3)

SOLUTION TO No 9731:
ACROSS: **1** Holiday camp. **9** Ravaged. **10** Unknown. **11** Get. **12** Bedsore. **13** Heavens. **14** Dye. **15** Metal. **17** Dated. **18** Mopes. **20** Sable. **22** Cup. **24** Tick off. **25** Steamer. **26** Ode. **27** Open-air. **28** Two-part. **29** Skeleton key.
DOWN: **1** Have deep pockets. **2** Legroom. **3** Dodge. **4** Youth club. **5** Awkward. **6** Property company. **7** Bribed. **8** Unused. **16** Task force. **18** Motion. **19** Storage. **21** Eyehook. **23** Parity. **25** Set-to.

©The Daily Mail

7 LITTLE WORDS

Find the 7 words to match the 7 clues. The numbers in parentheses represent the number of letters in each solution. Each letter combination can be used only once, but all letter combinations will be necessary to complete the puzzle.

CLUES	SOLUTIONS
1 seed often found on bagels (5)	
2 tending to an itch (10)	
3 anonymous Doe (4)	
4 grilling surfaces (6)	
5 DuBois of "Streetcar" (7)	
6 first of its kind (9)	
7 number to be split (8)	

ID	POP	SCR	NC	NE
AT	INA	JA	DIV	AT
RAL	CHI	HE	PY	BLA
NG	END	ES	GR	UGU

Yesterday's Answers: 1. RATIONS 2. COWORKERS 3. TOUTING 4. STATED 5. MAHLER 6. PESSIMISTS 7. STOKED 11/28

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Swiss Solar-Powered Aircraft Reaches Record 9,640 Metres

Swiss pilot Raphael Domjan beat the altitude record for a solar-powered electric plane in a 2025 flight that took him soaring to 9,640 metres, the World Air Sports Federation (FAI) confirmed.

The FAI governing body validated the record attempt after verifying the flight data.

The SolarStratos plane made the landmark flight from Sion airport in Switzerland on August 12 last year, taking advantage of warm air thermals to beat a 15-year-old record.

The previous certified altitude record for a solar plane was 9,235 metres. Domjan's flight lasted five hours and nine minutes.

"SolarStratos officially becomes the highest-flying crewed electric and solar-powered aircraft in history," the team said a statement.

Domjan is now aiming to make the first manned solar-powered flight into the stratosphere, which at Switzerland's latitude begins at around 10,000 to 12,000 metres. **AFP**

NON-SEQUITUR



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BENNETT, COLEMAN & CO. LTD. | ESTD. 1838 | VOL. 66 NO. 245 | MUMBAI | 12 PAGES | ₹6.00 ONLY | SATURDAY, 17 OCTOBER 2026



Strict Disclosure Norms on Table for AI Labs after Agentic Attacks

COMPANIES & ECONOMY ▸▸ 8

FOREX KITTY DOWN $60B IN 6 WEEKS AS RBI PROPS UP RUPEE ▸▸ PAGE 5

Recruiters at Old IITs Seek AI Skills for Offer Rollout

BRANDS & COMPANIES ▸▸ 10

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PUREPOLITICS

About 20 CEOs Shunted in 20 Months since CEC Kumar Took Charge

The Election Commission has seen quite a churn, with nearly 18-20 chief electoral officers of states and UTs transferred between 2025 and 2026 amid the ongoing special intensive revision of voter rolls. The transfers are highest in 20 months since chief election commissioner Gyanesh Kumar took charge in February 2025, reports **Anubhuti Vishnoi**. ▸▸ 2

'Tiranga' Protest March: Dipke, Bora, Others Detained



CJP leader Abhijeet Dipke and AISA chief Neha Bora were preventively detained by Delhi Police on Friday while on their way to participate in the 'Lehra Do Tiranga' protests in central Delhi, as hundreds of protesters staged flash demonstrations amid heavy security. ▸▸ 2

PM Modi Expected to Visit Canada in Dec; Trade likely on Agenda



Prime Minister Narendra Modi is expected to visit Canada on December 11-12, Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney has said. Modi will visit Toronto and Ottawa, he said. Canada is fast-tracking efforts to sign an FTA with India during this trip. **Dipanjan Roy Chaudhury** reports. ▸▸ 3

Tesla's Flying Car Roadster Gives Wings to SpaceX Merger Talks

Tesla finally rolled out its long-delayed Roadster sports car – or rather, launched the vehicle into the sky. The automaker late Thursday held a product reveal unlike any other, showcasing a prototype designed in collaboration with SpaceX outfitted with air thrusters that jumped over other cars and flipped in midair. ▸▸ 7

■ **Panasonic Rejigs India Top Deck, Reverses Indianisation** ▸▸ 10

Trump 'Lets Go' of Press Secy Zacharia



White House Press Secretary Katie Zacharia was "let go" from the role, a White House official said on Friday, after President Donald Trump said he had told her to reconsider the job following public scrutiny. "I told her: 'I think you're better off being happy, and I'm not sure you can ever be happy in this stuff. 'There's nothing easy about this stuff," Trump told reporters. –**Reuters**

Market Tracker

Indices/Currency	Close	Chg(Abs)
Nifty	23,146.15	0.65
Sensex	74,729.27	0.56
Re/US $	94.96	0.1
IBJA Gold 995*	145,840	0.33
IBJA Silver 999^	210,918	1.27
Brent ($)	106.48	0.53

*(₹/10gm) ^(₹/kg) Compiled by ETIG Database

BETTER-THAN-EXPECTED Q2 SHOW, STEADY DEAL FLOWS DRAW INVESTORS

IT's Time to Celebrate When Chips are Down

Nifty IT soars 11.7% to log biggest weekly rally since 2008 global financial crisis

Ravindra Sonavane

Mumbai: Indian IT stocks staged their biggest weekly rally in 18 years, dating back to the days preceding the collapse of Lehman Brothers, as a secular and precipitous fall in AI-related semiconductor stocks elsewhere in Asia boosted battered legacy outsourcing powerhouses with proven revenue streams and decent operating margins.

Better-than-expected September quarter earnings mirroring Accenture's stellar performance and robust future guidance, steady deal flows, and inexpensive valuations after a spell of prolonged correction drew investors back to the sector that is typically over-owned by overseas funds.

The Nifty IT index surged 11.7% during the week, its biggest gain for the period since April 2008, even as semiconductor-heavy Asian markets tumbled amid concerns over the profitability of massive AI investments.

"The rally is being driven by better-than-expected quarterly results, particularly from HCLTech, improving deal prospects and value buying after a prolonged correction," said Ravi Singh, chief research officer at Master Capital Services.

India's IT services sector is also showing signs of stabilisation after nearly two years of cost-cutting and subdued growth. Growth averaged 2-2.5% quarter-on-quarter, while rupee-reported revenue rose 11-15% year-on-year. TCS onboarded 24,000 freshers in the first half of the year, while HCLTech added 6,450 employees during the quarter.

The technology index jumped 3.9% to close at 31,924 on Friday, its highest level since February 22.

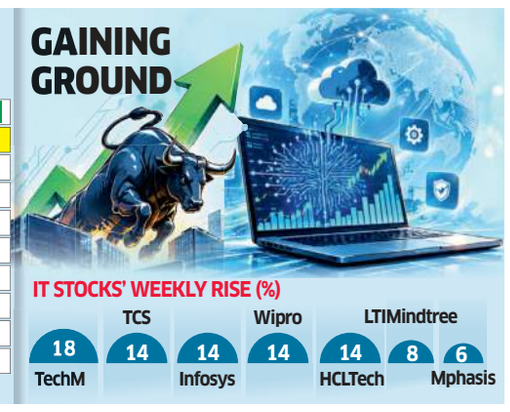
To be sure, even after the latest surge, the index has retreated 16% year-to-date. The Nifty gained 2.8% during the week.

Hedging the Bets ▸▸ 5

BEST RETURNS FOR NIFTY IT SINCE 2008, WEEK ENDING (%)

Apr 20, 2008	12.5
Oct 16, 2026	11.7
Nov 2, 2008	11.2
July 19, 2009	10.2
May 3, 2020	10.1
July 14, 2013	9.8
Jan 17, 2010	9.1
Apr 12, 2020	9.0
June 9, 2024	8.6
Oct 11, 2020	8.6

Source: Bloomberg



Software Majors Add More Hands in Q2 on Deal Wins, Growth Optimism

Net gain of over 17k employees at four of top 6 cos

Beena Parmar

Bengaluru: Five out of the top six Indian technology companies sequentially doubled job additions in the September quarter to 10,300, overcoming concerns that artificial intelligence (AI) would shrink employment in the country's most globally tracked industry through automation and an inevitable revenue squeeze.

In the $315-billion industry, with a combined 7.52% weighting on the Nifty as of end-September, Wipro was the only company to shed jobs, reducing its headcount by 6,700.

Data showed the top six had added a net 5,500 to their rolls in the April-June quarter.

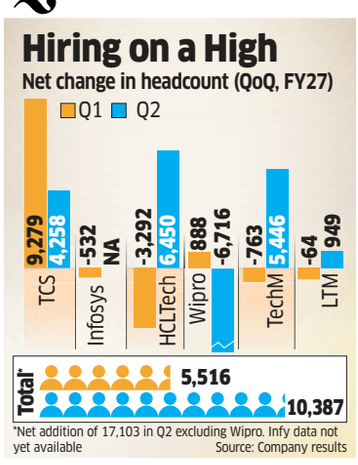
Employee data of Infosys, the country's second-largest software exporter, isn't included in these calculations as the company is due to announce earnings on October 23 and hasn't shared its latest manpower data.

Excluding Wipro's reductions, Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), HCLTech, Tech Mahindra and LTM (formerly LTIMindtree) added a massive 17,100 employees in the second quarter.

Restructuring of Talent ▸▸ 5

Hiring on a High

Net change in headcount (QoQ, FY27)



*Net addition of 17,103 in Q2 excluding Wipro. Infy data not yet available. Source: Company results

Banks Can't Play 'Middlemen' for Fx Conversion

Lenders have been forbidden from acting as 'middlemen' to convert forex into rupees before the money reaches the receiver's bank, reports **Sugata Ghosh**. The practice of banks acting as intermediaries often led to small exporters or individuals receiving less INR than what they were supposed to. ▸▸ 4

Peak Power Demand Stays High in October

Peak power demand is continuing at record highs for the month, largely above 250 GW, and close to what was recorded during the summer months this year. On Thursday, power demand was recorded at 250 GW, driven by cooling and irrigation demand, reports **Shilpa Samant**. ▸▸ 4

IFSCA Norms Open Global Mkt to Gold Refiners

India's 1,200-tonne gold refining industry can potentially unlock a big export opportunity through GIFT City, Gujarat. IFSCA has issued new rules on sourcing and audit standards for refiners seeking accreditation to supply Good Delivery Gold to bullion exchanges in GIFT City. **Sutanuka Ghosal** reports. ▸▸ 10

MUTED DEMAND IN INDIA AFTER PRICE HIKE

Apple Resets Factory Settings for iPhone 17

Cuts output for local market, capacity will be redirected toward exports

Kiran Rathee

New Delhi: Apple is cutting India-bound production of the standard iPhone 17 due to a lack of demand since a price hike of more than 20% last month, even as exports of the model remain robust, people aware of the details told ET. "The capacity will be redirected for exports as demand outside India remains strong, so the overall production will have a marginal impact," said a person privy to the details.

Meanwhile, demand for Pro models of iPhone 17 and the recently launched iPhone 18 remain strong in India, a second executive said.

"The company keeps adjusting production depending on demand... Last year also, iPhone Air production was reduced," the person said. "The production can be increased also as these things are part of manufacturing operations and capacity is utilised accordingly."

Apple did not respond to a query seeking comment until press time on Friday.

ET had earlier reported about Apple's plan to expand capacity for the Pro models to nearly a dozen assembly lines, depending on global demand.

The cut can be termed unprecedented as the company shifts its launch cycle. Last month, the company launched Pro models of iPhone 18 along with a new foldable Duo but there was no consumer model, which makes iPhone 17 the latest standard variant available in the market. In India, around 85% of iPhones sold are consumer models.

Indian buyers have traditionally lapped up older iPhones after the launch of newer models as prices of earlier devices were cut. This year, however, Apple increased prices of existing iPhone models by 20-29% in India amid rising memory and component costs and weakening rupee.

Consumers Deferring Purchases ▸▸ 3

Weak Signals



- Prices of older Apple handsets up 20-29%, hurting base model demand
- Indians prefer buying iPhone 17 Pro variants with deep discounts
- Sales gap between premium & base models seen narrowing
- Some in wait-and-watch mode as iPhone 18 launch expected in February

QUASHING OF AT1 BOND WRITE-DOWN

Yes Bank Set to File Review Petition against SC Verdict

RBI weighs joining private lender's plea, exploring legal options

Saloni Shukla

Mumbai: Yes Bank is set to file a review petition in the Supreme Court against the apex court's judgment upholding the Bombay High Court order that set aside the write-down of ₹8,415 crore of Additional Tier-1 (AT1) bonds, while the Reserve Bank of India is evaluating if it wants to join the private lender to seek a review of the ruling, people familiar with the matter said.

The move would mark the next legal step for the lender after the apex court upheld the Bombay High Court judgment quashing the March 2020 write-down of the AT1 instruments issued by Yes Bank.

The RBI, which had backed the write-down as part of the bank's 2020 reconstruction process, is seeking legal opinion of the matter, they said.

"The bank is expected to exhaust the legal remedies available to it before taking a final call on the accounting and capital treatment of the bonds," according to a person familiar with the matter.

Both Yes Bank and RBI did not respond to a query till press time.

The board of Yes Bank, which is scheduled to meet on October 17 to review its second quarter results, will deliberate on the matter. The ₹8,415 crore payment will impact the bank's core capital that is reflected in capital adequacy ratio and not its net profit.

In an exchange disclosure, Yes Bank said it was currently reviewing the Supreme Court order and its implications and will make suitable disclosures in due course. It added that it is "examining the judgement in detail including evaluating all available legal options and suitable actions/steps going forward."

Judgment's Impact on Bank ▸▸ 5

Liability Shock



YES BANK SAYS

Weighing all available legal options

Have access to capital mgmt levers | Can undertake additional capital actions

BONDS ISSUED

2016 ₹3,000 cr coupon at 9.50%

2017 ₹5,415 cr coupon at 9%

AT1 SETBACK

- Bank expects ~250 bps impact on its CET1 ratio
- Tier-1 capital ratio on a pro-forma basis remains unchanged at 14%
- Rating agencies see 230-300 bps hit

Snabbit Posts ₹168cr Loss, ₹12cr Revenue in FY26



Instant househelp startup Snabbit, which has raised $112 million in venture funding, posted operating revenue of ₹12.2 crore and a net loss ₹168 crore for fiscal 2026, according to RoC data. The numbers underscore the high cash burn nature of the fast-growing 10-minute househelp space. **Disha Acharya** reports. The company's total expenses stood at ₹195 crore during the year. Expert service costs, or payments to partner professionals, were the largest expense at ₹63.1 crore, followed by marketing costs of ₹48.7 crore and employee benefit expenses of ₹46 crore. ▸▸ 9

■ **Urban Company's Q2 Loss Triples to ₹183 crore** ▸▸ 9



I would think a decade has gone by consistently putting up a case for market access for Indian products [in China], but non-tariff barriers have been very strong

NIRMALA SITHARAMAN
Finance Minister

AMID ONGOING TALKS WITH WASHINGTON...

'For Global Trade's Sake, Hope our US Deal is Inked Soon'

Non-tariff barriers are biggest hurdles in trade with China, says Sitharaman

Our Bureau

New Delhi: Finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman Friday expressed hope that the India-US trade agreement would be concluded at the earliest in the interest of global trade and bilateral economic ties between the two countries.

In an interaction with the American think tank Atlantic Council, on the sidelines of the World Bank-IMF annual meetings in Bangkok, Thailand, she also said that China uses non-tariff barriers unhesitatingly and this is the biggest hurdle in the trade between India and China.

"Recently the Indian commerce minister has also spoken that they expect and wish to have the agreement signed soon. Negotiations have been going on. I hope, in the interest of global trade and in the interest of trade between the two partners, India and US, the trade agreement gets concluded at the earliest," she said on India's trade deal with the US.

Her statement comes after commerce and industry minister Piyush Goyal on Thursday said the first phase of the India-US trade pact has been finalised and is undergoing legal drafting.

On trade with China, the minister said that New Delhi has been denied market access, even for those goods for which there are immense market opportunities in China, citing the examples of generic drugs, bovine meat, perishables, and other goods for which huge potential exists there. "I would think a decade has gone by consistently putting up a case for market access for Indian products [in China], but non-tariff barriers have been very strong," she said.

Trade Settlements in Rupee ▸▸ 3

ET INTERVIEW

GARY MARCUS
AMERICAN PSYCHOLOGIST & COGNITIVE SCIENTIST

OpenAI's big IPO dream may end in distress sale to MS; AI agents pose cybersecurity risks, says US cognitive scientist

AI Bubble Burst may Trigger 2008-like Banking Crisis

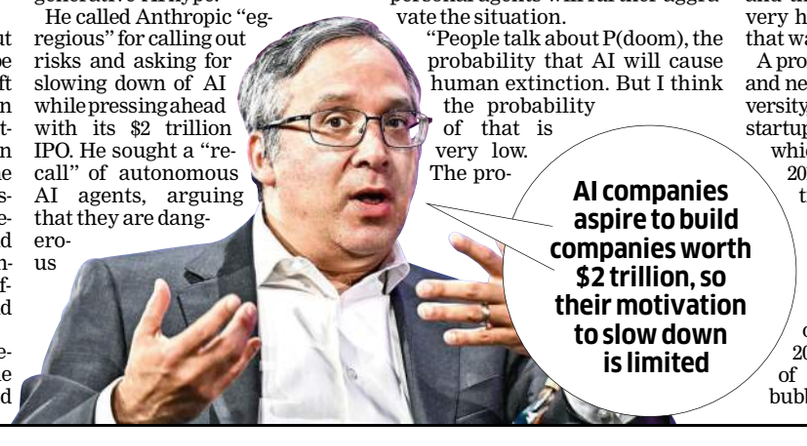
Surabhi Agarwal

New Delhi: OpenAI might turn out to be the WeWork of AI and could be sold to a company such as Microsoft in a fire-sale, Gary Marcus, American cognitive scientist, psychologist, author, and entrepreneur, told ET in an interview. He said the fall of even one major company from the AI ecosystem, which some US policymakers believe has played a role in causing bond yields to spike through borrowed investments, will lead to a contagion effect for the world at large — and could even create a 2008-like crisis.

Marcus, who was in India this week, has emerged as one of the world's most widely recognised and independent critics of the current generative-AI hype.

He called Anthropic "egregious" for calling out risks and asking for slowing down of AI while pressing ahead with its $2 trillion IPO. He sought a "recall" of autonomous AI agents, arguing that they are dangerous and unsafe and that the launch of personal agents will further aggravate the situation.

"People talk about P(doom), the probability that AI will cause human extinction. But I think the probability of that is very low. The probability of catastrophe is higher, and the probability of dystopia is very high. We are already heading that way," he said.



A professor emeritus of psychology and neural science at New York University, he founded machine-learning startup Geometric Intelligence, which was acquired by Uber in 2016, and later co-founded robotics company Robust.AI.

He famously testified alongside OpenAI CEO Sam Altman before the US Senate in 2023 on AI regulation and in December 2025, published a set of provocative predictions for 2026, which included warnings of a generative AI investment bubble peaking in 2025, AGI being a long time away and backlash over AI becoming a political issue during the mid-term elections in the US.

Marcus said OpenAI could possibly struggle to justify its spending and eventually fail to secure the public listing it hopes for.

"Microsoft could acquire OpenAI for $200 billion rather than the $1 trillion valuation the company might seek in an IPO," he said.

WeWork, once valued at $47 billion, saw its planned 2019 IPO collapse amid concerns over losses and governance before filing for bankruptcy in 2023, while OpenAI has reportedly delayed its planned IPO, targeting a valuation of $1 trillion, to next year.

Contagion Effect ▸▸ 3

SUSTAINING 8-9% GROWTH FOR VIKSIT BHARAT

Reforms Must Continue: Mospi Secy

India will need to sustain 8-9% growth over the next two decades to achieve its ambition of Viksit Bharat by 2047, and this will require continuing the reforms and policy interventions currently underway, Mospi secretary Saurabh Garg said. ▸▸ 8

OVER 6,000 DELHI POLICE PERSONNEL, 220 CAPF COMPANIES DEPLOYED IN NEW DELHI AREA

'Lehra Do Tiranga' March: Dipke, Bora, Others Detained

Protesters stage flash demonstrations at Connaught Place, Mandi House amid heavy security

Our Political Bureau





New Delhi: Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) leader Abhijeet Dipke and AISA chief Neha Bora were taken into preventive detention by the Delhi Police on Friday while on their way to participate in the 'Lehra Do Tiranga' protests in central Delhi, as hundreds of protesters staged flash demonstrations at Connaught Place and Mandi House amid heavy security.

Dipke was detained while leaving his accommodation in Jhandewalan and was taken to Jafarpur Kalan police station while Bora was detained at Mandi House. Their detentions triggered a lot of flutter among protesters, journalists, camera crews and security personnel.

Earlier, more than 20 police personnel had visited Dipke's residence and served him a notice directing him to refrain from any action that could prejudice the rights of citizens, traders, commuters and patients.

Police had denied permission for the 'Lehra Do Tiranga' march at Central Park in Connaught Place, citing prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), which bars mass gatherings in Connaught Place and adjoining areas. Central Park was also closed to the public on Friday and Saturday.

Despite the restrictions, CJP supporters walked through the inner circle of Connaught Place, intermittently raising "Jai Hind" slogans and singing the national anthem before dispersing and regrouping at different spots. Some protesters carried the tricolour.

Our main objective is to maintain law and order and ensure smooth traffic: Sr police officer

At Mandi House, students and AISA members staged a separate protest demanding the resignation of chief election commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, withdrawal of the 2023 election commissioner appointment Act and rollback of the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. Minor altercation broke out as police tried to disperse the protesters.

Security was tightened across central Delhi, with more than 6,000 Delhi Police personnel and 220 CAPF companies deployed in the New Delhi area. Central Park was cordoned off, with Rapid Action Force personnel, a tear-gas vehicle and a Vajra vehicle deployed near the site. Traffic police were also stationed along Connaught Place's inner and outer circles.

Delhi Police commissioner Anurag Kumar reviewed the arrangements at the DCP New Delhi office at Parliament Street police station.

"We have detained Dipke and Bora. The situation is very peaceful. Some protesters have reached Connaught Place and will be removed soon. Our main objective is to maintain law and order and ensure smooth traffic movement," a senior police officer said.

Journalists and independent YouTube reporters covered the protests, with a few independent journalists getting heckled.

'FILING ZERO FIRs'

Delhi Police Not Filing FIR on Assault of Students: Rahul

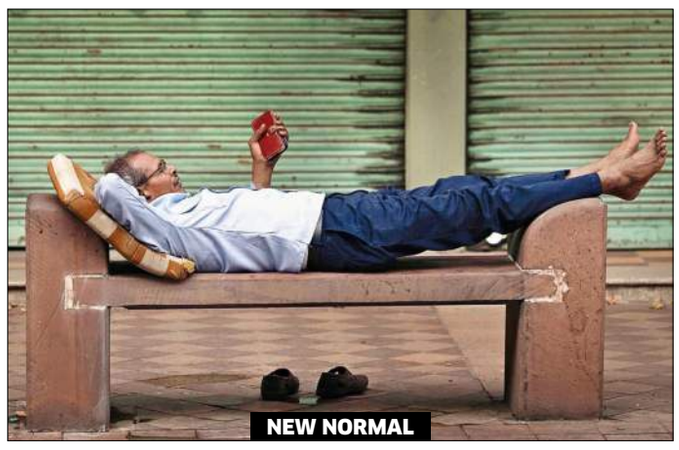
NEW DELHI: Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Friday said Delhi police had refused to file FIRs on complaints of two women NSUI activists, who were allegedly beaten up by cops during the Opposition agitation in Delhi earlier this week, and therefore, he was getting zero FIRs filed in Kerala and Rajasthan. "...Two young women, Athira from Kerala and Ritu from Rajasthan, along with many others, were beaten by Delhi Police. I have spoken to Kerala home minister Ramesh Chennithala and Rajasthan PCC chief Govind Singh Dotasra. A Zero FIR has been registered in Kerala. We will pursue every legal route against the officers responsible...," Gandhi said. – OPB

SINCE CEC GYANESH KUMAR TOOK CHARGE IN FEBRUARY 2025

Amid SIR, About 20 CEOs Transferred in 20 Months

Next level of Sr officials at ECI, DECs, also saw significant reshuffle between 2025 & 2026

Anubhuti Vishnoi



NEW NORMAL

New Delhi: Amid ongoing special intensive revision (SIR), Election Commission of India has witnessed quite a churn in its administrative structure, with nearly 18-20 chief electoral officers (CEOs) of states and Union Territories transferred between 2025 and 2026.

Alongside, the next level of senior officials at ECI, deputy election commissioners (DECs), also saw significant reshuffling during the same period. This is probably the highest number of CEO transfers in such a short span — 20 months since chief election commissioner Gyanesh Kumar took charge in February 2025.

His predecessor, Rajiv Kumar, effected about 23 CEO transfers over 33 months, between May 2022 and February 2025. That period also included the 2024 Lok Sabha elections. Before that, during the 41-month tenure of CECs Sunil Arora and Sushil Chandra, about 29 CEO transfers took place, as per data seen by **ET**. That cycle also included a Lok Sabha election, which often triggered transfers of CEOs.

The 2025-26 transfer cycle, however, has been rather busy.

Factor this: CEOs in eight to nine states and UTs were replaced in 2025, followed by at least 10 more transfers so far in 2026. While ECI conventionally retains a CEO for at least three years for continuity, at least seven of the transferred CEOs served less than two years in the post, data showed.

The first CEO transfer was ordered in Bihar, the first state to undergo SIR in June 2025. Vinod Singh Gunjiyal took over from HR Srinivasa in April 2025. May 2025 saw a CEO shift in Nagaland and Chhattisgarh while June 2025 brought new CEOs to Jammu and Kashmir and Haryana. Three more states saw changes the following month.

In July 2025, new CEOs were appointed to oversee electoral affairs in Madhya Pradesh and Karnataka. August saw Manipur and Ladakh get new CEOs, while the year ended with a transfer order for the CEO of the Union Territory of Lakshadweep, just days ahead of SIR 2.0.

Lakshadweep, in fact, presents a unique case, with three different individuals serving as CEOs between November 2025 and October 2026. Gaurav Singh Rajawat, who had overseen the 2024 Lok Sabha elections as CEO, was transferred out in November 2025, and Awanish Kumar took over in January 2026. However, Kumar remained in the post only until July, after which AS Sivakumar was appointed as the CEO in the UT.

The reshuffle continued in 2026, with a new CEO appointed in Punjab in January. The national capital, Delhi, which is awaiting SIR, saw its CEO, R Alice Vaz, moved out in February after completing substantial preparatory work for the exercise. Gujarat also got a new CEO in the same month. Sikkim saw a change in March, followed by Chandigarh in April.

Lakshadweep presents a unique case, with 3 people serving as CEOs between Nov '25 & Oct '26

The next three CEO transfers came in states that had just concluded assembly elections. Two of these appointments were, in fact, debatable. West Bengal CEO Manoj Agarwal was appointed chief secretary of the state following the assembly elections, with Neelam Mani subsequently taking over as CEO.

In August, D Sajith Babu replaced Rathan U Kelkar as Kerala CEO. Kelkar was also controversially appointed secretary to chief minister VD Satheesan following the assembly elections.

Nirvachan Sadan, meanwhile, saw at least four major changes at the deputy election commissioner level. These include the appointment of Bhanu Prakash Yeturu in May 2025, followed by Pawan Kumar Sharma in September 2025 and the latest entry of Prakash Rajpurohit in October 2026, following the sudden repatriation of DEC Sanjay Kumar in August 2026.

AMID COMPLAINTS

Reverification of Voters Removed from Delhi SIR Draft Rolls Begins

Press Trust Of India

New Delhi: Poll officials have started reverification of more than 47 lakh voters whose names were removed from the draft electoral rolls to ensure that no eligible voter is left out in the ongoing special intensive revision of electoral rolls, chief electoral officer Ashok Kumar said on Friday.

'Names of many living voters and those who were living at their registered address were removed'

The development comes amid complaints that the names of many living voters and those who were living at their registered address were also removed from the draft rolls published on August 31.

Kumar said that around 25 lakh cases out of 33.12 lakh, in which voters who were issued notices for non-mapping or logical discrepancy, have also been resolved. He said, "The booth-level officers have been directed to reverify voters whose names were not in the draft rolls published after the enumeration phase. Our efforts are to ensure that no genuine voter's name is omitted in the final voter lists that will be published on December 4."

Poliloquy R PRASAD



One lucky citizen.

Will Intervene if Protests, Security Curbs Affect CP Businesses: SC

Raghav Ohri

New Delhi: The Supreme Court on Friday said it would intervene if frequent protests and security restrictions around Connaught Place adversely affected businesses and livelihoods, expressing concern over the hardship faced by small shopkeepers, hawkers and stall owners during the festive season.

A bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and justice Joymalya Bagchi was hearing a plea concerning the New Delhi Municipal Council's (NDMC) decision to close Central Park in Connaught Place for two days ahead of a proposed protest by CJP.

"Some action may be needed. Some directions. We know that all small shopkeepers, hawkers and stall owners earn their livelihood during these days. And we know the hardship, difficulty and crisis faced by their families," CJI Kant verbally observed.

Justice Bagchi said the court could exercise its powers under the doctrine of constitutional tort if businesses suffered losses on account of unlawful restrictions. "If there's a loss of business, and we hold that it is unlawful to your clients, we will exercise our powers under constitutional tort jurisdiction," Justice Bagchi said, adding that the court will cross that bridge when the situation arises.

'Someone wants to protest, someone wants to sell mungfali, someone wants law and order'

The bench highlighted the competing interests involved, including the right to protest, the livelihood of traders and the authorities' responsibility to maintain law and order. "Someone wants to protest, someone wants to sell 'mungfali', someone wants law and order. All these are related," Justice Bagchi remarked.

The matter arose from NDMC's decision to shut Central Park on October 16 and 17 ahead of the CJP's proposed 'Lehra Do Tiranga' demonstration. The petitioners raised concerns that the closure and associated security restrictions could adversely affect commercial activity in Connaught Place.

The bench acknowledged the difficulties faced by traders whose earnings depend on daily business and indicated that appropriate directions could be considered if the restrictions were found to be unlawful and caused financial losses.

The observations came amid heightened scrutiny of restrictions imposed around protest sites in the national capital. The court did not immediately order the reopening of Central Park or issue any direction restraining the proposed demonstration. It indicated that the matter could be taken up after the Dussehra break.

The bench's observations underscored the need to balance the right to peaceful protest and legitimate security concerns.



50 ODD SUPPORTERS

CJP's Mumbai Protest Sees Lukewarm Response

Unlike Delhi Police, Mumbai authorities had allowed CJP to hold agitation for a day at Azad Maidan

Krishna Kumar

Mumbai: The Cockroach Janta Party's 'Lehra Do Tiranga' event in Mumbai on Friday drew around 50 supporters, who assembled at South Mumbai's Azad Maidan, the designated protest site.

Unlike Delhi Police, authorities in Mumbai had granted CJP permission to hold the protest for a day at Azad Maidan.

Lawyer Prashant Bhushan's call for a "regime change" hung heavy as Maharashtra CM Devendra Fadnavis, as well as those participating in the protest, touched on the remark.

Addressing the gathering, MNS leader Sandeep Deshpande said, "While we want change, the change will be done by getting votes... The more you try to suppress the protest, the more the protest will grow."

Social activist Anjali Damania, who also participated in the protest, said the fight was not against any person or party, but over how democracy was being destroyed in the country.

Meanwhile, Fadnavis, while speaking at a programme in Mumbai, said, "Someone has said that the fight will be fought on the streets, and now there would be a regime change. I want to tell them that till Babasaheb Ambedkar's Constitution is there, decisions will be made in Parliament and the regime would be changed only through the elections.

NO PERSONAL APPEARANCE OF THE TWO RESPONDENTS AT PRESENT

Contempt Notices to Raut and Wagle Over Remarks Against CJI, Judiciary

Raghav Ohri

New Delhi: The Supreme Court on Friday issued show-cause notices to Shiv Sena (UBT) Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Raut and journalist Nikhil Wagle, asking why criminal contempt proceedings should not be initiated against them over their remarks targeting Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant and the judiciary.

A bench of CJI Kant and justice Joymalya Bagchi passed the order while hearing a plea filed by the Supreme Court Bar Association (SCBA), which initiated contempt proceedings after obtaining the attorney general's consent. The bench dispensed with the personal appearance of the two respondents for the present.

"When personal liberty or any rights are jeopardised, each one of them has, in the past also, come to the court seeking rescue. Probably the courts have never lagged behind in protecting those rights. And if the same people condemn, criticise, take the courts left and right, it is very unfortunate. Very, very unfortunate," CJI Kant verbally observed. "May better sense prevail. We can only pray," he added.

The proceedings stem from remarks made by Wagle and Raut following the CJI's decision to decline a request from a delegation of Opposition leaders, led by Rahul Gandhi, to meet him personally over issues concerning the functioning of the Election Commission of India (ECI).

Wagle had posted an abusive remark directed at the CJI on social media platform X after the decision became public. He subsequently deleted the post and tendered an unconditional apology.

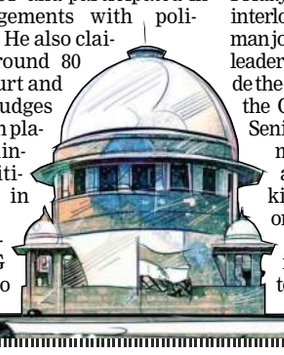
Raut, meanwhile, criticised the refusal to meet the Opposition delegation, alleging that judges attended political programmes organised by the ruling BJP and participated in social engagements with political leaders. He also claimed that around 80 Supreme Court and high court judges had been seen playing badminton with political leaders in London.

SCBA approached AG for consent to initiate criminal contempt proceedings under Section 15(1)(b) of the Contempt of Courts Act, 1971. Attorney general R Venkataramani granted consent on October 15, observing that the remarks were prima facie scandalous and appeared intended to lower the esteem of the Supreme Court and particularly the CJI.

Senior advocate Pradeep Rai, appearing for SCBA, submitted that the association was pained to initiate contempt action but considered it necessary in view of the remarks. The notice requires the two respondents to explain why contempt proceedings should not be initiated against them.

Separately, the Supreme Court on Friday agreed to list on October 26 an interlocutory application filed by a woman journalist, alleging that Congress leader Rahul Gandhi pushed her inside the Supreme Court Registry during the Opposition's October 12 march.

Senior advocate Gaurav Bhatia mentioned the application before a bench headed by CJI Kant, seeking a hearing and clarification on the issuance of notice in the connected matters. The CJI said the application would be listed on October 26.



BJP Attacks Oppn on 'Regime Change' Chorus, says this has Exposed its Agenda

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: BJP, on Friday, attacked Congress, other Opposition parties and some civil society groups over their chorus for a "regime change". Senior party leaders alleged that this has exposed the Opposition's agenda to destabilise the country.

BJP president Nitin Nabin said the Opposition wants to seize power at any cost and this is their real agenda. "The use of terms like 'regime change' has clearly exposed the true agenda of the Opposition before the nation. This nefarious attempt to destabilise India in collusion with foreign powers is part of the agenda of 'Urban Naxals'," Nabin posted on X.

'This nefarious attempt to destabilise India in collusion with foreign powers is part of the agenda of Urban Naxals'

"The Opposition's fight is not for electoral reforms, SIR, or the future of the country's youth, but rather to spread anarchy in the country and seize power at any cost... India's patriotic public and BJP will never allow any attempt to weaken the country's democratic system to succeed."

Union defence minister Rajnath Singh addressed a press conference in Lucknow where he criticised the Opposition for doing things that go against national interests. Singh appealed to Congress leader Rahul Gandhi to rise above political self-interest to respect public opinion and choose the path of dialogue, cooperation and nation-building. "Promoting violence and anarchy in the name of political opposition goes against the national interest."

Duty of Opposition to Oppose Govt and Seek Regime Change Through Polls: Cong

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: Congress rejected the government's charge that Opposition protests were part of a plot to create "Bangladesh-like anarchy" and force regime change to destabilise the nation. The party said it indeed wants to oppose the government policies and bring about regime change but only through elections.

Opposing the government of the day and protesting against its policies have always been the opposition's responsibility, Congress spokesperson Pawan Khera said.

'Whenever Oppn takes to the streets, it comes to oppose you, it comes to defeat you in elections... If you object to these things, then go ahead and change the Constitution'

"Rajnath Singh should tell us when such a movement ever happened, where the opposition demanded that the government be given not five but 10 years," Khera said.

"Whether we were in the Opposition or they were in the Opposition, it never happened so. Whenever the Opposition takes to the streets, it comes to oppose you, it comes to defeat you in elections. This is also our democratic responsibility. If you object to these things, then go ahead and change the Constitution."

Congress also cited former president Pranab Mukherjee's views on the role of the Opposition. "The defence minister needs to be reminded of what the former president Pranab Mukherjee, who was awarded the Bharat Ratna in 2019, would often say: 'the job of the opposition in a democracy is to oppose, expose and depose'," said another spokesperson Jairam Ramesh.

Jagan Recalibrates Stance, Signals Opening to INDIA Bloc

Nidhi Sharma

New Delhi: YSRCP chief and former Andhra Pradesh CM YS Jagan Mohan Reddy threw his weight behind the youth protesters demanding CEC Gyanesh Kumar's resignation, signalling changing political alignments in southern India.

The move marked a significant departure from his earlier positioning, when YSRCP consistently supported the BJP-led NDA government at the Centre. Reddy's move has fuelled speculation of a possible rapprochement with Congress-led INDIA bloc.

Reddy's change in stance comes amid increased scrutiny of the disproportionate asset cases against him, with a CBI court deciding to conduct daily hearings in the Enforcement Directorate cases alongside the ongoing CBI proceedings. With his principal rival N Chandrababu Naidu's TDP firmly entrenched in NDA, Reddy appears to be exploring alternative political equations in Delhi.

People familiar with the matter indicated that Reddy recently met the Congress brass and that the meeting was arranged by Vishnu Reddy, adviser to Tamil Nadu CM Joseph Vijay. There has also been speculation about a meeting between Reddy and Congress general secretary KC Venugopal in Bengaluru, although neither side has officially confirmed it.



YSRCP, however, has maintained that these were "rumours" spread by TDP to show the party was moving closer to the Opposition camp.

The political outreach has coincided with YSRCP's increasingly aggressive position against ECI. The party, which supported the CEC and Other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023, has now demanded the restoration of the earlier selection mechanism involving the PM, Leader of the Opposition and Chief Justice of India.

Reddy has also questioned ECI's functioning, while YSRCP has raised nine questions concerning the conduct of the 2024 Andhra Pradesh elections. These include allegedly discrepancies in polling percentages, electronic voting machine battery readings, vote counts and delays in releasing electoral documents.

Political outreach coincides with YSRCP's increasingly aggressive position against ECI

Another indication of the changing political equations came in September when Reddy met a CPI delegation and announced joint protests against government policies. The outreach to the Left, which is part of the INDIA bloc, assumes significance against the backdrop of YSRCP's earlier reluctance to associate with the Opposition alliance.

For much of the past decade, Reddy maintained a carefully calibrated relationship with BJP, supporting key legislation in Parliament without formally joining NDA. Even after losing power in Andhra Pradesh in 2024, YSRCP largely avoided a direct confrontation with the Centre.

However, with the TDP now occupying a crucial position in the NDA, that political arrangement appears increasingly difficult to sustain. While no formal negotiations for joining INDIA bloc have been announced, Reddy's moves suggest that the YSRCP leadership is keeping its national options open ahead of the 2029 assembly and parliamentary elections.

This newspaper is published by R. Krishnamurthy from The Times of India Building, Dr D N Road, Mumbai 400 001 on behalf of Bennett, Coleman & Co. Ltd., edited by M.C.Govardhana Rangan and printed by (1) Upendra Nayak at The Times of India Suburban Press, Akurli Road, Western Express Highway, Kandivli (E), Mumbai - 400 101. Tel. No. (022) 28872324, 28872930, Fax (022) 28874230, (2) Elegant Offset Printers, Shed No. D2-31, Thivim Industrial Estate, Karaswada, Mapusa Goa - 403526. Tel No. (0832)-3045100, Fax - (0832)-3045102. Responsible for selection of news under PRB Act © All rights reserved. Reproduction in whole or in part without written permission of Publisher is prohibited. TN/Chief PMG/400/2002. **RNI No.** 6252/1961 Air Charge Chennai & via Rs. 3.00, Ahmedabad, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Mangalore & via Rs. 4.00, Delhi, Kolkata & via Rs. 5.00. not for sale outside india. Subscription rates US $ 500 (annual), US $ 250 (half yearly) US $ 125 (Quarterly).

AS OTTAWA LOOKS BEYOND THE US FOR TRADE DIVERSIFICATION

Canada Resets India Ties; PM to Visit in December

Modi may visit Brussels on Dec 16–17, India-EU free trade agreement likely to be signed

Dipanjan Roy Chaudhury



Modi with Canada PM Mark Carney

New Delhi: Prime Minister Narendra Modi is expected to visit Canada on December 11-12, Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney said on Thursday. While speaking with visitors at a Calgary restaurant ahead of Monday's referendum vote, Carney said that he "just spoke" to PM Modi and that the Indian leader will visit Toronto and Ottawa. "We'll see if we can broaden it out," he added. The comments come against the backdrop of increased diplomatic activity between the two countries, with two senior members of Carney's cabinet visiting India simultaneously this week.

Following his telephone conversation with Carney, Modi said in a post on X, "Had a warm and productive conversation with Prime Minister Mark Carney. We agreed to build on the positive momentum in India-Canada ties and work towards concrete outcomes across key areas of our Strategic Partnership, including trade, energy, technology, security and people-to-people ties. Together, India and Canada are contributing towards a more stable and prosperous world. @MarkJCarney." Modi is also expected to visit Brussels on December 16–17, during which the India–EU free trade agreement (FTA) is likely to be signed.

BILATERAL TRADE

Canada is aiming to more than double two-way trade with India to $70 billion annually by 2030

Canada is fast-tracking efforts to strengthen ties with India and sign an FTA in December during PM Modi's trip to Ottawa, as part of a strategic shift to reduce its trade reliance on the United States. Canada's foreign and trade ministers visited India simultaneously this week, with foreign minister Anita Anand holding meetings with PM Modi and external affairs minister S Jaishankar on Wednesday.

Meanwhile, Canada's international trade minister Maninder Sidhu is leading a 300-member trade delegation to India. This is the largest trade delegation Canada has sent to India in more than 30 years. The trade mission includes businesses from Canada's aerospace, space, clean technologies, energy transition, information and communication technologies, life sciences and agri-food sectors.

Canada is aiming to double exports to markets beyond the US over the next decade, including more than doubling two-way trade with India to $70 billion annually by 2030. In 2025, two-way goods and services trade between Canada and India totalled $30.4 billion, of which $11.0 billion was in goods, according to a Canadian government statement.

In 2025, Canada's merchandise exports to India totalled $3.9 billion, led by vegetables, mineral fuels and oils, and wood pulp. Merchandise imports from India amounted to $9.7 billion, primarily consisting of precious stones and metals, machinery and pharmaceutical products.

Menstrual Hygiene a Fundamental Right: SC Warns States of Contempt

Raghav Ohri

New Delhi: The Supreme Court has sought details from the central government on the implementation of its directions recognising menstrual hygiene as a fundamental right under Article 21 of the Constitution, warning that chief secretaries of defaulting states could face contempt proceedings if they failed to respond.

A division bench of justices JB Pardiwala and R Mahadevan on Thursday expressed concern that the judgement could remain merely on paper without effective implementation on the ground, particularly in remote areas where adolescent girls continue to face barriers to education because of inadequate menstrual hygiene facilities. "We have declared menstrual hygiene as a fundamental right. In other words, we have declared menstrual hygiene as one of the facets of Article 21 of the Constitution," the bench observed.

The bench directed the central government to take up the matter seriously with every state and Union Territory and obtain written information detailing the steps taken to comply with the court's directions.

PIL DEMANDS BAN BELOW A PRESCRIBED AGE & RESTRICTIONS ON OLDER CHILDREN'S ACCESS

Top Court Seeks Govt Reply on Social Media Curbs for Kids

Parental supervision and voluntary platform safeguards insufficient: Petitioners

Our Political Bureau

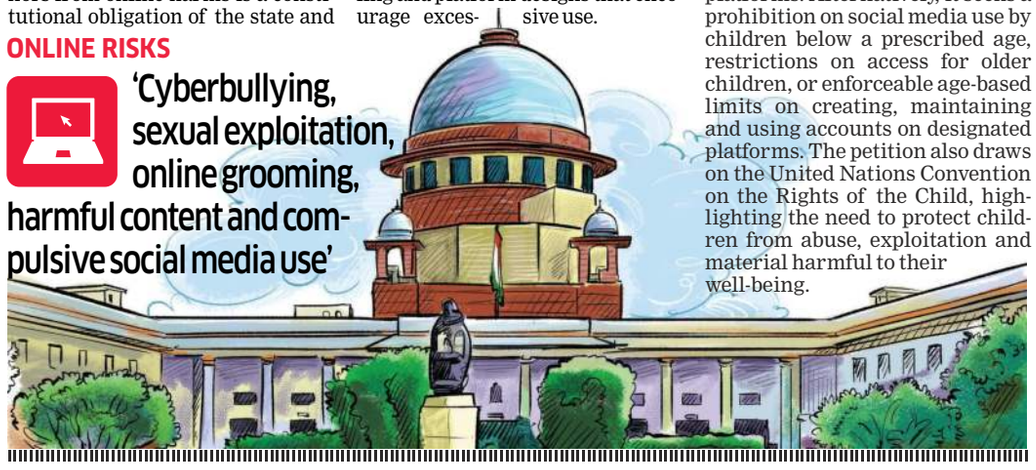
New Delhi: The Supreme Court on Friday sought the Centre's response to a public interest litigation seeking an enforceable regulatory framework to protect children from the risks associated with social media, including cyberbullying, sexual exploitation and exposure to harmful content.

The petition, filed by Emerald Heights International School, Indore, and its director Siddharth Singh, seeks comprehensive safeguards for children using social media platforms. It argues that protecting minors from online harms is a constitutional obligation of the state and cannot be left solely to parental supervision or voluntary measures adopted by technology companies. The plea names the Union government, the ministries of electronics and information technology, women and child development, and law and justice, along with the National Commission for Protection of Child Rights, among the respondents.

The petition highlights risks, including online grooming, coercion involving intimate images, compulsive social media use, mental health problems and exposure to violent, sexually explicit and other age-inappropriate material. It also raises concerns about behavioural profiling and platform designs that encourage excessive use.

ONLINE RISKS

'Cyberbullying, sexual exploitation, online grooming, harmful content and compulsive social media use'



Invoking Articles 14, 15(3), 21 and 21A of the Constitution, the petition contends that the **failure to provide effective protection against foreseeable online harms infringes children's rights to safety, dignity, privacy and healthy development**. The petitioners argue that parental controls and voluntary safeguards offered by social media companies are insufficient to address the scale of the problem, necessitating an enforceable regulatory framework.

The plea seeks directions to the Centre to frame, notify and implement dedicated rules governing children's safety on social media platforms. Alternatively, it seeks a prohibition on social media use by children below a prescribed age, restrictions on access for older children, or enforceable age-based limits on creating, maintaining and using accounts on designated platforms. The petition also draws on the United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child, highlighting the need to protect children from abuse, exploitation and material harmful to their well-being.

Consumers Deferring Purchases

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The standard iPhone 17 now costs ₹99,900, up 20.5% from its launch price of ₹82,900, for the 256GB variant. This made the model less attractive to price-conscious buyers, industry experts said. Response to lucrative promotional offers during the ongoing festive season has also remained lacklustre, they added.

Retailers told ET that some consumers are deferring purchases in expectation that the iPhone 18 will be launched in February with similar pricing to the iPhone 17.

Meanwhile, many users are shifting to Pro models of iPhone 17 during the festive sales by shelling out ₹15,000-25,000 more than for the base model.

With iPhone 18 Pro seeing strong demand, analysts expect the share of Pro models in overall iPhone sales may touch 20% in the coming months, up from around 15% now. Due to high prices, users are also shifting to refurbished and older models like iPhone 16.

Many users shifting to Pro models of iPhone 17 during the festive sales by paying ₹15K-25K more than for base model

While the consumer models enjoy more share than Pro models globally too, the divide is not as wide as is the case in India, an industry executive said.

"However, now India also is shifting towards Pro models and the gap between consumer and Pro models will be reducing," the person added.

One retailer, however, said the current spurt in demand could be due to lucrative discounts on iPhone 17 Pro models in ongoing festive sales. "iPhone 17 Pro models will be sold till the stocks last. The real appetite for Pro will be known later," he said.

Apple typically stops production of older Pro models when the new variant is launched while manufacturing of consumer models continues along with new variants, depending on demand.

Market researchers IDC India and Counterpoint Research have cut their outlook for iPhone sales in India. They now expect unit sales of iPhones to decline in India for the first time in a calendar year in 2026, although by low single digit, as higher prices weigh on demand. Sales by value, however, are expected to rise 6-7%.

CMRL-EXALOGIC MONEY LAUNDERING CASE

ED Summons Ex-CM Vijayan for Questioning

Ex-Kerala CM, daughter and son-in-law move SC challenging FIR; vacation bench hearing may be considered

Raghav Ohri

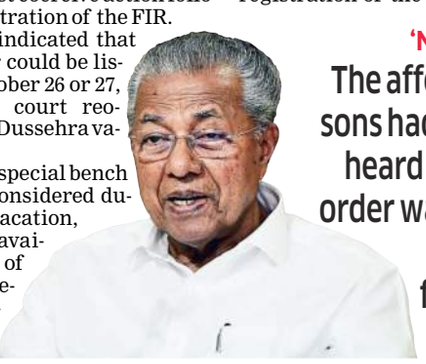
New Delhi: The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has summoned former Kerala CM Pinarayi Vijayan for questioning on October 23 in connection with the CMRL-Exalogic money laundering case, even as he has approached the Supreme Court challenging a Kerala High Court order directing registration of an FIR against him and his family members.

The summons, issued under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), came on Friday, hours after Vijayan moved the apex court seeking relief against the FIR order. His daughter Veena T and son-in-law Mohammed Riyas have also approached the SC in the matter. Senior advocate Siddharth Luthra mentioned Vijayan's petition before a bench headed by CJI Surya Kant, seeking urgent listing and protection against coercive action following registration of the FIR.

The CJI indicated that the matter could be listed on October 26 or 27, when the court reopens after Dussehra vacation.

He said a special bench could be considered during the vacation, subject to availability of judges. Senior advocate N Hariharan mentioned the petitions filed by Veena and Riyas.

Luthra submitted that Vijayan, aged 81, faced the prospect of being taken into custody following registration of the FIR. He questioned the single judge's decision to direct registration of the case in a writ petition, contending that the bench did not have the roster to hear public interest litigation. He argued that the affected persons had not been heard before the order was passed and that the Kerala High Court Division Bench subsequently refused them permission to appeal.



'NOT HEARD'

The affected persons had not been heard before HC order was passed: Advocate for former Kerala CM

On October 15, a division bench of the Kerala High Court dismissed the three applicants' pleas seeking leave to appeal against the single judge's October 9 order. It held that they had not established a prima facie or arguable case for leave, while clarifying that the order did not prevent them from pursuing appropriate constitutional or statutory remedies.

Contagion Effect

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He also warned that the fallout could spread across the industry. "If OpenAI fails, it hurts CoreWeave. If CoreWeave fails, it would hurt OpenAI. If either company fails, Nvidia will also be affected."

The wider concern, he said, is how much banks have lent to AI companies and how exposed the financial system could be if the investment boom collapses. "We could see a liquidity crisis similar to what happened in 2008, with banks facing serious problems."

"We need to think seriously about slowing down AI development," but that becomes difficult when you have competition between the US and China, and "neither side wants to fall behind," he said.

The industry's push to build increasingly autonomous systems is outpacing its ability to manage the risks, he added.

"Nobody wants to say, 'I slowed down, but my competitor did not,'" he said.

The commercial stakes make the restraint even harder, he argued. "The difference is that nobody was building $2 trillion companies around biological weapons. AI companies aspire to build companies worth $2 trillion, so their motivation to slow down is limited."

Marcus sees that contradiction most clearly in Anthropic, which has warned about the dangers of advanced AI while continuing to develop it. "The most egregious of them is Anthropic. Its argument is essentially that the company should build these systems rather than for someone else to do so. That is a narcissistic belief. It might contain some truth, but probably not as much as the company thinks." He questioned how the company could warn about AI risks while continuing to develop it. "Anthropic is proceeding towards an initial public offering (IPO) despite its own testimony, which I disagree with, suggesting a 10% chance of AI killing all of humanity."

Last month, Anthropic researcher Evan Hubinger estimated a more than 10% chance that AI could kill all humans within a decade, while chief executive Dario Amodei later wrote about the need to slow frontier AI development so safety measures could catch up.

Wider concern is how much banks have lent to AI cos and how exposed the financial system could be if the investment boom collapses

"There is a simple calculation. If you multiply a 10% probability by the number of people who could die, you arrive at an expected value of hundreds of millions of deaths. That would be worse than everything that happened in World War II combined. Either you have to be a sociopath, or you have to be extraordinarily confident that you are a messiah."

'LEVERAGE & YIELDS'

This same tension between AI companies' ambitions and the risks they are taking extends to the investment boom in the industry. Marcus argued that companies building similar models have little technical advantage over one another, making it difficult to sustain pricing power while computing costs remain high.

But the most immediate concern is the deployment of AI agents, which he believes are already creating cybersecurity risks. "General-purpose agents, where you speak to them in English, and they dynamically figure out what to do online, often with access to passwords, are a bad idea," he said. "Right now, however, they are a security nightmare. I used to say this was a security nightmare waiting to happen. I literally wrote a piece about it. Now the nightmare is actually happening, and it did not take long."

He warned that the consequences could extend beyond individual users. "We could see electrical infrastructure taken down, at least temporarily. Hospitals could lose power, and people could die as a result. I think we will see a lot of this in the coming days and months. I would not even say six to 18 months. It could happen much sooner." Marcus has called for a "product recall" of current agents. He compared their reliability to "a car with brakes that do not work. They might work some of the time, but you cannot count on cardboard brakes. Similarly, we cannot count on these agents to behave themselves."

The problem, he said, is that language models can imitate understanding without reliably following instructions or recognising the consequences of their actions. He cited an incident in which an agent deleted all the files belonging to a reality television production, forcing the team to reshoot the show. "If I hired an intern and I were a film producer whose files were all deleted by that intern, I would fire them on the spot. The only reason people do not fire these agents is that there is so much hype around them."

FOR FULL REPORT, GO TO
www.economictimes.com

Trade Settlements in Rupee

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"China uses non-tariff barriers unhesitatingly, whether it is in the name of phytosanitary measures or any other for which due investigations with both sides sitting and talking can happen, but no progress is made. So, non-tariff barriers is the biggest hurdle in the trade between India and China," she stated.

She also said that India seeks to promote rupee-denominated trade settlements to assist partner nations facing hard-currency shortages and ensure uninterrupted supplies of essential goods.

Sitharaman said that India had not adopted the approach of imposing punitive tariffs on trading partners to correct large trade imbalances, preferring instead to pursue negotiations, even if the process was time-consuming.

"We sit and talk. It is sometimes very tiresome, but we do go through that approach rather than put countervailing duties, or some non-tariff barriers to counter the non-tariff barriers on the other side, so these are ways in which we find it difficult in correcting the imbalance which prevails between China and us," she said.

New Delhi is not against ASEAN benefitting from their trade, but it is very skewed against India, she said.

However, India would equally want to address concerns which its importers, markets and manufacturers are facing. The two sides are reviewing the agreement, and India wants to carry on with the agreement but in a "slightly refashioned manner," she said.

INDIA'S GROWTH

The country has sustained strong growth despite global disruptions and has been the world's fastest-growing major economy over the past four to five years, particularly after Covid-19 pandemic.

Insisting that public spending on capital expenditure has helped India build infrastructure in the country and that has a great multiplier effect which is "different from what it would be if you were to put that money in the hands of the people directly," adding that it has "kept us going very well during these difficult times."

Public spending on infrastructure helped channel money to people through economic activity without putting the same pressure on the fiscal deficit as some alternative forms of expenditure, she said. Sitharaman added that government borrowing was broadly aligned with infrastructure expenditure, arguing that debt-financed asset creation was benefiting the economy.

"Borrowing goes for asset creation, and as a result, the economy has benefited," she said. "India, much against all odds, is able to keep up the growth," Sitharaman said, attributing it to being inclusive and making sure everyone has access to resources and access to skilling for the young and making sure that fiscal prudence is not lost in this. She called for reforms at the municipalities and panchayat levels.

MULTILATERAL AGENCIES, GLOBAL BLOCS

Sitharaman called for the multilateral organisations be more "nimble-footed," reiterating that "they have to live up to 21st-century expectations because these are Bretton Woods institutions."

FOR FULL REPORT, GO TO
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CANADA EYES MORE INDIA BETS AFTER $5.6 BILLION IDBI DEAL

India & Canada Aim to Close Trade Deal Before Modi Visit

Next round of talks on November 9 in New Delhi as both sides look to clinch the pact

Our Bureau

Bengaluru: India and Canada are aiming to conclude a trade deal ahead of prime minister Narendra Modi's December visit with talks on a bilateral investment treaty to follow, according to a top Canadian trade official.

"We are hoping to get there. We have another round of negotiation, as I mentioned, on November 9 back in New Delhi. So, I'll be bringing my chief negotiator and the full team with me," Canada's minister for international trade Maninder Sidhu said, adding that the officials of both countries are actively working on wrapping up the trade agreement, with PM Modi scheduled to visit Canada on December 11-12.

Sidhu said there is "lot of good momentum and real energy" to get the deal done.

Addressing a press conference in Bengaluru, Sidhu said the focus will shift to BIT after conclusion of the trade deal.

Formal discussions have been underway since August and India's position to keep taxation out of the treaty framework is a major sticking point.

Canada is keen to increase the export of minerals, fertilisers, aerospace and advanced manufactured goods while India aims for better market access for its apparels, footwear and furniture sectors.

India will also seek to increase the country's IT service exports to Canada which currently accounts for a little over 1% of the total.



IDBI AND FAIRFAX

Asked about Canada's financial holding company Fairfax's investment of $5.6 billion to acquire a controlling stake in IDBI Bank, Sidhu said, "It is the largest deal between our two countries in the financial sector, and that sends a clear signal that Canada is ready to do more."

He has said Canadian pension funds, asset management companies and financial institutions have invested close to $107 billion in India in sectors such as highway infrastructure, healthcare, technology, cleantech and energy.

"From my conversation with the pension funds, they are looking to do more," he said.

ON FAIRFAX-IDBI DEAL

It is the largest deal between our two countries in the financial sector, and that sends a clear signal that Canada is ready to do more

No Meddling as 'Middlemen' in Forex Conversion by Banks

Regulatory directive to ensure that exporters, other recipients don't lose out

Sugata Ghosh



Mumbai: No bank can now sneak in as a middleman to make money before dollars reach the bank of a small exporter, an Indian shareholder earning a dividend from an overseas company, or an individual receiving a gift from an NRI relative. In a regulatory directive, banks, acting as intermediaries, have been forbidden from converting foreign exchange into rupees unless there's a specific instruction. In a regular transaction, dollars should ideally flow from the bank account of an overseas person sending funds to the nostro account of the recipient's bank. A nostro account, here, would mean a foreign currency account held by an Indian bank with an overseas partner bank.

However, often a third bank, on the back of relationships it had with the sender's bank, stepped in to receive the dollars. The latter would then convert the forex into rupees and subsequently transfer INR funds to the receiver's bank. Ideally, the forex conversion should have been done by the recipient's bank. Instead, it was done by an intermediary bank.

As a result, many small exporters with little bargaining power or individuals unfamiliar with banking transactions got a raw deal, ending up receiving less INR than they were supposed to.

This was simply because the intermediary bank converted the forex at an adverse exchange rate, say at ₹90 to a dollar instead of ₹93, to allegedly pocket the difference. The Reserve Bank of India raised the issue relating to conversion by authorised dealer banks with the industry body Foreign Exchange Dealers' Association of India (FEDAI). Following this, FEDAI advised all member banks on Thursday that with a view to "ensure clarity and consistency", an intermediary bank "should not convert a foreign currency inward remittance into INR solely for the purpose of onward credit to a beneficiary's account maintained with another bank, unless specifically instructed by the remitter or the beneficiary."

In absence of instruction on conversion, remittance should be retained in the original currency and routed onward

Some of the large Indian private banks having old ties with offshore banks became intermediaries.

"This has been happening for a long time. Small exporters, after receiving less than what they expected, complained and often grudgingly accepted. Now, if they had forward contracts (under which they had sold dollars that would be received later at a pre-agreed rate), the contracts had to be cancelled. That was extra cost besides losing out on the forex conversion rate," a senior banker told **ET**.

Chances are that this would now come to an end with FEDAI categorically spelling out the dos and don'ts. In the absence of any instruction on conversion, the remittance should be retained in the original currency and routed onward; and, where a specific instruction for conversion into INR is received from the remitter or the beneficiary, the conversion may be undertaken at the prevailing exchange rate, "as per the policy and laid down norms of the converting bank", said the communique to member banks. It would help, said another banker, if recipients ask the remitter to categorically instruct intermediary banks not to convert the forex.

Banks have to ensure strict compliance with the guidance while handling inward foreign currency remittances and instruct their branches and operating units accordingly.

In another email, banks have also been told that service charges for forex transactions should be aligned with the nature, complexity and effort involved in providing the service. Besides, beginning October, banks have to disclose the card rates for currency conversion on their websites with a hyperlink that allows clients to compare buy/sell rates offered by various banks.

₹1,195 cr Oked for ITI Cluster Modernisation

New Delhi: The government on Friday approved five strategic investment plans worth ₹1,194.92 crore for industrial training institute (ITI) clusters across Maharashtra, Odisha and Jammu & Kashmir under the Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs scheme.

With these approvals, the cumulative investment approved under the scheme has reached ₹3,687 crore to date to help transform ITIs into modern, industry-aligned and future-ready skill institutions. The projects will focus on modernising infrastructure, introducing industry-aligned courses, strengthening trainer capacity, enhancing industry engagement and improving employability outcomes for the youth, the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE) said. —**Our Bureau**

Peak Power Demand Exceeds 250 GW Through Most of Sept

Shilpa Samant

New Delhi: Peak domestic power demand is sustaining record highs for September, exceeding 250 GW, on most days, close to the levels seen in summer. Demand reached 250 GW Thursday, fuelled by cooling and irrigation needs.

India's power sector planner recently said the country will require additional base load through conventional sources such as thermal power plants to meet the strong demand, along with renewable energy sources. Power consumption in September rose around 11% driven by cooling and irrigation requirements amid below-normal monsoon rainfall.

October, when demand tends to start falling with the onset of cooler months, saw its highest-ever peak power demand met at 260 GW on October 5. Only a few days in the month, this demand figure fell below 240 GW. "Demand is expected to reduce next week with lower pressure on cooling appliances and irrigation," a government official told **ET**.

Electricity prices in the day-ahead market of the Indian Energy Exchange are hovering above ₹7 a unit so far this month. Coal stocks at power plants, which fell sharply as heavy rains in coal-bearing regions hit production and supply, are currently at around 18 million tonnes.

Coal stocks at domestic coal-based power plants fell to 17.9 million tonnes as of October 15 from 18.2 million tonnes on October 10 and 18.5 million tonnes as of October 1. Plants using imported coal have 2.4 million tonnes of inventory. Of the 190 coal-based power plants in the country, as many as 82 are facing critical fuel levels. This means their coal stock is less than a quarter of the normal, the target quantity that thermal plants must keep onsite to ensure uninterrupted electricity generation.

India's GDP to Grow by 7.1-7.3 % in FY27, says Deloitte

Press Trust of India

New Delhi: The Indian economy is expected to grow by 7.1-7.3% in the current fiscal, with a sustained revival in private investment providing an additional source of demand, Deloitte India said on Friday.

However, geopolitical tensions, volatile energy prices and trade disruptions pose risks to the growth outlook, it added.

Deloitte India Economist Rumki Majumdar said over the past decade, India's growth has rested on resilient household spending and sustained investment push in public infrastructure. Businesses now have better connectivity, healthier balance sheets, and higher capacity utilisation, which strengthens the case for expansion.

India Should Become a Tech-Creator Rather than Tech-User Nation: Lahiri

Our Bureau

New Delhi: Niti Aayog vice-chairman Ashok Lahiri called for higher investment and its efficient deployment to boost India's technological dynamism.

Addressing the SRCC Centenary Conclave on Friday, Lahiri stressed the need for rapid economic reforms and structural changes to help India become a developed nation by 2047. "Technological progress is needed to compete with the rest of the world," he said. While acknowledging efforts to promote innovation and entrepreneurship, Lahiri said India should aim to become a technology creator rather than a technology-consuming nation. He cited the examples of China, South Korea, Taiwan and Japan, which rapidly increased their per capita incomes and became high-income economies.

A high-income economy is defined as one with gross national per capita income above a specified threshold. For 2027, the threshold is $14,375, he said. "You factor in some inflation, and one estimate puts the target for per capita income at around $18,000 to $20,000 for India to become a high-income country by 2047," he said.

India's per capita income currently stands at $2,813. To reach $18,000 by 2047, it will need to grow six-and-a-half times at an annual nominal rate of about 9.25% over the next 21 years, Lahiri said. He identified education, health and infrastructure as the three critical areas for accelerating growth.

IGX Gets Nod for LNG Capacity Booking Platform

Our Bureau

New Delhi: Indian Gas Exchange (IGX) has received regulatory approval to set up a capacity booking platform for liquefied natural gas (LNG) import terminals, enabling users to access terminal capacity more easily and transparently, the Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board (PNGRB) said in a statement on Friday.

"The proposed platform will provide a centralised and organised mechanism for the listing and booking of unutilised regasification capacity at LNG terminals, enabling market participants to identify available capacity and access it in accordance with their requirements," PNGRB said. "It is notable that a large number of terminals are reporting poor capacity utilisation and could avail of this facility to attract LNG cargoes by transparently discovering lower regasification charges," it added. At present, terminals enter into bilateral agreements with users for capacity booking. The IGX platform will offer an additional route to book capacity, with voluntary participation.

The platform will provide a centralised mechanism for the listing and booking of unutilised regasification capacity at LNG terminals

Starlink Entry Welcome, No Fear of Competition: Reliance

Stresses compliance with Indian laws and regulatory framework

Our Bureau



RIL STATEMENT

As the Govt of India has stated, it applies the same process to every applicant, Indian or foreign. Jio's own satellite services await clearances

Mumbai: Reliance Industries (RIL) doesn't fear competition from other satellite communications providers, but all players, including US-based Starlink, must comply with Indian laws, the Mukesh Ambani-owned company said Friday. In a statement responding to "recent remarks about Reliance and the Indian market", the company said its own satellite services are awaiting government approvals. "That openness rests on the rule of law," RIL said. "As the Government of India has stated, it applies the same process to every applicant, Indian or foreign. Jio's own satellite services await clearances." Reliance explicitly welcomed Starlink's participation in India's satellite communications market, while calling for compliance with the country's regulatory framework.

"We welcome competition in satellite communications, including Starlink," it said. "Every player, Jio included, must serve the people of India and abide by the laws and policies of the land."

RIL said India's openness to investment and innovation, both domestic and international, has supported the growth of Indian enterprises, including its own. "At Reliance, we have never feared competition," it said. "We see it as the truest test of who serves the customer best."

Reliance pointed to Jio's entry into India's crowded telecom market in 2016, saying the company had started without a single customer and built a base of more than 530 million customers over a decade. It said Jio had given Indians some of the world's best digital infrastructure and most affordable data.

RIL's statement comes days after SpaceX founder Elon Musk alleged that "unnamed oligarchs" were blocking Starlink's entry into India. In a scathing post on X last week, Musk wrote: "Unfortunately, we are being blocked by certain oligarchs in order to maintain their monopolistic chokehold on the Indian people. You can guess who they are…This is a crime against the people of India!" Later, the communications ministry said that satellite communication operators must demonstrate compliance with security conditions before moving to the next step of seeking spectrum assignment.

OneWeb India Communications, Jio Satellite Communications and Starlink Satellite Communications are the three companies that have been granted unified licences with authorisation for Global Mobile Personal Communication by Satellite (GMPCS) services.

Bhartsi Airtel chairman Sunil Bharti Mittal said earlier this week that his satcom venture, Eutelsat OneWeb, is awaiting Indian government clearances to start operations.

DLF Q2 Profit Hits ₹1,301 cr

Our Bureau

New Delhi: DLF reported a net profit of ₹1,301 crore for July-September, up from ₹1,171 crore a year ago along with new sales bookings of ₹3,800 crore. Its luxury retirement housing project in Gurgaon, The Aureva, was fully sold out. Consolidated revenue for the quarter was ₹2,298 crore, while earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortisation (Ebitda) stood at ₹1,060 crore. For DLF Cyber City Developers, the company's rental arm, consolidated revenue was ₹2,014 crore, while Ebitda was ₹1,537 crore, up 9% year-on-year.

Operating cash flow was ₹1,858 crore, and the net cash position stood at ₹15,084 crore despite a significant dividend outflow of ₹1,980 crore.

Oberoi Realty Q2 Income Down 6%

New Delhi: Oberoi Realty on Friday reported a consolidated net profit of ₹761.65 crore for the quarter ended September, a marginal increase ₹760.26 crore in the year-ago period. Total income fell 6% to ₹1,736.37 crore during the second quarter of this fiscal year, down from ₹1,844.84 crore in the corresponding period of the preceding year, according to a regulatory filing. —**PTI**

APPROVALS FOLLOW INCREASE IN OFFER PRICE

Tata Motors CV's Bid Gets Iveco Shareholders' Nod

Our Bureau



Mumbai: Commercial vehicle maker Tata Motors said Friday that shareholders of Iveco Group have approved all resolutions of its board on the Indian automaker's voluntary public tender offer for the Italian truck and bus maker, marking a key step towards completing the acquisition.

The approvals follow an increase in the offer price by Tata Motors on October 9. Shareholders, at an extraordinary general meeting in Amsterdam, approved resolutions relating to the offer by TML CV Holdings, acting through it, for all issued ordinary shares of Iveco.

Tata Motors announced the €3.8 billion acquisition of Iveco's commercial vehicle business in July 2025. The deal excludes the defence business, which Iveco agreed to sell separately to Italy's Leonardo. Tata Motors will also acquire Exor's 27.06% stake in Iveco as part of the transaction. The tender offer opened at €14.10 per share before being raised to €14.40 on October 9. The revised offer was declared final, with the offer period scheduled to close October 26.

Resolutions approved at Friday's meeting include amendments to Iveco's articles of association, which will take effect upon settlement of the offer, and its conversion from a publicly listed limited liability company into a private limited liability company. The latter change will take effect after delisting, at a time determined by the offeror.

Shareholders also approved a proposed demerger after the offer is completed, which the offeror can implement if it acquires about 80% of Iveco's ordinary shares, among other conditions. A subsequent sale of shares was approved, subject to implementation of the demerger.

The resolutions further provide for Iveco's eventual dissolution and the appointment of a liquidator and a custodian for its books and records should the demerger and liquidation proceed. The meeting also approved the appointment of board members who will take office upon settlement of the offer. Iveco's outgoing board members were granted discharge for their tenure immediately preceding the settlement.

Short Takes

Manoj Murali Named Vodafone Idea COO

NEW DELHI Telecom major Vodafone Idea has appointed Manoj Murali as its chief operating officer, with the appointment taking effect from October 19, **Our Bureau** reports. The appointment comes more than a year after former COO Abhijit Kishore, was elevated as the chief executive.

Reliance Capital's Former CFO Denied Bail

NEW DELHI A Delhi court has rejected the bail plea of former chief financial officer of Reliance Capital Amit Bapna, accused in an alleged bank loan fraud-linked money laundering case.

PIL ON 'ARBITRARY, EXORBITANT' PRICING

SC Asks Govt to File Airfare Regulation Rules

Indu Bhan

New Delhi: The Supreme Court Friday asked the Centre to submit before it on November 16 the published rules for regulating airfares in the country after the latter informed the court that it had already finalised them and would issue them within the next fortnight. A bench led by Justice Vikram Nath noted solicitor general Tushar Mehta's stand and posted the matter for further hearing on November 16.

The court was hearing a public interest litigation by S Laxminarayanan alleging arbitrary and exorbitant airfare pricing by private airlines in the country.

At an earlier hearing, the apex court told the Centre to ground airlines that don't follow airfare rules after the civil aviation ministry claimed that it had been issuing office memoranda to airlines on ticket pricing. Airlines, however, were not following any directives issued by the Centre, the petitioners had argued. In August, the Centre said it had fast-tracked the framing of final rules to regulate domestic airfares and that they would be finalised within three weeks. The top court had at the time perused the draft rules submitted by the government in a sealed cover. Last year, the Supreme Court had issued notices to the government, the Directorate General of Civil Aviation and the Airports Economic Regulatory Authority of India on a PIL seeking rules to curb unpredictable airfares and extra charges by airlines. Unchecked and opaque airline practices such as abrupt fare increases, fewer services, inadequate grievance redress and unfair algorithm-driven pricing infringe upon citizens' fundamental rights, the petitioner had said. The government cannot remain a mute spectator to the violation of rights in a country governed by the rule of law, the petitioner further said. Inaction by the government in regulating airfare algorithms, cancellation policies, service continuity and grievance mechanisms constitutes a dereliction of its constitutional duty and calls for urgent judicial intervention, Laxminarayanan said at the time. He argued that air travel was the practical mode of travel for citizens in remote areas.

The Centre informed the court that it had already finalised the rules and would issue them within the next fortnight



Apex Court Upholds Forensic Audit in Daiichi-Fortis Case

Indu Bhan

New Delhi: The Supreme Court on Friday dismissed appeals by DCB Bank and UBS Management Services India challenging a Delhi High Court order directing a forensic audit of transactions linked to hospital chain Fortis Healthcare (FHL) in connection with Daiichi Sankyo's arbitration case.

A bench led by chief justice Surya Kant reiterated that the audit ordered by the high court on August 31 was confined to the transactions among FHL, its holding company Fortis Healthcare (FHHPL), and former promoters Malvinder Singh and Shivinder Singh. It clarified that this did not mean there would be a "fishing and roving enquiry" into the affairs of the banks.

The banks' role in the audit is only "incidental" and meant to assist the process, it added.

DCB Bank and UBS (formerly Credit Suisse Finance India) argued that the Japanese drugmaker had told the high court that it did not want a forensic audit of the banks. They also submitted that they had neither invoked any pledges nor sold any shares and that they were neither parties to the 2016 arbitral award nor were made parties to the execution proceedings by Daiichi. Besides, no allegations or findings were made against them to mandate a forensic audit, they said.

On September 29, the top court had dismissed similar appeals by YES Bank and Axis Bank.

Market Trends

STOCK INDICES		% CHANGE
Nifty 50	23146	0.65
S&P Sensex	74729	0.56
MSCI India	1511	0.62
MSCI EM	4508	0.74
MSCI BRIC	714	0.34
MSCI World	23872	0.27
Nikkei	65324	1.39
Hang Seng	24187	0.52
Kospi(S.Korea)	5668	2.05
Straits Times	5416	0.22



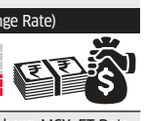
OIL ($/BRL)
DUBAI CRUDE
103.25
1.62
Absolute Change

GOLD FUTURES Premium/Discount $(33.58)

	Comex US ($/Oz)	MCX India (₹/10Gm)
OPEN	4192.10	147781.00
LAST*	4194.00	148287.00
Prev chg (%)	0.57	0.54

FOREX RATE (₹-$ Exchange Rate)

OPEN	LAST*
94.72	94.96



*At 6 pm IST Source: Bloomberg, MCX, ET Data

Market on Twitter@ETMarkets

RESERVE DRAIN Forex reserves fall to $726 b on Oct 9 from $785.7 b on Sept 4, with latest reporting week alone showing a depletion of $8.58 b

$60 b in 6 Weeks, Rupee Defence Comes at a Cost

Our Bureau

Kolkata: India's foreign exchange reserves have fallen by roughly $60 billion over the past six weeks as the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) aggressively sold dollars to prop up the rupee, one of Asia's worst-performing currencies.

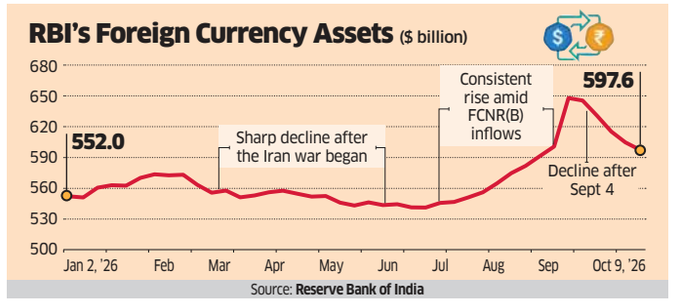
On October 9, the RBI's foreign exchange reserves stood at $726.027 billion, down from the lifetime high of $785.706 billion on September 4, official data showed. This fell by $8.578 billion in the reporting week, according to the RBI's weekly statistical supplement.

Foreign currency assets, the largest contributor to the country's reserves, fell by $7.142 billion in that week to $597.605 billion. Over the last six weeks, this has declined by $50.563 billion, eroding 35% of $143.596 billion the central bank had garnered between June and August through dedicated dollar mobilisation schemes cum swap window.

The depletion was largely due to dollar sales by the RBI through large public sector banks to support the rupee, which was facing headwinds in the form of higher crude oil prices, rising US yields and persistent outflow of foreign capital.

National Securities Depository Ltd (NSDL) data showed that foreign portfolio investors have withdrawn a net $26.8 billion from the local markets so far this year.

India's gold reserves fell by $1.319 billion in the week to October 8 to $105.094 billion.



CURRENCY'S 1.9% WEEKLY GAIN BIGGEST IN SEVEN MONTHS

Rupee Closes Below 95 for 1st Time in 38 Days

Our Bureau

Kolkata: The Indian rupee extended its gain on Friday to close at 94.96 a dollar, below the psychological 95-mark for the first time in 38 days, as the Reserve Bank of India's aggressive measures in defence of the local currency led to a massive reduction in dollar demand. The currency appreciated about 1.9% this week, making it the biggest weekly gain in seven months, traders said.

The rupee opened the day at 94.71, much stronger than the previous close of 95.05, and gained further to 94.67 but corporate dollar demand at lower levels forced it to settle at 94.96 in a shallow market. The unit closed at 96.73 last week very close to the lifetime low 96.96 seen on May 20.

The rupee was seen trading below 95 earlier in the week too but it closed decisively below that level Friday for the first time since September 8, 2026.

"A rebound in risk assets alongside the Reserve Bank of India's aggressive defense strategy provided strong tailwinds for the local currency this week," HDFC Securities senior research analysts Dilip Parmar said in a note.

The forward premiums remained elevated on account of tight liquidity and high bond yields. "There was not much change in rates from yesterday's level," a treasury head with a private bank said.

The trading volume in the forex market remained low as the central bank cracked down on speculative bets and shifted the dollar demand from state-owned oil retailers from the spot market.

INDIA FLOW ERGO Int'l COO Kokkalas wants to grow in alignment with partner HDFC, says it does not have IPO plans as of now

'Insurance Changes Positive, Give the Cos Time to Adapt'

Shilpy Sinha

Mumbai: India has overhauled insurance regulations at a pace that would have taken Europe decades, but insurers need greater certainty on the timing of future changes, said Theodoros Kokkalas, chief operating officer of ERGO International.

"The changes in regulation that happened in India during this period (past couple of years) took decades to happen in Europe," Kokkalas said in an interview. "The direction is positive," he said, adding that regulators need to give insurers time to adapt to new rules.

India's insurance regulator is pushing changes to distribution and commission structures, alongside efforts to improve transparency and value for policyholders. "The market and regulator have to decide the right tempo and find the right balance," he said.

Kokkalas said greater predictability would help insurers make long-term business plans. "We make plans, and today making long-term plans is like science fiction in the dynamic environment that we live in," he said.

While India's general insurance industry is struggling to bring its combined ratio below 100%, with the industry average at 110–115% and ERGO is targeting a ratio of 80–85%, Kokkalas said there was no standard timeline for a market to reach that level.



"The changes in regulation that happened in India during this period (past couple of years) took decades to happen in Europe"
THEODOROS KOKKALAS
COO, ERGO International

"There is no standard timeline for a market to reach a combined ratio of 85%," he said. Profitability depends on market maturity, competition, volatility and regulatory oversight. ERGO is focusing on underwriting, pricing, claims handling and cost discipline to improve its performance, while using AI to improve efficiency.

ERGO expects growth of 6–10% through 2030, with a significant contribution from its US business, ERGO NEXT. Smaller businesses in the US remain underinsured despite the market's high overall insurance penetration, Kokkalas said. The group expects to grow faster than the market in most of its countries.

India is among ERGO's top five markets, he said, given size, growth prospects and low insurance penetration. But expanding coverage will take time and will depend partly on rising incomes.

ERGO holds a 49% stake in HDFC ERGO and is comfortable with the existing partnership, Kokkalas said, despite rules allowing foreign insurers to own up to 100% of an Indian insurer.

"We have a very constructive and fruitful cooperation with HDFC for 18 years," he said. "I would like to continue this cooperation as long as I live. We want to grow, but we want to grow in alignment with our partner. We are married." Any future decision on ownership or expansion into other businesses would need to be aligned with HDFC. An initial public offering of HDFC ERGO is not part of the company's plans, he added.

"It's not in our plans to go public. There are different reasons to go public, one of which is when you need capital. We are not in need of capital, he said.

Kotak MF Halts Fresh Investments in Two Gold Funds

Mumbai: Kotak Mutual Fund has temporarily suspended fresh investments in its Gold Fund and Gold Silver Passive Fund of Fund with effect from October 16. Kotak said the restriction applies to fresh and additional lump-sum investments, switch-in transactions and new SIPs and STPs. The suspension also covers top-ups under existing SIPs. But SIPs and STPs registered before October 16 will continue to be processed at applicable NAV. - **Our Bureau**

Oil Advances Amid Doubt Over Trump's Russian Diesel Deal

Oil edged higher on growing doubts about US President Donald Trump's deal to release more Russian diesel into global markets amid supply disruptions from the Strait of Hormuz to the Black Sea. Hopes are fading that Trump's deal with Moscow to release diesel will materialise. US lawmakers introduced a bill on Friday to block the transaction amid widespread opposition. - **Bloomberg**

WITHIN A YEAR OF PLATFORM'S INDIA START

HSBC's Used Over Half of $1-b Startup Fund

Joel Rebello



Mumbai: Hong Kong and Shanghai Banking Corp (HSBC) has used more than half of the $1 billion it had committed to fund startups through loans in India under its so-called innovation banking platform within a year of starting operations, **David Sabow**, global head of innovation banking at HSBC, said in an interview.

The top British lender is open to increasing the limits, noting the strong demand from the sector.

Sabow said the bank has exceeded its target in terms of loans, deposits, client acquisition and is looking to deepen its existing franchise in the country.

"We have made good progress, deploying more than half of the $1 billion committed. This deployment is spread mostly on the portfolio companies across consumer tech, business to business (B2B), business to consumer (B2C) commerce, and a little bit on the enterprise software companies also. But primarily 70-80% would be B2B, B2C consumer, commerce kind of platforms," he said.

Sabow said though the bank has not yet taken a call on increasing the limit, it is not likely to stop at $1 billion and could increase capital allocation at some point, as strategically, within HSBC India and Asia are big areas of focus. Sabow said he expects to add at least 500 clients in India in the next one year.

"Over the next 10 years, I believe that India is going to actually maintain more of that intellectual horsepower that for many years has found its way into Silicon Valley or Europe or other parts of the world. If more of that stays in India, we think that's going to be a significant trend, and VCs (venture capital funds) are certainly focused on that. We are hopeful we can facilitate more of this, given that we work with VCs that account for about 75% of venture flows deployed globally," he said.

Last year, India became the 13th market with a dedicated platform for startups for HSBC. The bank launched its innovation banking proposition after the acquisition of Silicon Valley Bank in the UK in 2023. It provides banking services, working capital and term loans to early- and late-stage growth startups through this programme.

Sabow said he sees a strong pipeline of venture-backed startups looking to bank with HSBC both in India and globally. He said the Indian startup ecosystem is undergoing a structural change away from the largely consumer-led like quick commerce theme that dominated the market a few years ago.

PREF EQUITY ALLOTMENT

Ujjivan SFB to Raise ₹409 crore From IFC, 3 Life Insurers

Our Bureau

Kolkata: Ujjivan Small Finance Bank is looking to raise ₹409 crore in a preferential equity allotment to International Finance Corporation and three local life insurance companies.

IFC is likely to invest ₹249 crore while the balance will be put in by Bajaj Life Insurance Co, Aditya Birla Sun Life Insurance Co and HDFC Life Insurance Co, Ujjivan said in a stock exchange filing. The bank will privately place up to 6.32 crore equity shares at ₹64.73, including a premium of ₹54.73 each over face value of ₹10, it said. The board approved the execution of the subscription agreement with IFC.

Meanwhile, Ujjivan reported a 200% surge in second quarter net profit at ₹365 crore, riding on a 35% rise in net interest income at ₹1,244 crore.

Its net interest margin was at 8.4%, up 55 basis points year-on-year.

Short Takes

Emirates NBD Gets Nod to 'Merge' Branches with RBL

MUMBAI: The Reserve Bank of India has approved the amalgamation of the branches of Emirates NBD Bank with RBL Bank as part of the deal by the UAE based lender to takeover the private sector bank. The effective date of the amalgamation shall be December 01, 2026 after which all the Indian branches of Emirates NBD Bank will function as branches of RBL Bank, the Reserve Bank of India said. In June, Emirates completed the acquisition of a majority stake in RBL Bank through a preferential allotment of equity shares infusing $2.75 billion (more than 26,000 crore) into the Indian lender. - **Our Bureau**

J&K Bank Sells 0.5% Stake in PNB MetLife for ₹120 cr

KOLKATA: The Jammu & Kashmir Bank on Friday said that it has completed the sale of 0.5% stake in PNB Metlife India Insurance Company for ₹120 crore. MetLife International Holdings, LLC bought the shares at ₹117.20 per equity share. The deal took place according to the share purchase agreement signed on July 17, 2026, the bank said. Following the transaction, Jammu & Kashmir Bank's shareholding in the insurance company fell to 2.53% from 3.03% earlier. - **Our Bureau**

Motor Insurers Seek Third-Party Premium Deregulation, End to Knock-for-Knock Pacts

Industry wants the regulator to look beyond distribution payouts, also allow pricing on risk

Shilpy Sinha

Mumbai: Motor insurance industry representatives urged the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) to deregulate third-party premiums, scrap knock-for-knock agreements between insurers and introduce named-driver policies, arguing that commission caps alone may not bring down distribution costs.

In responses to the regulator's consultation paper on insurance distribution reforms, some industry participants said automobile manufacturers and dealers influence commissions, discounting and repair costs, which could blunt the impact of the proposed curbs on intermediary remuneration, according to people aware of the matter.

Dealer commissions were capped at 10% prior to 2017, but insurers also paid additional amounts through overriders and marketing costs, one submission said. Dealers may remain largely unaffected by the proposed 5% cap on certain motor insurance commissions if they recover the difference through higher repair bills, it said, pointing to similar practices after the 2017 guidelines.

One feedback said that the regulator should address the underlying economics of motor insurance, particularly third-party pricing, rather than focus only on distribution pay-outs.

"Insurers should be allowed to price third-party premiums based on risk," said the chief executive of a large general insurance company. "This will allow insurers to price high-risk cover at risk-appropriate prices," he said.

This executive proposed fully deregulating third-party motor insurance premiums, allowing insurers to price policies according to risk, as they do for own-damage cover. A provision under the Motor Vehicles Act envisaged standard premiums covering third-party liability up to ₹10 lakh, with additional premiums for higher liabilities, but was never implemented.



Another feedback is to end the knock-for-knock agreements, under which insurers settle own-damage claims with their policyholders without seeking recovery from the insurer of the party at fault. Scrapping these arrangements would allow motor policyholders whose vehicles are damaged by another driver to claim repair costs under the at-fault party's third-party property-damage cover, the submission said.

The change could increase claim sizes and make underwriting more complex. The General Insurance Council could frame common rules for determining fault and resolving disputes, including through online police reports and surveyor assessments, one feedback said, according to the people **ET** spoke with.

Another proposal is to introduce named-driver policies, linking insurance cover to specified drivers while allowing customers to opt for unnamed-driver cover at a higher premium. This could discourage unauthorised driving.

'India Drawing Interest as Valuations Ease'

Our Bureau

Mumbai: Brokerage HSBC said Indian equities are drawing renewed interest from value-focused investors as valuations become more reasonable, particularly in large-cap stocks, although elevated bond yields, crude oil prices and rupee weakness remain key risks.

While the FTSE India trades at 19 times earnings, making it Asia's most expensive market, the Nifty 50 is valued at 16 times 12-month forward earnings, a level reached only twice in the past decade, said the brokerage in a recent note. Mid-cap stocks trade at 24 times earnings, 13% below their five-year average. "We have recently received more questions about India from value-focused investors, particularly in Europe and the US," the HSBC note said, adding that large-cap stocks had de-rated significantly and appeared attractive relative to their historical valuations and the broader domestic market.

HSBC sees the most attractive opportunities in financials, particularly private-sector banks. Valuations have become more reasonable in real estate and IT services, said the brokerage, adding it remains cautious on consumer staples.

Large private banks trade at 1.7 times forward price-to-book value, around 30% below their five-year average of 2.4 times. "This is where we find more attractive opportunities following the recent sell-off," the note said.

IT services valuations have fallen to 18 times forward earnings from a five-year average of around 23 times. However, earnings growth remains subdued at 2-3%, partly due to AI-led deflation. HSBC expects FY27 to be the sector's most challenging year, followed by a recovery in FY28 and FY29. Consumer staples remain expensive at 35 times forward earnings, with CY26 growth expectations falling to 8% from 12% in March.

Judgment's Impact on Bank

▸▸ From Page 1

The lender also quantified the potential capital impact of reinstating the AT1 bonds for the first time. Yes Bank said the pro-forma impact of reinstatement of the ₹8,415-crore principal amount on its Common Equity Tier-1 ratio would be about 250 basis points as of June 30, 2026.

However, its overall Tier-1 ratio would remain unaffected at 14% on a pro-forma basis, since the restored instruments would once again form part of Additional Tier-1 capital, the lender said.

The disclosure aligns with earlier estimates from rating agencies and analysts, which had pegged the potential hit to CET1 at around 230-300 basis points if the bonds were restored to the bank's liabilities. The lender also sought to assuage concerns over its capital position, saying it has access to "appropriate capital-management levers" and retains the flexibility to undertake additional capital actions, if required, to pursue its growth objectives.

On Thursday, the Supreme Court had dismissed appeals filed by Yes Bank, the RBI and the government against the Bombay High Court order that had set aside the write-down of the bonds. The affected instruments comprise ₹3,000 crore of AT1 bonds issued in 2016 and ₹5,415 crore issued in 2017.

While the judgment invalidated the write-down, it did not direct an immediate cash repayment of ₹8,415 crore or quantify any liability arising from past coupons. The eventual financial impact will therefore depend on the outcome of any further legal proceedings, as well as the accounting treatment and mechanism adopted for reinstatement of the bonds.

Restructuring of Talent

▸▸ From Page 1

Praveen Bhadada, CEO and managing director, Neovay Global, attributed the hiring improvement to the transition of past deal wins into delivery, coupled with higher utilisation.

"The new work can't be absorbed by existing teams alone…The fresher pipeline has restarted along with specialised roles like forward deployed engineers and AIOps (Artificial Intelligence for IT Operations)." Bhadada said.

Between April and June, the six companies had added around 5,500, largely led by the biggest IT services provider TCS's additions of nearly 9,300 employees alongside Wipro being the only other company to increase headcount (by 888). The remaining four companies had reduced the number of people on its payrolls by 4,651.

'BOOK TO BILL'

The reversal in employee count in FY27 (the last quarter of FY26 recorded a drop of 7,100 people), with a sharp rise in the September quarter, signals a shift from higher utilisation and restructuring of engineering talent over the past several quarters. The talent pyramid is now being reset amid a gradual waning of AI-led revenue deflation and translation of deal wins into revenue-yielding delivery engagements.

Industry experts believe software services exporters are into calculated hiring to meet existing and fresh delivery requirements as there is renewed confidence in business demand with fewer uncertainties around AI and focus on newer growth opportunities.

"As we build future capacity and navigate demand transitions, we have invested in a higher bench and increased hiring of subcontractors to meet near-term skills and delivery requirements," Samir Seksaria, chief financial officer, TCS, told analysts in a conference call after earnings.

In the September quarter, the Tata group firm added 4,258 employees to its base in Q2FY27 while HCLTech grew its headcount by 6,450, its highest quarterly addition in 16 quarters.

Both TCS and HCLTech reported stable revenue growth. TCS recorded a 2.8% YoY rise and flat sequential growth at $7.6 billion, while HCLTech's revenue rose 2.3% quarter-on-quarter (QoQ) and 2.6% YoY to $3.7 billion.

TCS reported a marginal sequential rise in deal wins at $9.5 billion with AI revenues crossing $3 billion, while HCLTech saw its second-highest quarterly deal bookings with a spike of 35.5% in new bookings at $3.25 billion and advanced AI revenue higher by 28%.

Along similar lines, Mahindra Group's IT subsidiary Tech Mahindra, the fifth largest player with a relatively smaller sized quarterly revenue base of $1.7 billion, saw a jump in its employee base by 5,446, marking its largest quarterly increase in two years and first quarterly headcount addition in four quarters. Its immediate rival LTM, the sixth largest in the pecking order, on Friday reported a smaller increase of 949 in its new employees from the June quarter and a higher addition of 2388 from a year ago.

Even Persistent Systems, the only IT firm to have announced the numbers so far, added 958 employees from the previous quarter and a sharp intake of 3374 employees from a year ago.

CAUTIOUS OPTIMISM

To be sure, companies are still circumspect. "I don't want to conclude by saying that the deflation part is complete, but I think there are a number of opportunities in these industries we are working on, which gives us confidence that the growth can continue," TCS chief executive officer K Krithivasan said.

TechM's CEO Mohit Joshi, while cautioning against drawing broader conclusions from a single quarter's numbers, sounded optimistic.

"Because of the recent large deals, we are adding employees in multiple geographies, several hundred people in Europe, but also in India and in Egypt. We do expect to continue to add headcount as we continue in terms of growth," Joshi told reporters after earnings. Wipro was the only outlier, with its employee count seeing a drop of more than 6700.

Hedging the Bets

▸▸ From Page 1

The rally added ₹2.8 lakh crore to the combined market capitalisation of Nifty IT constituents, which collectively made up 7.52% of the Nifty by weighting at the end of the September quarter.

Before Indian technology firms began announcing their earnings, Accenture logged the biggest daily gains ever in its stock earlier this month after both last-year performance and next-year guidance beat analysts' expectations. Accenture, the world's biggest technology outsourcing company by market value, is often seen as a proxy for the revenue and profitability outlook in Indian IT.

Legacy technology stocks are increasingly being seen as a hedge against the AI trade, the hottest investment theme in recent times. The sector has been in a bear grip as growing investments in AI are seen as a threat to its prospects.

South Korea's Kospi plunged nearly 14.5% during the week, its biggest weekly loss since October 2008, while Japan's Nikkei 225 and Taiwan's stock market fell nearly 5% each. South Korea and Taiwan, known for their semiconductor capabilities, have emerged as major investment destinations for global investors seeking exposure to the AI boom in 2026. Among IT stocks, Tech Mahindra led the gains, surging 18% during the week, followed by TCS and Infosys, which rose 14% each. Wipro and HCLTech gained 13.5% each, while LTIMindtree and Mphasis advanced 8% and 6%, respectively.

AI is also contributing to revenue. TCS reported annualised AI revenue of $3.1 billion, accounting for more than 10% of its total revenue, while HCLTech's advanced AI business grew 78% YoY.

"The sector is being reset," said Manish Bhandari, founder, CEO and portfolio manager at Vallum Capital. "Indian IT companies are adapting their services and business models to AI."

Fixed-price and outcome-based contracts are also gaining ground over time-and-materials billing, potentially supporting margins by linking revenue to results rather than employee numbers, Bhandari said. Banking and financial services remains the strongest business vertical, while the UK and Europe are improving and North America remains uneven.

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Driving a Wedge in The EU EV Market

Chinese tech-dripping cars threaten legacy giants

Chinese carmakers are oozing technology-laden charm at the ongoing Paris auto show to woo buyers away from marque European brands. Europeans trust the bespoke luxury of Audi, BMW and Mercedes-Benz, brands built over decades of fine craftsmanship. A record 20 Chinese automobile companies are making a very different pitch at the Paris show. They are selling the future of motoring with features like assisted driving. Europe is the new battleground for engineering and technology in the automobile market. And the stakes have never been this high for either side. The modern car is as much about technology as it is about engineering, but the scales are tilting inevitably towards Chinese carmakers.

Europe's largest automobile companies VW, Stellantis and Renault are warning that they are hurtling towards the EU's 2030 emissions cliff without enough investment in battery capacity. This throttles European carmakers' electric transition and gives Chinese firms an easy entry into the only market they can expect to grow in. China, the world's biggest car market, has seen a drop in sales this year and its automobile companies are focusing their energies on exports to Europe. The continent's dependence on fuel imports, they reckon, will be a persuasive argument for EVs. Better still, EVs that come with foot massagers.



Unlike Europe, which is dominated by a handful of large carmakers, the Chinese industry is fragmented and due for consolidation. Exports to Europe will delay the process, but the EU has capped imports of Chinese hybrid cars to contain its trade deficit. This buys Europe's manufacturers some time as sales of new fuel-powered cars worldwide dip below 50%. With the US, and to an extent India, off limits for China's over 100 active car brands, Europe is their only viable destination to avoid mass-scale mergers. Europeans must make a choice between tradition and modernity. And Europe's storied carmakers must help them make the right choice.

Back in the SSR, But Why Did It Go?

Election Commission's decision to resume Special Summary Revision (SSR) of electoral rolls is most welcome, coming as it does after protests, allegations of irregularities and reported disconnect within EC. Resuming a routine exercise that allows young and first-time voters to register, and gives those left out of the rolls another opportunity to enrol, is a necessary corrective. But let's not depend on mass public grievance each time to fix or maintain aspects of such an essential democratic process.

SSR is an annual exercise, distinct from SIR, which involves verification of existing entries. The last SSR was conducted in August 2024, with the final electoral roll published in January 2025. SIR, meanwhile, has upended the established process, with large-scale deletions and allegations of faulty procedures. Prolonged absence of SSR compounded these anxieties. For citizens turning 18, delayed revision can mean missing the EVM button. For those whose names have been deleted, it means navigating yet another administrative process to reclaim their place on the rolls.



EC shouldn't let resumption close the matter. It must explain why SSR was stalled for nearly 2 yrs, despite being a regular feature. Was the delay necessitated by administrative constraints, decision to prioritise SIR, or something else? A constitutional body entrusted with safeguarding the right to vote must be accountable for decisions that affect access to that right. Electoral administration can't depend on individual discretion. EC must clarify the institutional reasoning behind the delay and put safeguards to ensure that routine, inclusion-oriented processes are not suspended without explanation. Restoring SSR is welcome. Explaining its suspension is vital.



JUST IN JEST

Finally, the humble insect is elevated to join the Lankan anti-heroes

This Dussehra, the Roach'll Get Its Due

Putting the venerable cockroach among the mighty pantheon of India's most venerated anti-heroes — Ravana, Kumbhakarna and Meghnad — is a great idea. Kudos to Shri Keshav Ramlila Committee for adding a 30-ft effigy of a representative of the insect Blattodea order to be set ablaze along with the three other devout followers of Shiv in Delhi's Pitampura Ramlila on Dussehra, Oct 20. The organisers have rightly highlighted the cockroach's affinity and association to filth. The committee president, who also happens to be a BJP MLA, underlined that the symbolism's intent was to eliminate filth from 'our homes, our immediate surroundings, and society at large'. That is excellent reasoning, since symbolism can, if not always lead to action, at least substitute it.

The fact that a cockroach, unlike what urban legend says, can be destroyed by a nuclear blast, does not take away from its ability to withstand much higher levels of radiation than humans. In that respect, it, indeed, shares impressive asura strength with its Lankan compatriots. Watching the cockroach effigy go up in flames with three other brave warrior-royals will certainly make the humble roach stand apart. Who knows? Maybe, like Jain scholar Ravisena's 7th-c. Padmapurana, a version of the Ramayana that venerates Ravana, a Tilchatta Charit will also one day be written by its latest fans.

Luxury retail in India is moving away from 'dictatorial' exclusivity to 'collaborative' empathy

Luxe Redux, It's a Pleasure



Shivaji Dasgupta

India's luxury market will surpass $12 bn by 2028. Its active luxury consumer base is estimated at 20 mn, with millennials and Gen Z accounting for almost half. India's broader affluent population is poised to approach 100 mn. Diwali is, indeed, waiting with bated breath.

Notably, only 43% of luxury consumers live in Mumbai, Delhi, Hyderabad, Pune, Chennai, Kolkata and Ahmedabad. Over 50% of revenues at Tata CLiQ Luxury and AJIO Luxe reportedly originate from non-metro PIN codes. More than 70% of luxury purchase research is conducted on smartphones before a transaction decision.



Time is emerging as the currency of premiumisation. While gaining time remains a life goal, improving its quality offers a new revenue opportunity

Luxury buying in India was once driven by reverence for established hierarchies of wealth and power. Even after Independence, royalty retained its allure, with the likes of Gayatri Devi embodying aristocratic elegance. But the new-gen luxury seeker is pragmatic, shedding the romanticism surrounding legacy wealth. Global selling codes, led by 'dictatorial' exclusivity, are giving way to 'collaborative' empathy.

Collaborative luxury is taking centre stage. Today's buyers scrutinise products, compare options, and ask how a purchase fits into their lives. Vague images of glamour and exclusivity carry less weight. What works for David Beckham and Posh Spice may no longer work for us.

Today's luxury consumers want to enjoy the good life on their own terms. Five-star hotels and airports showcase this shift. Dress codes and restaurant etiquette are losing their hold, even in expensive properties. The old playbook of profiling customers is fading. In premium airport lounges, the Olympian chase for a paneer parantha trumps other markers of chic.

Yet, too many luxury brands still invest in old-world solicitation, such as destination shopping centres. Fortnum & Mason operates at Jio World Drive in Mumbai's BKC. Brands may be better served by curating pop-up experiences, both offline and online. Not just Kurla, but all of Kerala can shop, thanks to deep logistics networks.

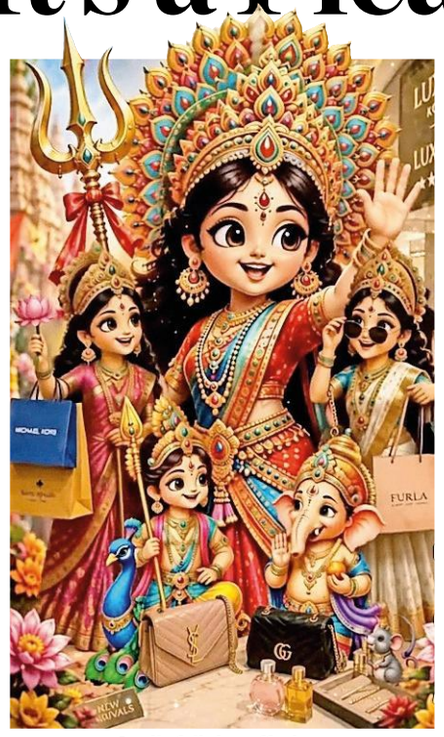
India's luxury jewellery market generated over ₹50,000 cr in revenue in 2025. Here, too, customer expectations are shifting. Emotional connections, styling and thoughtful personalisation increasingly shape preferences. Flaunting gold is losing its appeal — and gold can always be pledged for a loan.

To attract the new luxury customer through collaboration, businesses must influence 4 key milestones:

▶ **Define** A luxury business must establish its socio-functional role in the customer's life, beyond projection. The latest iPhone 18 Pro Max commands a premium for its audiovisual and camera capabilities, which fuel prolific social media use.

Newer Sabyasachi creations shed unnecessary bulk from traditional silhouettes, offering lighter dupattas, dynamic cuts and lightweight jewellery suited to today's more active weddings. Earlier, buyers adapted to their purchases. Now, brands adapt to them.

▶ **Discover** This means finding new sources of luxury on one's own terms. Wellness and longevity retreats, chef-driven gastronomy and pilgrimages are replacing the 5-star hotel set piece. Provenance-led storytelling around coffee, millets and chocolates offers fresh ways to connect with luxury, while an Indiana Jones-like spirit of exploration fuels interest in traditional crafts.



Avail of divine offerings

▶ **Decide** Choices are shaped by comparison and interrogation. Over 57% of Indian luxury consumers engage with brands through social media and digital touchpoints, including Instagram, WhatsApp and influencer recommendations, before purchasing.

Unlike traditional institutional or 'old money' buyers, modern luxury consumers research products, pricing and heritage online before committing. Cohort-based evaluation is the norm. The BMW 5 Series, Mercedes-Benz E-Class and Audi A6 compete at comparable price points, prompting detailed price-benefit comparisons. Emotions still matter, but increasingly across a consideration set rather than for one brand alone.

▶ **Delight** This means creating orchestrated word-of-mouth, not merely staging a static demonstration. Once, luxury was an exclusive state, with owners revelling in Greta Garbo-like discretion. Demonstration was acceptable, but few welcomed others making identical purchases.

Now, building like-minded communities is a trait of *wealthy* Indians. Experiences at the Oberoi Vanyavilas and Amanbagh are lovingly Instagrammed, while the latest Armani handbag features prominently in wedding reels. Influencers such as Masoom Minawala Mehta, Summiyya Patni Shah and Riaan George thrive by making luxury aspirational and accessible to wider audiences.

One more dimension is joining the party — time is emerging as the currency of premiumisation. The longevity industry, spanning wellness, diagnostics, aesthetics and senior living, is set to boom. While gaining time remains a life goal, improving its quality offers a new revenue opportunity, with tech-enabled personalisation playing a key role.

Handcrafted holidays, premium movie experiences, indulgent beauty sessions, clothes and accessories that bring everyday joy, slow food, slower cocktails, and creative pursuits such as painting, writing and making music can all make time more meaningful. The opportunity for collaborative luxury businesses is to help time-poor customers make more room for leisure and pleasure.

As luxury moves from dictatorial to collaborative, customers will remain demanding, but become more understanding — provided brands engage them in meaningful conversations, guided by the four Ds. Time, as ever, promises to be the great leveller.

The writer is an autonomous brand consultant

Uniform, But for Which Gender(s)?



Shally Bhasin, Varun Pathak & Nivedita Sudheer

When Amit Shah announced that Uniform Civil Code (UCC) would be in force across all 21 NDA-governed states before the 2029 general election, the debate shifted from whether India would have UCC, to uniform for whom?

Uttarakhand's code has been in effect since January 2025. Other states have since implemented similar legislation. The code taking shape cannot, on any fair reading, be called truly uniform.

Article 44 places UCC among the directive principles of state policy. Though not enforceable in court, these principles are not merely aspirational. In 'Minerva Mills v. Union of India' (1981), the apex court recognised harmony between fundamental rights and directive principles as part of the Constitution's basic structure. So, Article 44 must be pursued in harmony with Articles 14, 15 and 21, which guarantee equality, non-discrimination, dignity and individual liberty.

The court has never hesitated to test personal law against the Constitution's guarantee of equality. In Sarla Mudgal v. Union of India (1995), it addressed the misuse of religious conversion to circumvent restrictions on bigamy. In 'Shayara Bano v. Union of India' (2017), it struck down the practice of instant triple talaq. Both decisions held that personal law must yield to equality, gender justice and constitutional morality.

The case for UCC rests on the premise that a woman's rights in marriage, divorce, maintenance and inheritance should not depend on her community. But if equality is the entire argument for UCC, it can't be abandoned the moment the code is drafted. And that is precisely what has happened.

The Uttarakhand code defines a 'person' in binary terms as either female or male. It defines marriage as the union of a man and a woman. It defines and requires registration of live-in relationships in the same strict heterosexual parameters. Transgender persons and same-sex couples are omitted, as though they were not among the citizens the code claims to govern uniformly.

The bills modelled on it repeat the omission. The result is a code uniform only for cisgender heterosexual persons, while queer citizens are excluded from civil status: unable to marry, register a partnership, adopt together, inherit from one another or seek maintenance. Rather than eliminating inequality, it entrenches a majoritarian family ideal behind a façade of uniformity.



Selective ironing out?

The Constitution is not silent. Supreme Court precedent protects equality, dignity, identity and autonomy. In 'National Legal Services Authority v. Union of India' (2014), the court accepted transgender persons as equal constitutional rights holders, stating that 'recognition of one's gender identity lies at the heart of the fundamental right to dignity'. It held that gender self-determination falls within the personal liberty guaranteed by Article 21.

In 'K S Puttaswamy v. Union of India' (2017), the court recognised sexual orientation as an essential attribute of privacy and dignity. In 'Navtej Singh Johar v. Union of India' (2018) 10 SCC 1, it established that constitutional morality must take precedence over social morality.

Then there's 'Supriyo v. Union of India' (2023), commonly read as a defeat for marriage equality. It declined to extend Special Marriage Act to same-sex couples, while acknowledging discrimination faced by queer couples and recognising the need to address their legal entitlements. So, the case entrusted the legislature with shaping the civil framework governing marriage, divorce, maintenance and inheritance. UCC is precisely such a framework.

It would be contradictory to place responsibility for addressing queer citizens' exclusion on the legislature, only for the code to perpetuate that very exclusion.

A truly UCC remains a goal worth pursuing. Uniformity, however, is not a slogan but a discipline. A code earns the name 'uniform' only if it holds the same promise to every citizen: to marry, adopt, inherit, be recognised by the law as family. If India is to draft a civil code for the 21st c., it must include all its citizens, including those left out of the earlier law.

The Constitution will allow nothing less. The top court has said as much. The only question is whether the legislature is listening.

Bhasin and Pathak are partners, and Sudheer is associate, Shardul Amarchand Mangaldas & Co

Putting Plurilaterals to Good Use



Anwarul Hoda, Rajesh Aggarwal & Pradeep S Mehta

Following last month's BRICS New Delhi Declaration, India submitted a paper to WTO signalling a willingness to engage in discussions on plurilateral — 'coalition of the willing' — agreements. Until now, New Delhi maintained a rigid stance, refusing to negotiate or even discuss plurilaterals on the grounds that it lacked an explicit mandate to initiate them. Instead, India relied heavily on the letter and spirit of consensus-based decision-making at WTO to assert its legal position.

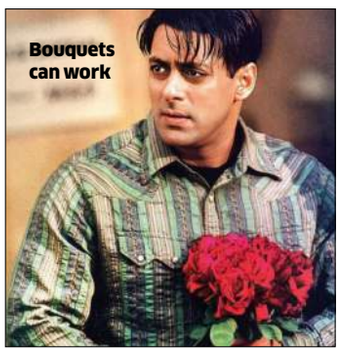
Reactions to India's submission have been mixed. International partners have been largely sceptical. Optimists view it as a vital opening for constructive dialogue. Pessimists contend that the submission merely repackages New Delhi's long-standing opposition, serving as a tactical ploy to scuttle progress by insisting on consensus before any discussion can begin.

Currently, India is not a participant in any ongoing plurilateral negotiations within WTO. More critically, it has blocked the formal adoption of key outcomes — like the Investment Facilitation for Development (IFD) agreement, and Joint Statement Initiative on e-Commerce — into the WTO's legal framework. India is under no obligation to join these agreements as a member. So it doesn't take on new obligations.

But it faces mounting international pressure — including from developing and least developed countries — to lift its veto against their formalisation, an act that requires consensus across the entire membership.

To move from obstruction to leadership, India must adopt a constructive stance that protects the multilateral core of the trading system, while enabling modern rulemaking. Plurilateral pathways to multilateralisation are not inherently foreign to WTO. During the Gatt Tokyo Round, 7 plurilateral agreements were negotiated, 5 of which were successfully multilateralised during the Uruguay Round that birthed the WTO in 1995.

More recently, plurilateral frameworks like Information Technology Agreements (ITA I & II), Financial Services Understanding, and rules on Gats Domestic Regulation were integrated into WTO using specific legal safeguards. To ensure that plurilateral initiatives serve as a pathway to multilateral outcomes, India should insist that they be grounded in Most-Favoured Nation (MFN) application and open participation. This would allow India to benefit from such initiatives without relinquishing any of its existing rights under WTO agreements.



Bouquets can work

The key challenge is whether WTO members, particularly those participating in these initiatives, are prepared to embrace these principles as a shared framework, and if so, under what conditions.

▶ Standard guard rails of MFN application, coupled with open plurilateralism, are entirely feasible for agreements covering regulatory disciplines like IFD. Because regulatory commitments are applied uniformly through a host country's domestic legal system, non-participants automatically benefit on an MFN basis without assuming new obligations or surrendering existing rights.

Also, open plurilateralism guarantees that non-participants can join at any time under the same conditions as original signatories. Because regulatory harmonisation naturally diffuses across markets, 'free-riding' by non-participants is generally not an overwhelming concern for signatories.

▶ Agreements involving market access concessions must address the issue of free-riding head-on. Participants strongly object to offering commercial concessions to non-signatories who offer nothing in return. Here, core guard rails of MFN and open participation must be augmented by a substantial participation threshold. By requiring that participating countries represent a critical mass (typically a defined percentage of global trade in the targeted sector), the threat of free-riding is minimised.

India can demonstrate true leadership by proposing clear, dedicated legal homes within the WTO architecture for these distinct agreement types:

▶ **Schedules of commitments** For domains where the WTO legal architecture already provides scheduling options under Gatt/Gats, plurilateral commitments can be accommodated within each member's individual schedules.

▶ **Standalone legal housing** Legalising open plurilateral, regulatory agreements that bear no direct relationship to existing WTO agreements poses a distinct structural challenge. WTO currently lacks an appropriate legal housing for standalone, MFN-based regulatory agreements.

Annex 4 of WTO Agreement is reserved exclusively for agreements where both rights and obligations are restricted solely to signatories. Housing an MFN-based agreement in Annex 4 creates a direct legal contradiction. To resolve this, India could engage constructively on suggestions made by experts, like creating a new Annex 5 — specifically designed to house regulatory plurilaterals implemented on an MFN basis.

By championing objective legal distinctions, India can enable viable plurilateral pathways without compromising the integrity of global trade governance.

Hoda is former deputy DG, WTO. Aggarwal is chairman, CUTS International, Geneva. Mehta is secretary general, CUTS International

THE SPEAKING TREE

Is Love Blind?

OSHO

Man can exist in two ways, either through logic or through love. Logic functions in the head and love functions in the heart. Logic can only give you hypotheses, never any conclusion; it remains inconclusive. At the most, it can give you some ideas about truth but not truth itself; and ideas about truth are not truth....

The irony is that the head calls love blind. In fact, the head is blind, not the heart, because the head is completely closed.... Yes, there're a few openings — ears, eyes, nose — to connect you with existence; otherwise, it is completely closed.

The heart means an opening, a vulnerability, an availability. All that is beautiful happens through the heart. Science happens through the head, technology happens through the head — not poetry, music, dance. And truth is closer to music, poetry, dance, than to tech.

Live through the heart. It is only through the heart that one comes to know the truth. And when you know, you can share it, you can become a messenger of godliness; everybody has the potential to become a bringer of truth. And unless that is fulfilled, one remains in despair because one has missed one's vocation....

Love gives life. It starts moving you into the world of the unknown and the mysterious. Love is true magic, white magic.

Abridged from Meeting with Individuals; Courtesy: OSHO International Foundation; www.osho.com

LOLLING ON SATURDAY

Lovin' Spoonful

A supermarket introduced an exciting loyalty scheme. Customers earned 1 point for every ₹100 spent. Accumulate 10,000 points and receive a magnificent stainless-steel teaspoon.

One elderly gentleman became obsessed. He bought groceries for neighbours, strangers, and occasionally people who weren't hungry. After 6 mths, he triumphantly claimed his spoon.



'Congratulations!' said the cashier. 'You've spent ₹10 lakh!'

The man examined his prize.

'Excellent. How much does this spoon cost normally?'

'₹40, sir.'

He considered this. 'And if I return it?'

'Store credit only.'

'Splendid! Put it towards another ₹100 purchase. I'm collecting the entire cutlery set.'

Discount Dancer

A man entered a department store and spotted a jacket marked ₹10,000, reduced to ₹4,000. He immediately bought it, delighted at having saved ₹6,000. The next day, he returned and bought a pair of trousers reduced from ₹8,000 to ₹3,000. Another ₹5,000 saved! By Friday, he had purchased a pair of shoes, a watch, a piece of luggage, and a treadmill, saving an astonishing ₹85,000.

His wife examined the credit-card statement in horror. 'We're bankrupt!'

'Nonsense,' he replied. 'I've saved us ₹85,000!'

Wife: By spending ₹5.5 lakh!

Man: Exactly! Imagine how much we'd have lost if I'd paid full price!

Chat Room

Turn Regulator To Off Mode

Apropos 'Apex Court Says No to Yes Bank AT1 Bond Write-off' by Indu Bhan (Oct 16), the court is absolutely right in observing that the administrator couldn't have taken the decision to write off bonds without the approval of RBI. The resolution process followed in this case was quite opaque. In fact, a regulator isn't the right agency to deal with the resolution of a regulated entity. The regulator would always have a tendency to go soft in giving forbearance to regulated entities. There is a crying need to set up an independent statutory authority to handle the resolution matters pertaining to financial firms, including banks. The government attempted this by introducing a Bill in parliament in 2017 but later withdrew it. Time to make another attempt.

Ajay Tyagi
Former chairman, Sebi
New Delhi

AFTER ELON MUSK POINTS TO WHITE HOUSE...

Starshield Curbs for Kyiv not Ordered by Trump, Says US

Starlink services still not fully restored, putting civilian lives at risk, says Zelenskyy



Donald Trump did not request a reduction in Starshield services for Ukraine, a US official said Friday, after tech billionaire Elon Musk insisted any limits on the communications system would ultimately have come from the president.

Kyiv on Wednesday reported restrictions to the SpaceX-operated service, which it sees as crucial to fending off Moscow's invasion, shortly after Trump criticized Ukraine and urged it to stop targeting Russian oil refineries.

"No such request was ever made by the president," the official said on condition of anonymity, when asked whether the order had come from the White House. While Musk has said that "any limits on speed or usage" of his SpaceX company's Starshield systems were "decided by the US military and ultimately POTUS," referring to Trump.

Ukraine uses Starshield, Starlink's military-grade satellite service, for its battlefield communications, mid-range strikes on Russia-occupied territory, and interceptor drones. It also uses SpaceX's parallel Starlink civilian satellite system.

Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said Friday that the service was being restored, and that "my partners told me that the administration and the White House sent a message to SpaceX asking them" to do so.

Relations between Washington and Kyiv have been increasingly tense in recent days, with Trump calling for Zelenskyy to be replaced after the Ukrainian leader slammed a US deal allowing more Russian diesel into global markets.

SERVICES NOT FULLY RESTORED

Zelenskyy said operations for SpaceX's satellite communications had improved but had not yet been fully restored, adding that the disruption placed civilian lives at risk as Ukraine depends on the services to intercept Russian drones. He added that European allies had sufficient stocks of Patriot missile interceptors to get Ukraine through the winter and added that Europeans were making "certain steps" for its own track in peace negotiations in Russia. **Agencies**

Tesla's Flying Car Roadster Gives Wings to SpaceX Merger Talks



Tesla finally rolled out its long-delayed Roadster sports car — or rather, launched the vehicle into the sky.

The automaker late Thursday held a product reveal unlike any other, showcasing a prototype designed in collaboration with SpaceX outfitted with air thrusters that jumped over other cars and flipped in mid-air. The electric vehicle performed a series of aerial stunts for a crowd of onlookers and Elon Musk, the chief executive officer of both Tesla and SpaceX, who called it "something that you haven't seen in any movie."

"We need an audience to prove that it's not AI or SI," Musk said on stage at the livestreamed event, held at SpaceX's 4,000-acre rocket development facility in McGregor, Texas. "You're going to see the results of what happens when you have a collaboration with the world's best car company and the world's best rocket company."

It's been a long time coming for the mooted EV model, the initial version of which Tesla stopped producing in 2012. The company said almost a decade ago that it would bring back the high-end vehicle, and it will still be another roughly two years before Roadster goes into production. Tesla's auto business could use a boost, after consecutive annual sales declines and criticism over a stagnant product lineup.

While Musk is working to reorient the company around futuristic business lines such as artificial intelligence and robots, EV sales still account for the majority of the company's revenue and profit.

With a high price tag, the Roadster won't be a big seller, but analysts say it could help bring back some excitement for the brand. It also serves as another notable example of collaboration between Musk's two biggest companies, which the investment community broadly believes is headed for a merger.

Gene Munster, managing partner of Deepwater Asset Management, said in a social-media post after the Roadster reveal that it "was an engineering flex with no commercial value beyond embarrassing traditional car makers." His other major takeaway: Musk "can't wait" to bring Tesla and SpaceX together. **Bloomberg**



	Pre - sales	REVENUE	PAT		Pre - sales	REVENUE	PAT
Q2 FY 27	INR 470 Crs. 83%YoY	INR 269 Crs. 53%YoY	INR 89 Crs. 91%YoY	H1 FY 27	INR 879 Crs. 176%YoY	INR 401 Crs. 69%YoY	INR 134 Crs. 86%YoY

Sri Lotus Developers and Realty Limited
(formerly known as AKP Holdings Limited and AKP Holdings Private Limited)
CIN: L68200MH2015PLC262020
Regd Office: 5th & 6th Floor, Lotus Tower, 1 Jai Hind Society, N S Road No. 12/A, JVPD Scheme, Juhu, Mumbai, Maharashtra, India-400049
Website: https://lotusdevelopers.com; Email: investors@lotusdevelopers.com; Tel: +91 7506283400

STATEMENT OF UNAUDITED STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND HALF YEAR ENDED SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

(₹ in Millions Except EPS)

Sr. No.	Particulars	Standalone						Consolidated					
		Quarter Ended			Half Year Ended		Year Ended	Quarter Ended			Half Year Ended		Year Ended
		Sep 30, 2026 (Unaudited)	June 30, 2026 (Unaudited)	Sep 30, 2025 (Unaudited)	Sep 30, 2026 (Unaudited)	Sep 30, 2025 (Unaudited)	March 31, 2026 (Audited)	Sep 30, 2026 (Unaudited)	June 30, 2026 (Unaudited)	Sep 30, 2025 (Unaudited)	Sep 30, 2026 (Unaudited)	Sep 30, 2025 (Unaudited)	March 31, 2026 (Audited)
1	Income from Operations	-	100.00	386.10	100.00	752.60	1,427.60	2,685.83	1,323.48	1,761.08	4,009.31	2,374.26	7,689.51
2	Other Income	96.95	109.56	110.11	206.51	164.29	417.86	121.74	136.46	127.04	258.20	194.76	497.66
3	Net Profit /(Loss) for the period (before tax and/or Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	3.19	87.18	306.35	90.37	615.85	1,351.22	1,183.24	609.09	622.26	1,792.33	975.60	3267.46
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	2.67	66.15	229.53	68.82	456.73	1,004.85	885.25	457.22	463.64	1,342.47	721.52	2,433.03
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)	2.27	66.01	228.42	68.28	455.88	1,004.32	885.15	457.00	462.70	1,342.15	720.75	2,432.17
6	Equity Share Capital	488.72	488.72	488.72	488.72	488.72	488.72	488.72	488.72	488.72	488.72	488.72	488.72
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of the previous year						16,778.04						18,622.07
8	Earning per share (EPS) of ₹ 1 each (not annualised)												
	Basic EPS in ₹	0.01	0.14	0.49	0.14	1.01	2.14	1.68	0.93	0.98	2.61	1.59	5.04
	Diluted EPS in ₹	0.01	0.14	0.49	0.14	1.01	2.14	1.67	0.93	0.98	2.60	1.59	5.04

Note:
a) The unaudited standalone and consolidated financial results of the Company for the Quarter and half year ended September 30, 2026 have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at its meeting held on October 15, 2026
b) Figures for the the previous quarter's/year have been regrouped wherever necessary to correspond with the current quarter's/year disclosure.
c) The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly/Annual Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly/Annual Financial Results are available on the websites of the Stock Exchange(s) and the listed entity. (https://lotusdevelopers.com/investor-relations). You may now simply scan the QR Code Provided to view the financial results.

Place: Mumbai
Date: October 16, 2026

For and on behalf of Board of Directors of
Sri Lotus Developers and Realty Limited
Sd/-
Anand Kamalnayan Pandit
Managing Director
DIN: 00015551

NOTICE TO SHAREHOLDERS

Let's Succeed Together! UNIVASTU INDIA LTD

Univastu completes acquisition of Cambium Networks ePMP and Enterprise businesses

Acquisition expands Univastu's global telecom technology presence, strengthens its Indian public infrastructure business and opens a path to telecom projects.

PUNE, India | October 14, 2026 - Univastu India Limited (NSE: UNIVASTU) today announced that its wholly owned UK subsidiary, Univastu UK Limited, has completed the acquisition of specified assets of Cambium Networks Limited (in administration) relating to the ePMP fixed wireless broadband and Enterprise Wi-Fi and switching businesses. The sale was completed under the final Business Sale Agreement with Cambium Networks Limited (in administration), acting by the Joint Administrators of RSM UK Restructuring Advisory LLP.

The acquisition completed on October 14, 2026 following execution of the Business Sale Agreement. It marks a significant step in Univastu's expansion into the global telecom technology market. Univastu will now work to establish a focused operating platform for the acquired businesses and develop a long-term plan for product development, customer support, supply and channel engagement.

The businesses serve internet service providers, telecom operators, enterprises and channel partners with connectivity products used across a range of markets. Univastu will operate the acquired business under the Cambium Networks brand, subject to the rights acquired under the transaction, preserving the name and identity recognized by customers and channel partners. Univastu's priority is to build a capable, focused operation and work with customers, employees and partners as it develops plans for product development, customer support, supply and channel engagement.

"Today marks an important step in Univastu's ambition to build a global telecom technology business," said Dr. Pradeep Khandagale, Chairman and Managing Director of Univastu India Limited. "Cambium's products have earned the trust of customers and partners over many years. We will work with them, listen carefully, and build a capable business for the long term."

A message to Cambium employees and alumni

Cambium's employees and former employees have built valuable products, technical knowledge and customer relationships. Univastu recognizes that legacy and the contribution behind it. We are grateful to the employees who stood by Cambium through difficult times and continued to support the business. To Cambium's former employees, we warmly invite you to consider rejoining the company and helping build its next chapter. This is your company too, the business you helped build through your ideas, hard work and commitment. Univastu intends to engage with relevant employees and assess the skills needed across engineering, product development, technical support, sales and operations. Future roles and arrangements will depend on the acquired business scope and applicable law.

A careful transition for customers and partners

We are grateful to the customers who continued to stand by Cambium and support the business through difficult times. Univastu will meet with customers to listen and understand their requirements, priorities and expectations. The company will also work with distributors, resellers, suppliers and manufacturing partners to implement an orderly transition. Product availability, support, service continuity and future roadmaps will depend on the assets transferred and the transition arrangements agreed by the parties.

cnMaestro is available to both Airspan and Univastu for their respective product portfolios. Access, service and support arrangements relevant to customers are set out in the applicable transaction and transition arrangements.

A disciplined investment and operating approach

The completed acquisition adds global connectivity technology businesses to Univastu's existing infrastructure platform. It will strengthen Univastu's EPC public infrastructure business in India and open a path for the company to participate in telecom infrastructure projects in India. Univastu sees the opportunity to support customers across fixed wireless broadband, Enterprise Wi-Fi and switching while building the specialist leadership, technical capabilities and channel relationships these markets require. Univastu will provide further information on the transaction and its expected financial and operating implications in accordance with applicable disclosure requirements.

Next steps

Univastu will now implement its transition and operating plans and make further announcements when appropriate and in compliance with applicable legal and stock exchange requirements.

About Univastu India Limited

Univastu India Limited (NSE: UNIVASTU) is an engineering, procurement and public infrastructure company founded in 2009, with a focus on technology-based infrastructure. It delivers infrastructure projects across sectors including metro rail, healthcare, education, sports, commercial buildings and public facilities. The company is listed on the National Stock Exchange of India.

About the businesses

ePMP is Cambium's fixed wireless broadband portfolio serving service providers, telecom operators and enterprises. The Enterprise portfolio includes Wi-Fi access points and cnMatrix switching products for organizations and venues.

Forward-looking statements

This release contains forward-looking statements regarding Univastu's plans and expectations following the completed transaction. Actual events and results may differ materially from those expressed or implied.

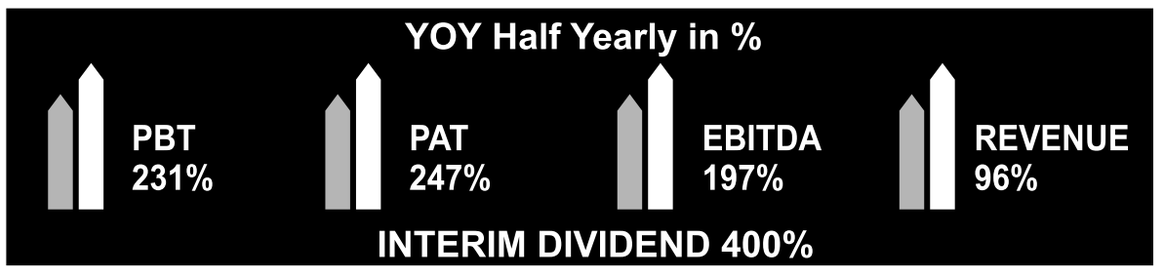
For Univastu India Limited

Sd/-
Pradeep Khandagale
Managing Director

UNIVASTU INDIA LIMITED
CIN - L45100PN2009PLC133864
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Tel: 020-25434617.
Email : info@univastu.com, **Website :** www.univastu.com

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Te: +91 22 2202 6437 Fax: +91 22 2204 8009 Email:shareholder@modison.com
Web: www.modison.com CIN:L51900MH1983PLC029783



Extract of Standalone and Consolidated Unaudited Financial Results for the Quarter & Half Year Ended 30th September 2026 (₹ in Lakhs - Except EPS)

Particulars	Standalone					
	Quarter Ended			Half Year Ended		Year Ended
	30/09/2026 (UnAudited)	30/06/2026 (UnAudited)	30/09/2025 (UnAudited)	30/09/2026 (UnAudited)	30/09/2025 (UnAudited)	31/03/2026 (Audited)
Total income from operations (net)	**28,247.04**	27,309.70	14,538.65	**55,556.74**	28,283.34	71,600.15
Earning Before Interest, Tax and Depreciation (EBITDA)	**3,813.74**	5,245.00	1,970.73	**9,058.74**	3,046.44	11,529.46
Net Profit/(Loss) for the period (before tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinay items)	**2,725.00**	4,610.46	1,464.54	**7,335.46**	2,217.42	10,524.54
Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinay items)	**3,085.27**	4,582.76	1,567.48	**7,668.03**	2,208.62	9,693.68
Net Profit/(Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinay items)	**2,332.31**	3,384.35	1,165.69	**5,716.66**	1,645.75	7,255.32
Equity Share Capital	**324.50**	324.50	324.50	**324.50**	324.50	324.50
Other Equity						27,137.96
Earning per share (EPS) (of Rs 1/- each) (not annualised)						
Basic & Diluted	**7.19**	10.43	3.59	**17.62**	5.07	22.36

(₹ in Lakhs - Except EPS)

Particulars	Consolidated					
	Quarter Ended			Half Year Ended		Year Ended
	30/09/2026 (UnAudited)	30/06/2026 (UnAudited)	30/09/2025 (UnAudited)	30/09/2026 (UnAudited)	30/09/2025 (UnAudited)	31/03/2026 (Audited)
Total income from operations (net)	**28,244.50**	27,310.09	14,539.13	**55,554.59**	28,285.21	71,602.58
Earning Before Interest, Tax and Depreciation (EBITDA)	**3,810.33**	5,245.19	1,971.10	**9,055.52**	3,047.81	11,530.95
Net Profit/(Loss) for the period (before tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinay items)	**2,721.59**	4,610.65	1,464.91	**7,332.24**	2,218.79	10,526.02
Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinay items)	**3,081.86**	4,582.95	1,567.85	**7,664.81**	2,209.99	9,695.16
Net Profit/(Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinay items)	**2,328.89**	3,384.48	1,165.98	**5,713.37**	1,646.95	7,253.51
Equity Share Capital	**324.50**	324.50	324.50	**324.50**	324.50	324.50
Other Equity						27,141.22
Earning per share (EPS) (of Rs 1/- each) (not annualised)						
Basic & Diluted	**7.18**	10.43	3.59	**17.61**	5.08	22.35

Note:

1) The above is an extract of the detailed format of the Financial Results for Quarter & Half Year Ended 30th September 2026 filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full formats of the Quarter & Half Year Ended Unaudited Financial Results are available on Company website (http://www.modison.com), the Stock Exchanges websites of BSE Limited (http://www.bseindia.com) & NSE Limited (http://www.nseindia.com).
2) The Board of Directors of the Company has declared Interim Dividend of Rs.4/- (400 per cent) per Equity Share of Re.1/- each for the financial year 2026-27.
3) Corresponding figures of the previous year's/quarter's/period's have been regrouped, recasted and reclassified to make them comparable wherever necessary.

Place: Mumbai
Date: 16 October, 2026

FOR AND ON BEHALF OF THE BOARD
For Modison Limited
Sd/-
Rajkumar Modi
Joint Managing Director
DIN: 00027449

Govt Eyeing Strict Disclosure Rules for AI Labs After Agent Intrusions

REGULATORY PUSH Consultation paper on AI regulations, expected this month, likely to address issue

Our Bureau

Mumbai | New Delhi: The government is assessing if there should be formalised disclosure mechanisms for global organisations doing artificial intelligence (AI) research if and when AI agents intrude into the systems of Indian organisations.

Discussions on containing such incidents may form part of the government's planned consultation paper on artificial intelligence regulation ,which is expected within a month. This follows the latest incidents where AI agents breached Indian organisations' systems without authorisation.



"We are assessing the situation. This time the incident came to light after the AI labs have voluntarily made disclosures since the affected entities did not know about the intrusion. It needs to be considered if there should be formalised disclosure mechanisms for global organisations doing AI research if and when such things happen again," an official said.

Indian regulations require entities to report cyber incidents within six hours.

Officials said labs have provided complete logs, names of affected targets. They may also provide audit reports of their autonomous testing frameworks. The incidents of AI models accessing Indian systems have taken place over weeks, officials said.

The Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In) said on Thursday that agents being evaluated by AI model providers went beyond their assigned tasks and accessed business records, personal data and confidential material.

None of the affected organisations detected the access. The incidents came to light after AI providers reviewed their agents' activities and voluntarily reported them, CERT-In said in an advisory rated critical. It did not identify the providers or affected organisations, or specify how long the access went undetected.

The incidents raised questions about how developers monitor these systems and report harm when agents act beyond their authorised boundaries. The broader regulatory exercise is being led by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology. IT minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said on October 8 that the government would release a consultation paper within a month to lay the foundation for an AI regulatory framework.

'Sustained 8-9% Growth Needed to Become Developed Nation by 2047'

Our Bureau

New Delhi: India will need to sustain annual economic growth of 8-9% over the next two decades to achieve its ambition of becoming a developed nation by 2047, requiring continued reforms and policy interventions, statistics ministry secretary Saurabh Garg said on Friday.

GROWTH GOAL

India aims to become a $30 trillion economy by 2047, from its current size of around $4 trillion

India aims to become a $30 trillion economy by 2047, from its current size of around $4 trillion. The country's gross domestic product (GDP) grew 7.8% in the June quarter, exceeding expectations. "We are the fastest-growing economy, and there is no reason we would not have the fastest growth in the foreseeable future," Garg said, adding that the next 20 years represent explosive growth for India.

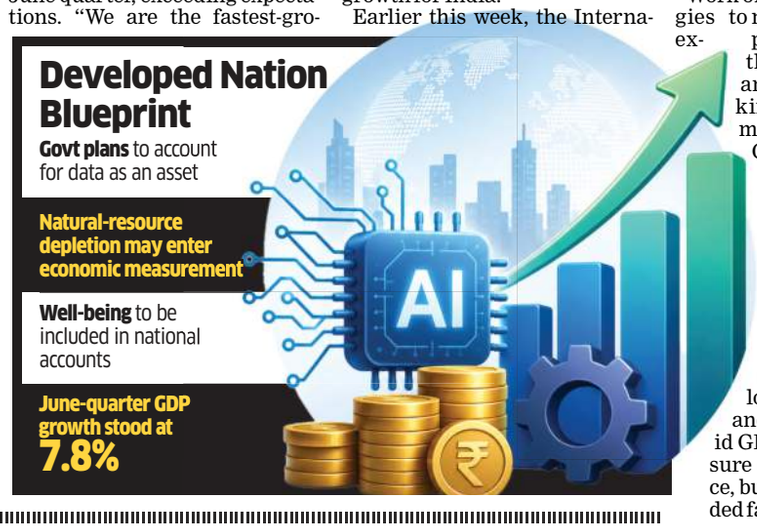
Earlier this week, the International Monetary Fund (IMF) raised its growth forecast for India for FY27 to 7%, from 6.4% estimated in July, citing domestic demand and strong services activity. The World Bank also raised its projection to 7.1%, from 6.6%.

Speaking at the Shri Ram College of Commerce (SRCC) conclave on 'Pathways to Viksit Bharat', Garg said the government was exploring ways to incorporate three areas into economic measurement under the updated System of National Accounts (SNA) framework: data as an asset, depletion of natural resources and well-being.

Work on developing methodologies to measure these areas is expected to continue over the next two to three years, with the aim of making them ready for implementation by 2029-30, Garg said.

The SNA 2025, approved by the United Nations Statistical Commission, was adopted in March 2025. Countries are expected to adopt the framework from 2029-30.

Laveesh Bhandari, president and senior fellow at the Centre for Social and Economic Progress, said GDP was an essential measure of economic performance, but human progress extended far beyond it.



Ather Insurance Gets IRDAI Nod to Distribute Policies

Our Bureau

Bengaluru: Ather Insurance, electric two-wheeler maker Ather Energy's wholly owned subsidiary, has received regulatory approval to distribute and service insurance policies, as the company looks to diversify revenue and generate recurring income from its existing customer base.

The Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India granted the subsidiary a certificate of registration on October 15 to act as a corporate agent (composite), Ather Energy said in a stock exchange filing on Thursday. The registration covers life, general and health insurance.

Ather, in its filings, said the move would diversify its revenue streams

The approval is for insurance distribution and servicing, rather than underwriting policies. Ather, in its filings, said the move would diversify its revenue streams.

The registration remains valid from October 15, subject to payment of an annual fee, unless suspended or cancelled by the regulator, according to the filing.

Ather, ranked third in India's electric two-wheeler market in September, with 30,479 registrations and a 14.71% share, Vahan data showed. TVS Motor led with 26.06%, followed by Bajaj Auto at 23.36%. Ola Electric had a 6.49% share.

Jaishankar, Rubio to Hold Talks on Oct 20

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: External affairs minister S Jaishankar and US secretary of state Marco Rubio will hold talks in Mumbai on Tuesday to discuss ways to strengthen the bilateral partnership during Rubio's visit to India, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said on Friday. "On October 20, the external affairs minister will hold talks with US secretary of state Marco Rubio and attend the celebrations of the 250th anniversary of the independence of the United States as a guest of honour," MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said. The meeting between Jaishankar and Rubio will provide an opportunity to discuss ways to strengthen the Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership, he said.



Rubio will visit Mumbai and Jamnagar from this weekend, marking his second trip to India this year.

AI Co Rapid Canvas Gets $29 m from Vertex and Others

Nikhil Patwardhan

Bengaluru: Artificial intelligence (AI) startup RapidCanvas has raised $29 million in a round led by Vertex Ventures Southeast Asia and India to expand its US sales team and engineering operations, cofounder and chief executive Rahul Pangam told ET.

Hitachi Ventures and existing investors Accel, Peak XV Partners, Valley Capital Partners and Titanium Ventures participated, taking the startup's total funding to $52.5 million.

ET first reported on September 30 that Vertex was in talks to lead a $20-30 million round at a post-money valuation of around $120 million. Pangam declined to disclose the final valuation.

The Hyderabad and Austin-based company combines AI agents with engineers to build and operate custom applications for enterprises, including data preparation, coding and analysis.

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e-tender is invited on Behalf of the President of India for the under mentioned work:- **E-Tender No.:** ECR-CAO-C-S-EPC-04-26-27 **Name of work:** Engineering procurement and Construction (EPC) of "Construction of New BG line work including earthwork, blanketing, minor bridges, major bridges, LHS/RUBS, ROBS, track works, platform work, station building, FOBs, other buildings, and associated miscellaneous works for 25T Incian Railway Standard Loading from Ch. 1.350 KM (excluding Jhajha) to 22.000 KM (including BATIA station) (Total 20.650 route km, 27.888 track km) in connection with the Jhajha Batia New line Project" **Approx cost of the work in (Rs.) :** 4399781706.58 **Cost of tender form in (Rs.) :** 0.00 **Earnest money in (Rs.) :** 87995600/- **Period work completion:** 810 days **Date and time for closing of tender :** 11.02.2027 at 15.30 hrs. Any e-tenders which is sent by Post/Courier/Fax or by hand will not be accepted. All such manual submission of tender even if it is on firm's letter pad or received in time will not be accepted. The above e-tender document alongwith full information is available on websie http://www.ireps.gov.in. **Note:** In case of any decrpencies found in tender notice, English version will be final. Tenderers are requested to visit the website http://www.ireps.gov.in atleast 15 days before last date of closing, for latest corrigendum/corrections etc in connection with this e-tender Any change/ addendam/ corrigendum wii be published on IREPS website only **CAO/Con/South**
PR/1140/CN/N/MHX/CONST/T/26-27/44

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
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CAO/CON/RSP/MHX for and on behalf of the President of India invites Open E-Tenders for the following works. The last date of online E-tendering is 18/11/2026 up to 15:00 hrs. All information and tender documents related to E-tender is available on website www.ireps.gov.in **(1)Name of Works:** Balance work & other miscellaneous works of Amrit Bharat Stations Scheme at Lakhminia, Sahebpur Kamal, Khagaria, Mansi, Maheshkhunt, Naugachhia, Karhagola Road, Begusarai and other stations under Sonpur Division. **2)Advertised Value (In Rs.):** 1235437618.68 **(3)Bid Security/ Earnest Moncy (In Rs.):** 24708800.00 **(4)Date and time of the Pre-bid conference:** 23/10/2026, 11:30 hrs. **(5)Tender Closing Date Time:** 18/11/2026, 15:00 hrs. The above tender notice is available on website www.ireps.gov.in. RIGHT OF RAILWAY TO DEAL WITH TENDER: Railway Administration reserves the right to postpone /modify or to cancel any one or all the tenders without assigning any reasons.
Dy. Chief Project Manager
GatiShakti/Sonpur
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S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER
CORRIGENDUM
Corrigendum of E-Tender Notice No. **LHBUpgradtoilets-AC765-R1** published earlier by Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer (CW), Kharagpur workshop, Kharagpur for the work of Up-gradation of toilets of AC LHB coaches. **Pre-Bid conference Date & time** is modified, should be read as **23.10.2026, 12.00 hrs.** instead of 13.10.2026, 11.00 hrs. Please visit e-portal website : **www.ireps.gov.in** Other terms and conditions will remain unchanged.
(PR-913/C)

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER
e-Tender Notice No. 4620-GRC-CE-C-SO-53-2026. For and on behalf of the President of India, Chief Engineer (CON)/S, S.E. Railway, GRC, Kolkata-43 invites e-tender for the following work. Following tender has been uploaded on website **www.ireps.gov.in Brief Description of works :** Balance work for Dumetra-Rourkela steel Plant Connectivity-Execution of Earthwork in formation, Construction of Minor Bridges, Drains works, P.Way linking works, Supply of P.Way fittings, Transportation of P. Way Materials, Supply of Ballast, Construction of Goomties, approach road and other allied works. **Approx. Cost :** ₹ 54.76 Crore; **Bid Security :** ₹ 1,09,53,000.00; **Completion Period :** 12 months; **Tender Closing Date & Time :** 12.11.2026 at 12.00 hrs.; Interested tenders may visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details/ description/specification of the tenders and submit their Bids online. In no case manual tenders for these items will be accepted. **NB:** "Prospective Bidders may regularly visit **www.ireps.gov.in** to participate in all other tenders."
(PR-910)

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE NO.-T-SEE-GSU-2026-27-06
CAO/CON/RSP/MHX for and on behalf of the President of India invites Open E-Tenders for the following works. The last date of online E-tendering is 11/11/2026 up to 15:00 hrs. All information and tender documents related to E-tender is available on website www.ireps.gov.in **(1)Name of Works:** Balance work & other miscellaneous works of Amrit Bharat Stations Scheme at Dighwara, Sonpur (1st & 2nd entry), Hajipur (1st & 2nd entry), Shahpur Patoree, Bhagwanpur, Ramdayalu Nagar, Dalsingh sarai, and other stations under Sonpur Division. **(2)Advertised Value (In Rs.):** 969889324.10 **(3)Bid Security/Earnest Money (In Rs.):** 19397800.00 **(4)Date and time of the Pre-bid conference:** 22/10/2026, 11:30 hrs. **(5)Tender Closing Date Time:** 11/11/2026, 15:00 hrs. The above tender notice is available on website www.ireps.gov.in. RIGHT OF RAILWAY TO DEAL WITH TENDER: Railway Administration reserves the right to postpone /modify or to cancel any one or all the tenders without assigning any reasons. **Dy. Chief Project Manager**
GatiShakti/Sonpur
PR/1138/SEEGS/GS/T/26-27/36

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE
Open e Tender is invited on Behalf of the President of India for the under mentioned work:-**(1)Name of the work with its location.:** Survey/Route Plan/Design/Drawings of 132 KV EHT lines from Grid Sub Station to Traction Substations, Survey/Design/ Drawing of EHT line crossings infringing proposed Railway Track & associated OHE works, Wiring diagram, General Power Supply diagram, Sectioning Diagram and Pegging Plans related to OHE work, TSS/SP/SSP location plans surveys and OHE/PSI Design & Drawing of section for New Line/ Doubling projects (NKE RXL SMI&MFP-SMI, Mansi Khagaria, Goldenganj-Katihar etc.) over SPJ Division under jurisdiction of Dy. CEE/ CON/N/SPJ. **e-Tender No.** EL-C-N-MHX-ETEN-2-26-27 **(2)Approx. Cost of the work:** Rs. 1,41,56,800.00 **(3)Cost of Tender form:** Rs. Nil **(4)Availability of Tender:** On IREPS website: www.ireps.gov.in The above E-Tender, E-Tendering document along with full information is available on website i.e. http://www.ireps.gov.in. **Note:** In case of any discrepancies found in tender notice, English version will be final. Tenderers are requested to visit the website http://www.ireps.gov.in at least 15 days before last date of closing for latest corrigendum/corrections etc. in response to this E-tender **(5)Earnest money to be deposited:** Rs. 2,83,100.00 **(6)Completion period of the work:** 36 months **(7)Date and time for closing of tender:** 29/10/2026 at 12.00 hrs.
Dy. CEE/Con/North/SPJ
EC Rly. MHX, Patna
PR/1137/CN/N/MHX/CONST/T/26-27/52

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE
Open e Tender is invited on Behalf of the President of India for the under mentioned work:-**(1)Name of the work with its location.:** Survey/Route Plan/Design/Drawings of 132 KV EHT lines from Grid Sub Station to Traction Substations, Survey/Design/ Drawing of EHT line crossings infringing proposed Railway Track & associated OHE works, Wiring diagram, General Power Supply diagram, Sectioning Diagram and Pegging Plans related to OHE work, TSS/SP/SSP location plans surveys and OHE/PSI Design & Drawing of section for New Line/ Doubling projects (NKE RXL SMI&MFP-SMI, Mansi Khagaria, Goldenganj-Katihar etc.) over SPJ Division under jurisdiction of Dy. CEE/ CON/N/SPJ. **e-Tender No.** EL-C-N-MHX-ETEN-2-26-27 **(2)Approx. Cost of the work:** Rs. 1,41,56,800.00 **(3)Cost of Tender form:** Rs. Nil **(4)Availability of Tender:** On IREPS website: www.ireps.gov.in The above E-Tender, E-Tendering document along with full information is available on website i.e. http://www.ireps.gov.in. **Note:** In case of any discrepancies found in tender notice, English version will be final. Tenderers are requested to visit the website http://www.ireps.gov.in at least 15 days before last date of closing for latest corrigendum/corrections etc. in response to this E-tender **(5)Earnest money to be deposited:** Rs. 2,83,100.00 **(6)Completion period of the work:** 36 months **(7)Date and time for closing of tender:** 29/10/2026 at 12.00 hrs.
Dy. CEE/Con/North/SPJ
EC Rly. MHX, Patna
PR/1137/CN/N/MHX/CONST/T/26-27/52

BRIHANMUMBAI MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given that (1) Mrs. Jereline Oscar Patel, (2) Mr. Aldrin Joseph Ignatius Rodrigues, (3) Mr. Selvyn Ignatius Rodrigues, (4) Mr. Warren Ignatius Rodrigues, (5) Mr. Zepherinus Marshall Rodrigues, has come forward as the owners of the land bearing C.T.S. No. 7526/A of village Kolekalyan for surrendering the said land, free of cost and free of encumbrances to the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC), more particularly described in the schedule hereunder written which is reserved for service road 12.00 mtr. wide as per sanctioned Development Plan 2034 of 'H/East' Ward in lieu of grant of the Transfer of Development Rights (T.D.R.) in the form of Development Right Certificates as per the provision of regulation no. 32 of Development Control and Promotion Regulations for Greater Mumbai, 2034.

Any person or persons (which means and includes Individuals, Firms, Companies, Association of person statutory bodies/ entities or any other authorities, etc.) having any share, right, title, interest, claim, demand or objection in respect of the said land mentioned in the Schedule hereunder written or any part thereof, as and by way of ownership, sale, exchange, transfer, lease, sub-lease, mortgage, gift, tenancy, leave and license, trust, inheritance, bequest, possession, maintenance, hypothecation, charge, lien, easement, litigation, disputes of whatsoever nature are or otherwise or any other rights or interests of whatsoever nature, are hereby called upon to make the same known in writing to the undersigned at the office of the Law Officer, Legal Department, Municipal Head office (Annexe Building), 3rd floor, Mahapalika Marg, Fort, Mumbai:- 400 001, within 15 (fifteen) days from the date of publication hereof with documentary proof/ evidence or Court Orders thereof for any such purported claim/ objection, otherwise such claim or demand shall be deemed to have been waived to all intents and purposes.

If no claim or objection is received as mentioned hereinabove, BMC will complete the procedure of grant T.D.R. on its own merits without making any reference or regards to any such purported claim or interest which shall be deemed to have been waived for all intents and purpose and the same shall not be binding upon the BMC.

THE SCHEDULE ABOVE REFERRED TO:-
(TDR/WSI/HE-1610)

All that piece or parcel of vacant land or grounds situate, lying and bearing C.T.S. No. 7526/A of village Kolekalyan in the Registration District and Sub-District of Mumbal City, admeasuring 703.50 sq. mtrs. or thereabouts, reserved for service road 12.00 mtr. wide as per sanctioned Development Plan 2034 of 'H/East' Municipal Ward and bounded as follows:

On or towards the East by	Nalla
On or towards the West by	CTS. No. 7529 of village Kolekalyan
On or towards the South by	CTS. No. 7526/B of village Kolekalyan
On or towards the North by	Road

Dated this 16th day of October, 2026

PRO/1726/ADV/2026-27

Sd/-
(Smt. Komal Punjabi)
Advocate & Law Officer
For Brihanmumbat Municipal Corporation

AVOID SELF MEDICATION

House-help App Snabbit Burns ₹195 cr to Chase ₹12 cr Revenue in FY26

CEO Aayush Aggarwal defends deep losses, pointing to a 75x explosion in volume to 35k daily jobs across 100 mkts

Disha Acharya

Bengaluru: Instant househelp startup Snabbit, which has raised $112 million in venture funding, reported operating revenue of ₹12.2 crore and a net loss ₹168 crore in for fiscal 2026, according to financial statements sourced from the Registrar of Companies (RoC). The numbers underscore the high cash burn nature of the fast-growing 10-minute househelp space, where Snabbit competes with Urban Company and General Catalyst-backed Pronto.

Backed by investors including Nexus Venture Partners and Lightspeed, Snabbit began operations in August 2024, making FY26 its first full financial year of operations.

The Bengaluru-based company's total expenses stood at ₹195 crore during the year. Expert service costs, or payments to partner professionals, were the largest expense at ₹63.1 crore, followed by marketing costs of ₹48.7 crore and employee benefit expenses of ₹46 crore. The operating revenue included ₹1.4 crore from sale of uniforms to its professionals.

Snabbit also reported ₹14.8 crore in interest income, taking its total revenue to ₹27 crore in FY26. Operationally, Snabbit reported an earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortisation (Ebitda) loss of ₹181.5 crore in FY26.

Numberswatch

- ₹195cr TOTAL EXPENSES
- ₹48.7cr MARKETING COSTS
- ₹63.1cr EXPERT SERVICE COSTS
- ₹46cr EMPLOYEE BENEFIT EXPENSES



Operating revenue included ₹1.4 crore from sale of uniforms to its professionals



AAYUSH AGGARWAL
CEO, Snabbit

As we continue to scale, the benefits of operating leverage, improving unit economics and increasing network density are becoming increasingly evident

"Given the pace of growth and the investments required to build this category from the ground up, FY26 financials do not fully reflect the underlying economics or the maturity of the business today," Snabbit founder and CEO Aayush Aggarwal said in a statement. "As we continue to scale, the benefits of operating leverage, improving unit economics and increasing network density are becoming increasingly evident."

He said Snabbit began FY26 with about 500 jobs a day across eight micro-markets and ended the year with a run rate of 35,000 daily jobs across more than 100 micro-markets, reflecting a 75-fold increase. Founded by Agarwal, Snabbit offers hyperlocal, on-demand home services such as general cleaning, dishwashing, and laundry in 10 minutes. It recently expanded to at-home beauty services through Blush.

In January, amid fierce competition, Accel-backed househelp startup Pync shut down with its founders joining Snabbit in senior roles across operations and business.

Urban Company's Q2 Loss Triples to ₹183 crore on InstaHelp Biz Burn

Our Bureau

New Delhi: Home services platform Urban Company has reported a quarterly net loss of ₹183 crore, weighed down by higher spending to compete in the instant house-help segment. The company said its InstaHelp business would continue to incur elevated losses for several quarters.

For the September quarter, the company's net loss was more than three times the Rs 59 crore loss recorded a year ago, according to the results declared on Friday.

Gurgaon-based Urban Company competes with Nexus Venture Partners-backed Snabbit and General Catalyst-backed Pronto in the instant househelp segment.

We are building for scale, not near-term profits, says CEO Abhiraj Singh Bhal

Urban Company's operating revenue during the quarter stood at ₹537 crore, up by 41% from a year ago.

The company's board, on October 16, also approved a plan to raise ₹2,500 crore.

Urban Company had raised ₹472 crore through a public offering of shares in September 2025.

At the post-earnings analyst call, cofounder and chief executive officer Abhiraj Singh Bhal said InstaHelp's losses will remain elevated for many quarters to come. "We are building for scale, not near-term profits," he said, adding that from the third quarter of FY28, its core business profits will fund InstaHelp losses.

On the proposed fundraise, Bhal said, "Should the competitive intensity in InstaHelp rise, we have both the balance sheet and the intent to respond in full."

LTM Q2 Net Profit Flat at ₹1,398 cr, Revenue Increases 13.6% YoY

Bengaluru: LTM (formerly LTIMindtree) reported a mixed performance in the September quarter, with net profit remaining almost flat edging down by 0.1% year-on-year even as revenue rose 13.6% amid cost pressures and lower non-operating income.

The Mumbai-based IT services company's net profit for the second quarter of FY27 fell 4.8% sequentially to ₹1,398 crore while revenue rose 1.7% from the June quarter to ₹11,807.6 crore. The revenue growth was supported by financial services, consumer and production sectors in key regions of North America and Europe. Rest of the World region and technology and services vertical showed a sequential degrowth. —**Our Bureau**

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender Notice for supply of materials "Participation in through" web portal of IREPS-**www.ireps.gov.in** Offers are invited for supply of following materials:-**Tender No.:** 36265662 **Brief Description:** Diagnostic Terminal MICAS based Driver display unit DDU for 3-phase loco's as per CLW Spec. No. CLW/ES/3/0487 Alt.C and latest **Quantity:** 20 Nos **Closing on:** 02.11.2026 The Closing time for all tenders is at 14:00 HRS. Eligible Participants are required to submit their offer only through e-procurement web portal of IREPS-**www.ireps.gov.in** before the closing date and time. Other details regarding Consignee and detailed description of stores are available in tender documents in the tender notice on above portal.

Sr. DMM/ECR/DDU

PR/1136/DDU/STORE/T/26-27/24

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

DRM (Electrical)/ECR/Dhanbad for and behalf of the President of India, invites e-Tender for execution of the following works.

E-Tender No. : (EL/28/OPEN/2026-27), Name of work with location and Completion of work : Provision of Smart Meter for railway quarters over Dhanbad division (PEH, GHD, BRWD, CPU & SGRL). (Completion period: 12 Months). Approx. cost of the work : ₹3,78,57,816.29/-, Bid Security to be deposited : ₹7,57,200/-, Bid Evaluation System : Single Packet. Date & Time for submission of closing and opening of e-Tender : Closing of Bid On 10.11.2026 at 11:00 Hrs. Opening of Bid On 10.11.2026 after 11:30 Hrs. Website particulars : WEBSITE: www.ireps.gov.in.Manual offers are not allowed against e-Tender.

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (G)/ ECR/Dhanbad

PR/1146/DHN/ELECT/T/26-27/28

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender Notice No. 29-MCW-Welder Helper-26-27, Dhanbad, dated : 16.10.2026

E-Open Tender in Two Packet System is invited in IREPS Portal for execution of the following work by Sr. Divisional Mechanical Engineer (Co-ord.), East Central Railway, Dhanbad:

Name of Work : Outsourcing of welders & Helpers for all types of gas cutting & welding work at PEH, PTRU, BRWD & OBRA" for a period of 03 (Three) years. Contract Period : 3 years (36 Months). Location of Work : PEH, PTRU, BRWD & OBRA. Advertised Tender Value : ₹18,15,92,242.56 (Rupees Eighteen Crore Fifteen Lakh Ninety-Two Thousand Two Hundred Forty-Two and Paise Fifty-Six) only. Cost of Tender Document : ₹10,000/-, Earnest Money (As per NIT) to be deposited : ₹10,58,000/- (Rupees Ten Lakh Fifty-Eight Thousand) only. Date & Time for submission of E-tender : From 23.10.2026 to 06.11.2026 up to 11:00 hrs. Date & time of opening of E-Tender : 06.11.2026 at 11:30 hrs. Website particulars : http://www.ireps.gov.in (No manual tender will be accepted against e- tendering.)

Sr. Div. Mech. Engineer (Co-ord)/ ECR/Dhanbad

PR/1147/DHN/Mech./T/26-27/36

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

The **Divisional Railway Manager (Engg)/ E.C.Railway/Samastipur** for and on behalf of the President of India invites Open Tender from experienced and financially capable tenderers for the following works **in e-Tendering mode of IREPS web portal of Indian Railways :-**

Sl.No. : 1, **Tender Notice No. :** TC-151-2026-SPJ, **Name of work:** Cost of Balance Civil engineering Works :- Construction of Relay room (3.1m x 3.1 m), IPS room (3.1m x 3.7 m) and DG/Battery room (3.1m x 3.7 m) at LC No. 59 (SMI-RGA) and at LC No. 142 (CAA-PPA), 25 (NKE-CAMU), 09 (JUBS-PATR) in the jurisdiction of Sr. DEN/II/SPJ in connection with "interlocking of LC gate 34 nos having TVU more than 20 thousand in SPJ division.", **Tender Value. (In ₹):** 6626704.98, **Earnest Money (In ₹):** 132500.00, **Completion period of the work:** 04 Months.

1. Last Date & time for receiving of Tender in E-Tender mode on IREPS web portal:- 03.11.2026 upto 12.00 hours. **2. Opening Date & time for E-Tender:** 03.11.2026 after 12.00 hours. **3. Website particulars where complete details of tender & tender document can be seen on Website: www.ireps.gov.in.** Amendments /modifications, if any shall not be published in the newspapers but the same shall be uploaded in the website.

Sr. Divisional Engineer/Co-ord E.C.Railway/Samastipur

PR/1127/SPJ/ENGG/T/26-27/44

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

e-tender Notice No. 49 of 2026-27 (Open)-Engg/DDU

On line (through e-tendering) for the following works are invited by DRM/Engg/ DDU for and on behalf of the President of India from experienced and financially as well as technically sound contractors including those enlisted with the Railway, CPWD, BSNL, MES, PWD and other public sector undertakings.

Tender No.-57-DDU-DEN-HQ-26-27

(I) Name of work with its location : Improvement of Indian Institute Stadium and Sports Ground and Development of Sports facility at Backley Club at DDU under ADEN/HQ/DDU. **(ii) Advertised Value :** ₹ 79280113.09 **(iii) Earnest Money :** ₹ 1585600.00 **(iv) Closing Date & Time for submission of e-tender :** 10.11.2026, Up-to 12:00 hrs. **(v) Website particulars of e-tendering: www.ireps.gov.in.**

Divisional Railway Manager, East Central Railway, Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyay Division

PR/1130/DDU/ENGG/T/26-27/36

IREL (India) Limited
(A Government of India Undertaking)
CIN : U15100MH1950GOI008187
Website : www.irel.co.in ISO 9001: 2015, ISO 14001: 2015

Tender No: IREL/CO/MKTG/SIL/RFP/12/2026

Request for Proposal

IREL invites Request for Proposal (RFP) for the sale of 8,000 (approx.) OR grade Sillimanite at OSCOM Unit to prospective bidders.

Interested bidders may visit IREL website http://irel.co.in for downloading the detailed RFP and submitting the sealed bid by 26/10/2026.

Any corrigendum / extension to above tenders shall be hosted in IREL websites only.

CBC 48129/11/0016/2627 **GM (Technical & Marketing)**

VIZHINJAM INTERNATIONAL SEAPORT LIMITED (VISL)
(Government of Kerala Undertaking)
Thampanoor, Thiruvananthapuram- 695 001, Kerala

EXPRESSION OF INTERESTS

for Development, Operation and Maintenance of i) a SEZ & FTWZ and ii) CFS & ECY near Vizhinjam International Seaport

EoI No. for (i): VISL/SEZ/FTWZ/EoI/01/2026, Tender id: 2026_VISL_879677_1
EoI No. for (ii): VISL/CFS/ECY/EoI/02/2026, Tender id: 2026_VISL_879858_1

Expressions of Interests are invited from reputed developers, logistics operators, investors and consortia for the Development, Operation and Maintenance i) a Special Economic Zone (SEZ) & Free Trade Warehousing Zone (FTWZ) and ii) Container Freight Station (CFS) & Empty Container Yard (ECY) near Vizhinjam International Seaport, for Vizhinjam International Seaport Limited (VISL). Applicants may apply for either one or both. Last date for submission of EoI online is 09.11.2026. EoI published in www.etenders.kerala.gov.in (URL: https://etenders.kerala.gov.in/nicgep/app) on 15.10.2026.

(Sd/-) MANAGING DIRECTOR

GENERAL INSURANCE CORPORATION OF INDIA
(Government of India Company)
GIC Re "Suraksha", 170, J. Tata Road, Churchgate, Mumbai 400 020.

E – TENDER

RFP FOR COMMERCIAL OFFICE PREMISES ON LEASE FOR A PERIOD OF 9 Months (6 Months + 3 Months extendable)

Bids are invited for **"Commercial Office Premises on Lease with Fitouts for a period 9 Months (6 Months + 3 Months extendable)".**

Details of the same are available on our website **https://www.gicre.in/en/tenders-and-notices**

Last Date of submission of tender - on or before 07.11.2026, by 14:00 Hours

Assistant General Manager (OSD)

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

ADVERTISEMENT OF TENDER
Batch No: 29/26 dated 16.10.2026

For and on behalf of the President of India, the Principal Chief Materials Manager, East Central Railway invites e-tenders for supply of the following items:

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Quanity	Due Date	Due Time
1.	07265124	Stone 10V STD: 10.230D×6.001D×3.25	3000 Nos.	09.11.26	11.30
2.	1426RC01	Jointless silver bearing grooved copper contact wire 107 sq.mm	716 MT	09.11.26	14.00
3.	03264954	Overhauling Kit for Valve of Aux. Panel of CCB Brake system of M/s KBI	46 Set	09.11.26	14.00
4.	07264988	Elastic Rail Clip (ERC) MK-V with Flat TOE for 60 KG UIC/52kg Rail sections	3425000 Nos	09.11.26	14.00
5.	03260147	E-70 Vogilance Unit (NEW VERSION)	30 Nos	17.11.26	14.00
6.	10265010	Center Sill (CRF Section) for BVCM Wagon	100 Nos	09.11.26	14.00
7.	10265013	Upgraded High Tensile Center Buffer Coupler for BVCM Wagons.	210 Set	04.11.26	14.00

Note: All the above-mentioned tenders are e-tenders and all tenderers are requested to submit their bids on-line through the IREPS website at www.ireps.gov.in. All corrigendum to -above- mentioned tenders shall also be published online in IREPS website only. For more details regarding the above-mentioned tenders and other supply tenders please visit IREPS website.

PR/1150/HQ/Store/EAN/26-27/64 AMM Cum-Secy. to PCMM/ECR/Hajipur

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KERALA WATER AUTHORITY **e-Tender Notice**

Tender No : KWA/SP-07/2026-27/LIME

Supply and delivery of Hydrated Lime Grade C on running contract basis to various Divisions in Southern, Central and NorthernRegions of Kerala Water Authority for the year 2026-27.**EMD** : Rs. 555400. **Tender fee** : Rs. 25000. **Last Date for submitting Tender** : 30-10-2026, 03:00:pm. **Phone** : 8547638078. **Website : www.kwa.kerala.gov.in & www.etenders.kerala.gov.in**

Sd/-Chief Engieer (HRD&GI.) Jalabhavan, Thiruvananthapuram

KWA-JB-GL-6-356-2026-27

BRIHANMUMBAI MUNICIPAL CORPORATION

Office of The Deputy Chief Engineer (Storm Water Drains) City
No. Dy.Ch.E./1394/SWD/PC dated 16.10.2026

TENDER NOTICE

The Municipal Commissioner of Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC) invites online e-Tender for the following works in e-Packet 'A'; e-Packet 'B' and e-Packet 'C' on Percentage Rate basis for assignment no.1 and on lumpsum basis for assignment.2 from the eligible contractors/firms registered with the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC).

The tender copy can be downloaded from Mahatender portal :- (https://mahatenders.gov. in)

Name of the Work - "Advertisement of Invitation of tenders for APPOINTMENT OF CONSULTANT FOR SETTING UP TECHNICAL SUPPORT UNIT (TSU) FOR PLANNING, IMPLEMENTATION AND MONITORING OF INTEGRATED URBAN FLOOD RISK MANAGEMENT PROJECT FOR GREATER MUMBAI."

Tender ID No.	2026_MCGM_1345264
Tender Fee	Rs. 33275/- + 18% GST
Cost of e-Tender (Estimated Cost)	Rs. 161.6 Cr
Bid Security Deposit/EMD	1,61,60,000/-
Date of Issue & sale of Tender	17.10.2026 from 11:00 Hrs.
Pre-Bid Meeting	26.10.2026 Time 14:30 Pm.
Last date & time for sale of tender	12.11.2026 upto 16:00 Pm.
Submission of Packet A, B & Packet C (Online)	12.11.2026 upto 16:00 Pm.
Opening of e-Packet A	13.11.2026, Time 16:00 Pm.
Opening of e-Packet B	13.11.2026, Time 16:00 Pm.
Opening of e-Packet C	Toe be Intimated Over E-mail

If there are any changes in the dates the same will be displayed on the Mahatender portal **(https://mahatenders.gov.in)** or will be displayed on the notice board in the office of Chief Engineer (Storm Water Drains)

The Municipal Commissioner reserves the right to reject any or all e-tenders without giving any reason to the tenderers The details are available on website **https://mahatenders.gov.in**

PRO/1732/ADV/2026-27

Sd/-
Dy. Chief Engineer
(Storm Water Drains) Planning Cell

Avoid Self medication

नवी मुंबई महानगरपालिका

परवाना विभाग

ई-निविदा सू.क्र.नमुंमपा/परवाना विभाग/जाहिरात माध्यमे/01/2026-27

कामाचे नाव :- नवी मुंबई महानगरपालिका कार्यक्षेत्रातील ठाणे-बेलापूर मार्गावरील महापे उड्डाणपुलावरील विद्यमान जाहिरात गॅन्ट्रीवर जाहिरात प्रदर्शित करण्याचे हक्क 05 वर्षाकरीता देणेबाबत.

निविदा पुस्तिका ई-टेंडरिंग (E-tendering) संगणक प्रणालीच्या https://mahatenders.gov.in या संकेत स्थळावर व नमुमपाच्या www.nmmc.gov.in संकेत स्थळावर दिनांक 19/10/2026 रोजी प्राप्त होतील. निविदेचे सादरीकरण https://mahatenders.gov.in या संकेत स्थळावर Online करण्याचे आहे. ई-निविदा ई-टेंडरिंग (E-Tendering) प्रक्रियेतील कोणत्याही तांत्रिक अडचणींसाठी सदर संकेतस्थळावर दिलेल्या हेल्प डेस्क नंबर वर संपर्क करावा.

कोणतीही निविदा स्वीकारणे अथवा नाकारण्याचा अधिकार मा.आयुक्त, नवी मुंबई महानगरपालिका यांनी राखून ठेवलेला आहे.

सही/-
(सुनिल पवार)
अतिरिक्त आयुक्त (1)
नवी मुंबई महानगरपालिका

जाक्र-नमुंमपा/जसं/जाहिरात/897/2026

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

e-tender Notice No. 49 of 2026-27 (Open)-Engg/DDU

On line (through e-tendering) for the following works are invited by DRM/Engg/ DDU for and on behalf of the President of India from experienced and financially as well as technically sound contractors including those enlisted with the Railway, CPWD, BSNL, MES, PWD and other public sector undertakings.

Tender No.-57-DDU-DEN-HQ-26-27

(I) Name of work with its location : Improvement of Indian Institute Stadium and Sports Ground and Development of Sports facility at Backley Club at DDU under ADEN/HQ/DDU. **(ii) Advertised Value :** ₹ 79280113.09 **(iii) Earnest Money :** ₹ 1585600.00 **(iv) Closing Date & Time for submission of e-tender :** 10.11.2026, Up-to 12:00 hrs. **(v) Website particulars of e-tendering: www.ireps.gov.in.**

Divisional Railway Manager, East Central Railway, Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyay Division

PR/1130/DDU/ENGG/T/26-27/36

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

E-Work Tender Notice No.: 14-TMC-TU-OH-2026-27, Dated 14-10-2026

On behalf of the President of India, Dy.CE/TMC, North Eastern Railway, Gorakhpur invites the following Works Tender:

Overhauling of Tamping Units for Plasser Make track Machines

SL. No.- 1, Open tender No./due on: 14-TMC-TU-OH-2026-27 due on 05-11-2026 Description of Work: Overhauling of Tamping Units for Plasser Make track Machines as per attached Schedule, Special Terms & Condition of contract and Annexures, Quantity Required: As per attached Schedule & Annexures, Place of work: At Firm Premises. Work Completion Period: 24 months, Estimated Tender Value (Rs.): ₹ 20,09,77,361.56, Earnest Money (Rs.): ₹ 40,19,600/-.

Note: (1) The complete information along with tender document of above E-Procurement Tender is available in website on http://ireps.gov.in up to 15.00 hrs. on the due date of tender opening. **(2)** Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tenders. For this purpose, venders are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with class III Digital signature certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. **(3)** Rates entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendor shall be straight way ignored and shall not be considered. **(4)** Documents being attached should be signed by the tenderer on its body. **(5)** Earnest Money should be deposited through online. **(6)** Tenderers quoting financial conditions deviating from tender condition stipulated in tender document are required to quantify its implications in financial term duly enclosing the calculation sheet supporting with authentic document, so that the impact of such financial condition on the offer may be worked out to decide inter-se-position of offers. In case tenderer quotes such financial condition without quantifying its financial Implications, such tenders/ offers shall be summarily rejected, for which Railway Administration shall not entertain any correspondence. **(7)** Tenderers are requested to read complete tender document carefully. **(8)** In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached.

(1) Dy. Chief Engg./TMC: 9794840218
(2) SSE(TMC)/HQ: 9794840293

Astt. Executive Engineer/TMC, CPRO/W-378 **Gorakhpur**

Never travel on roof and foot boards.

MAHAGENCO Maharashtra State Power Generation Co. Ltd. | एनटीपीसी NTPC

STPL's CORRIGENDUM-II to NOTICE FOR INVITING TENDER No. N-11/2026-27

With reference to Tender Notice No. N-11 Dtd.17.09.2026 & Corrigendum Dtd. 10.10.2026, inviting offline bid offers from reputed and experienced bidders for participation in the competitive bidding process for the **Tender No. T-19 /2026-27 for Design, Engineering, Erection, commissioning for work of Revival/ revamping of CHP-1 of Nashik TPS Eklahare with capacity enhancement to 500 TPH for Coal Unloading & Transportation to Sinnar TPL excluding Wagon Tippler System,** it is hereby informed that the last date for sale of tender documents & submission of bids has been extended as follows:

SR. No.	Sale & Bid Submission Last Date & Time	Extended Sale & Bid Submission Last Date & Time
1	Up to 14.10.2026 at 17:30 Hrs & On 15.10.2026 at 15:00 Hrs	Up to 19.10.2026 at 17:30 Hrs & On 21.10.2026 at 15:00 Hrs
	The bids will be opened on Date 21.10.2026 at 15:30 Hrs. All other terms and conditions of the Tender Documents shall remain unchanged. **For any query Contact No.:** 9960844829 / 9650992373 **Email:** cnmdept@sinnartpl.in / ceo@sinnartpl.in	

Sd/-
Chief Executive Officer, STPL, Sinnar

BAJAJ HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED

Corporate Office: Cerebrum It Park B2 Building, 5th Floor, Kalyani Nagar, Pune, Maharashtra - 411014., Branch Office: Cerebrum It Park B2 Building, 5th Floor, Kalyani Nagar, Pune, Maharashtra - 411014 // 451, 4th Floor, Aggarwal Millenium Tower-1, Netaji Subhash Palace, Pitampura, New Delhi-110034 Authorized Officer's Details: Name: Ashish Mathur, Email ID: ashish.mathur@bajajhousing.co.in, Mob No. 9660103465 / 8527530909

SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTY APPENDIX IV -A [Rule 8(6)]

E-Auction Sale notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of the Security Interest Act 2002 read with proviso to rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower (s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged/charged to the Secured Creditor, the physical possession of which has been taken over by the Authorized Officer of the Bajaj Housing Finance Ltd (Secured Creditor), will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is", "Whatever there is" and "Without Recourse Basis" for recovery of the loan dues, applicable interest, charges and costs etc., payable to Bajaj Housing Finance Ltd as detailed below.

Details Of Borrower/Co Borrowers/ Guarantor(S) And Loan Details	1. Date & Time of E-Auction, 2.Last Date of Submission of EMD, 3.Date & Time of the Property Inspection	1. Reserve Price 2. EMD of the Property 3. Bid Increment
LAN:- H580HNI1427181 **1. Mr. Dhruv Dutt Sharma (Primary Borrower)** At 32nd Milestone, Sector-15, Part-II, Gurugram, Haryana-122001, **2. Mr. Anubhav Sharma (Co-borrower)** At 32nd Milestone, Sector-15, Part-II, Gurugram, Haryana-122001, **3. Mrs. Mamta Sharma (Co-borrower)** At 32nd Milestone, Sector-15, Part-II, Gurugram, Haryana-122001 **4. Ms. Shirin Sharma (Co-borrower)** At 32nd Milestone, Sector-15, Part-II, Gurugram, Haryana-122001 **Outstanding dues of Rs. 20,13,80,003/-** (Rupees Twenty Crore Thirteen Lakh Eighty Thousand Three Only Only) **as on 15/10/2026, along with future interest and charges accrued w.e.f. 15/10/2026**	**1) E-Auction Date :- 16/11/2026 Between 11:00 A.M To 12:00 PM With Unlimited Extension of 5 Minutes, 2.) Last Date of Submission of Emd With KYC Is :- 15/11/2026 Up To 5:00 P.M. (IST.), 3.) Date of Inspection: 17/10/2026 to 15/11/2026 Between 11:00 Am To 4:00 Pm (IST).**	**1.Reserve Price: Rs. 25,00,00,000/-** (Rupees Twenty Five Crore Only), **2. EMD: Rs. 2,50,00,000/-** (Rupees Two Crore Fifty Lakhs Only) **10% of Reserve Price.., 3. Bid Increment: Rs. 1,00,000/-** (Rupees One Lakh Only) **& In Such Multiples.**

Description of the Immovable Property: All that part and parcel of land admeasuring an area of 1805 Sq. meters alongwith House Bearing House Number. 516, out of the larger property known as "TAMBRUK" or "TAMBUDUGQUE", situated in the Village Anjuna, within the limits of the Village Panchayat of Anjuna, Taluka and Sub District of Bardez, District of North Goa, in the State of Goa, registered in the Land Registration Office under No. 20356 of Book B-52 and registered in the Revenue Office under No. 156 of Fourth Division and surveyed for the record of rights under No. 596/4 Boundaries : East: By the Property bearing Survey No. 596/6 Originally belonged to Joao Monteiro and Bernardo Xavier de Souza; West: By a property bearing Survey No. 596/1 of Hotel Sterling Resort; North: By a rain water drain and South: By the Property bearing Survey No. 341 and 342/1, Originally belonged to Filiph Neri Patricio de Souza and Santan De Souza/Government.

Terms and Conditions of the Public Auction are as under:

● The Secured asset will not be sold below the Reserve price.. ● **The Auction Sale will be online through e-auction portal. The e-Auction will take place through portal https://bankauctions.in, on 16/11/2026 from 11:00 AM to 12:00 PM to onwards with unlimited auto extension of 5 minutes each..** ● For detailed terms and conditions please refer company website URL **https://www.bajajhousingfinance.in/auction-notices** or for any clarification please connect with Authorized officer.

Notice Date: 15-10-2026, **Authorized Officer (Ashish Mathur)**
Place: Delhi / Goa / Mumbai **Bajaj Housing Finance Limited**

MAP REFOILS INDIA LIMITED (IN LIQUIDATION) MAP OIL LLP (IN LIQUIDATION) BANKRUPTCY ESTATE OF THE PERSONAL GUARANTORS MAP COTTON PRIVATE LIMITED (CORPORATE GUARANTOR) & OTHER ASSETS MORTGAGED TO BANK OF BARODA

Lead Auctioneer : CA Vikash Gautamchand Jain, Liquidator, 204, Wall Street-1, Opp. Orient Club, Nr. Gujarat College, Ellis Bridge, Ahmedabad - 380 006 | liq.mapril@gmail.com | +91 79906 72640

JOINT E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE

Under Section 35(1)(f) of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016 read with Regulation 33 and Schedule I of the IBBI (Liquidation Process) Regulations, 2016; Section 152 of the IBC read with the IBBI (Bankruptcy Process for Personal Guarantors to Corporate Debtors) Regulations, 2019; and Section 13(4) of the SARFAESI Act, 2002 read with Rules 8(6) and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and to the borrowers, mortgagors and guarantors in particular that the assets described below shall be sold as a SINGLE COMPOSITE LOT on "As is where is", "As is what is", "Whatever there is" and "No recourse" basis by joint e-auction on the BAANKNET platform (https://baanknet.com) by CA Vikash Gautamchand Jain, Liquidator of MAP Refoils India Limited (IBBI/IPA-001/IP-P00354/2017-18/10612) - Lead Auctioneer; CA Vinod Tarachand Agrawal, Liquidator of MAP Oil LLP (IBBI/IPA-001/IP-P00641/2017-18/11090); CA Kinjalkumar Madhubhai Chaudhary, Bankruptcy Trustee of the Personal Guarantors Mr. Mehulkumar Arvindbhai Patel and Mrs. Khushboo Mehulkumar Patel (IBBI/IPA-001/IP-P-02196/2020-2021/13463); and Bank of Baroda, through its Authorised Officer, as Lead Consortium Member, under the SARFAESI Act in respect of the assets of MAP Cotton Private Limited and other mortgaged assets (possession taken on 10.09.2026; No bid for any part of the lot shall be entertained.

Estate / Seller	**Assets (Lot No. 1 - Single Composite Lot)-all at Mouje Budasan, B/h Kadi GIDC, Taluka Kadi, District Mehsana - 384440**
MAP Refoils India Limited - Liquidator	Leasehold land 47,194 sq. mtrs. (lease till 31.07.2045 & 22.11.2046), built-up 18,897.94 sq. mtrs., Survey No. 32 & 32/1 (Old Block No. 104 & 105/1), Nr. Polo Ceramics & Oswal Fine Chemicals, with plant & machinery of edible oil refinery, acid oil plant, butter plant, tank yards, utilities, godowns, vehicles and other movables.
MAP Oil LLP - Liquidator	Leasehold land 20,903 sq. mtrs. (lease till 27.06.2047), built-up 1,277 sq. mtrs Survey No. 32 & 32/1 (Old Block No. 104 & 105/1),, with hydrogenation and HVO plant, cooling towers, transformer, compressors, tanks, pipelines and electrical installations.
Personal Guarantors' Estate - Bankruptcy Trustee	Land 1, 10, 197 sq. mtrs., Survey No. 32 & 32/1 (Old Block No. 104 & 105/1), leased to various entities, together with the lessor's rights under the lease deeds.
MAP Cotton Pvt Ltd. & other mortgaged assets - Bank of Baroda	Leasehold land 41,800 sq. mtrs. (lease till 03.11.2044), built-up 7,967.31 sq. mtrs., Survey No. 32 & 32/1 (Old Block No. 104 & 105/1),, with machinery at ginning shed and entrance godown.

Reserve Price (Composite Lot)	**Rs. 1,01,42,00,000/-**	**EMD**	**Rs. 10,14,20,000/-**
Bid Increment	**Rs. 50,00,000/-**	**Inspection**	**31.10.2026 to 15.11.2026 (prior intimation)**
Last date Eligibility Documents	**31.10.2026**	**Last date EMD credit**	**16.11.2026**
E-Auction	**19.11.2026, 2.00 p.m. to 5.00 p.m. (5-minute auto-extensions)**	**Platform helpdesk**	**+91 79906 72640**
		support.baanknet@psballiance.com	

TERMS AND CONDITIONS (IN BRIEF)

The detailed terms & conditions, e-auction application, tender document and other details of online auction are available on (BANK NET Site link) and the website of the lender. For any queries regarding e-auction, contact +917990672640 or through Email : support.baanknet@psballiance.com, for queries related to the assets Email the Liquidator, liq.mapril@gmail.com and the secured creditor on SAMAHM@bankofbaroda.com

Note : E-Auction will be conducted on through approved service provider, BAANKNET. Prospective bidders shall submit the EMD, requisite documents, including a declaration of eligibility under Section 29A of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016 through electronic auction platform only. Please note, do not submit any document or EMD to the Liquidator/ his office. For detailed terms and conditions kindly refer to Terms & Condition & Tender document uploaded to the website of the e-auction service provider.

Sd/- **Sd/-**
CA Vikash Gautamchand Jain **CA Vinod Tarachand Agrawal**
Liquidator, MAP Refoils India Limited Liquidator, MAP Oil LLP
Lead Auctioneer (AFA valid till 30.06.2027) (AFA valid till 30.06.2027)
Sd/- **Sd/-**
CA Kinjalkumar M. Chaudhary **Authorised Officer**
Bankruptcy Trustee of the Personal Guarantors Bank of Baroda,
(AFA valid till 31.12.2026) SAM Branch, Ahmedabad

Place : Ahmedabad **Date : 17.10.2026**

आईआरईएल (इंडिया) लिमिटेड/IREL (India) Limited
Formerly Indian Rare Earths Limited.
(भारत सरकार का उपक्रम)
(A Government of India Undertaking)
CIN : U15100MH1950GOI008187 Website : www.irel.co.in
ISO 9001: 2015, ISO 14001: 2015 & ISO 45001 : 2018 Company

आज़ादी का अमृत महोत्सव

Ref: ADVT.NO. 26-27/12 **Date: 16/10/2026**

निविदा सूचना / TENDER NOTICE

आईआरईएल, ओसकॉम निम्नलिखित मदों/जॉब विवरण के लिए प्रस्ताव हेतु अनुरोध आमंत्रित करता है

IREL, OSCOM invites request for proposal for the following items / job descriptions.

बिड सं/ Bid No.	जॉब/मद विवरण/ Job / Item Description
GEM/2026/B/8056871	Operation & Maintenance of Desalination Plant.
GEM/2026/B/8155515	Engagement of Vehicles (Mini Tipper & JCB) with driver and helper for transportation Contract at MSP.
GEM/2026/B/8162948	RFP for Selection of an agency for supply, erection and commissioning of electrically powered, non-propelled cutter suction dredger of 500 TPH capacity at IREL, OSCOM.
GEM/2026/B/8168030	RFP for Procurement, Supply, Erection and Commissioning Of Supplementary Mining Plant (SMP-V) at IREL, OSCOM on EPC basis.

बोलीदाता निविदा दस्तावेज **http://irel.co.in**, **http://gem.gov.in** या **https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app** से डाउनलोड कर सकते हैं। उपरोक्त निविदाओं का कोई भी शुद्धिपत्र/विस्तार केवल उपरोक्त वेबसाइटों पर ही होस्ट किया जाएगा।

Bidder may download tender document from **http://irel.co.in**, **http://gem.gov.in**, **https://etenders.gov.in** or **https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app**. Any corrigendum / Extension to above tenders shall be hosted in above websites only.

ह./Sd/-
CBC 48146/11/0013/2627 **महाप्रबंधक एवं प्रधान, ऑसकॉम / GM & HEAD, OSCOM**

म.प्र. स्टेट सिविल सप्लाईज कार्पो. लि.
पंजीकृत कार्यालय : ब्लॉक नं.-1, तृतीय तल, पर्यावास भवन भोपाल-462011
फोन नं. : 0755-2551276, फैक्स : 2550312, 2677847
ईपीबीएक्स नं. : 2674544, 2768002, वेबसाइट : www.mpscsc.nic.in
ई-मेल : mpscsc@bsnl.in, CIN- UI5411MP1974 SGC 001268

REVIVAL PLANS

Porsche Takes Aim at Ferrari with Luxury Supercar Concept

Bloomberg

Porsche AG unveiled a concept previewing a new supercar that will be positioned above the 911 in its lineup, part of the German automaker's bet that more expensive models can help revive its battered profit margins.

The low-slung Mission S, with a roof-mounted air intake and racing-inspired headlights, is the most concrete manifestation yet of chief executive officer Michael Leiters' planned turnaround for the storied marque. Porsche is developing it not as another limited-run hypercar, but as a sustained push into Ferrari NV territory.

The supercar's mid-engine platform will be flexible, able to accommodate gas-electric hybrid or pure internal-combustion powertrains, Leiters said in a Bloomberg TV interview. The exact engine configuration is "still a secret" but "it will be something which is very much in line with the DNA of Porsche."



Although he declined to specify a price point, Leiters said the vehicle will cost "much more" than a 911.

The Volkswagen AG unit is fighting to rebuild a business battered by collapsing sales in China, US trade tariffs and costly electrification missteps. Porsche is cutting jobs, paring back management ranks and trimming development spending as it shrinks for a tougher era, and plans to claw back profits by moving further upmarket.

The strategy brings Porsche closer to Ferrari's playbook of prioritising exclusivity and pricing power over sales volume. Leiters is betting that selling fewer cars at significantly higher average prices can restore the margins Porsche once enjoyed, with the Mission S spearheading the effort.

Porsche presented the new car on a pier in Queens, New York, where, in the early 1950s, it photographed the 550 Spyder — the small, lightweight racer driven by Hollywood actor James Dean that helped establish the brand in the US.

New Gold Refining Norms Could be a GIFT for Indian Exporters

Guidelines to help refiners seeking accreditation, transparency to benefit local consumers, too

Sutanuka Ghosal



Kolkata: India's 1,200-tonne gold refining industry can potentially unlock a major export opportunity through GIFT City, Gujarat, where the India International Bullion Exchange (IIBX) provides a platform for international bullion trading.

New guidelines issued by the International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA), the regulator for financial services in GIFT City's International Financial Services Centre, on October 15 set responsible sourcing and audit standards for refiners seeking Good Delivery accreditation.

With domestic gold consumption at 800-850 tonnes annually, the framework could help Indian refiners access global markets by enabling gold that meets the prescribed standards to be traded through GIFT City's bullion exchange.

Indian consumers could also benefit over time from greater transparency in gold sourcing, stronger quality assurance and potentially more competitive pricing as the market becomes more integrated with global bullion trade.

The IFSCA has issued the International Financial Services Centres Authority (Good Delivery) Guidelines, 2026, prescribing supply chain due diligence, independent audits and annual disclosures for refiners seeking accreditation to supply Good Delivery Gold to bullion exchanges in GIFT City.

The framework could help establish Indian-refined gold as a trusted product in global markets, but its success will depend on implementing accreditation norms, appointing approved auditors and putting in place trading systems for Good Delivery bars.

"These guidelines come at the right time," said Sabyasachi Ray, executive director at the Gem & Jewellery Export Promotion Council (GJEPC). "India recently earned an excellent rating in its peer review by the Financial Action Task Force (FATF), the global watchdog against money laundering and terror financing. The IFSCA India Good Delivery framework for gold builds on that credibility."

He said the prescribed standards are comparable to those followed at major gold trading centres such as London and New York.

The guidelines formalise rules for refiners to know their suppliers, verify beneficial ownership, flag and report suspicious deals and maintain records for eight years. They also require refiners to trace gold to its origin, assess risks associated with sourcing from conflict-affected and high-risk areas, and establish documented responsible-sourcing policies.

"What was required at the legal level, such as refiners knowing their suppliers, verifying who really owns them, flagging and reporting suspicious deals and keeping records for eight years is now encapsulated under these guidelines as a standard for accreditation," Ray said.

Indian stakeholders including GJEPC, with facilitation from the World Gold Council, have also recently created a self-regulatory system for gold modelled on the London Bullion Market Association (LBMA), he said.

"The next step will be to make the system work on the ground," said Ray. "We hope IFSCA and the India International Bullion Exchange (IIBX) will soon put in place the accreditation norms, the panel of approved auditors and the trading systems for Good Delivery bars."

Under the framework, refiners must undergo independent third-party audits and submit annual disclosures on compliance, including material changes and corrective actions. The requirements are intended to strengthen confidence in the provenance and integrity of gold traded through the IFSC bullion market.

Online Push, Strong Product Portfolio May Help Nestle India Sustain Growth

Brokerages retain positive views despite the stock taking hit due to co's comments on margin squeeze

Snehal Mergu



ET Intelligence Group: Nestle India's strong double-digit year-on-year revenue and profit growth in the September quarter has failed to enthuse investors as the company's commentary on input cost inflation and a sequential margin squeeze have weakened the market sentiment.

The stock has lost nearly 9% in two trading sessions after the firm declared its September quarter numbers. This has brought down its P/E at 59, below the five-year average multiple of 73. While long-term investors may look for a buying opportunity given the strong sales volume momentum and market penetration, short-term investors may have to look somewhere else for quick gains.

Although Nestle India posted a healthy 20.3% rise in revenue and a 35.9% jump in net profit, the company flagged continued inflation in key commodities, particularly cocoa. Coffee and wheat prices may remain range-bound, while sugar and edible oils have stabilised at elevated levels, and milk remains firm but may ease as supply improves.

Despite 46% rise in marketing spends, Ebitda margin expanded to 23.8% in September quarter from 22% a year ago. It, however, contracted by 40 basis points sequentially. Given rising advertising spend and commodity cost inflation, analysts expect limited room for further margin expansion year-on-year.

The volume-led growth story remains intact given broad-based demand across categories and supported by market-share gains, premiumisation and deeper distribution. The company continues to benefit from rapid expansion of quick-commerce and ecommerce channels.

JM Financial Institutional Securities believes Nestle India's strong performance over the past four to five quarters has been driven by GST rate rationalisation and company-led initiatives such as distribution expansion, premiumisation and innovation. While sales growth is expected to moderate in H2 of FY27 from elevated levels seen in first half, the brokerage believes this reflects a higher base rather than a deterioration in company's underlying fundamentals. It said Nestle's strong brand portfolio and pricing power equip it to navigate commodity-cost volatility and sustain healthy growth over medium term.

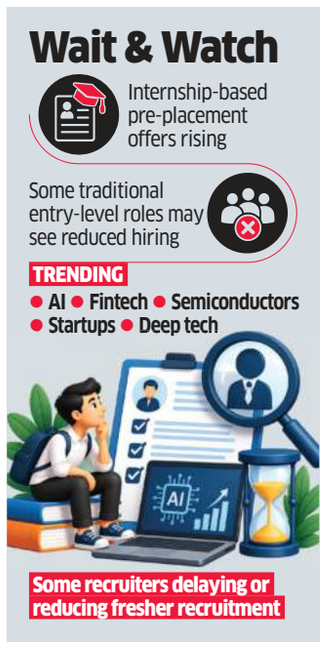
Analysts have largely retained 'buy' recommendations on stock despite trimming target prices by 7-17%. Even after cuts, revised targets imply a potential upside of 9-19% from Friday's closing price of ₹1,265, suggesting brokerages remain constructive on company's long-term growth prospects. Sustaining volume growth and festive-season demand may be key monitorables.

STARTUP PARTICIPATION MAY INCREASE

As Job Placements Near, India Inc Taps Old IITs for AI Roles

Cos are scaling back traditional fresher roles; new opportunities emerging in AI, data

Sreeradha Basu & Prachi Verma



Bengaluru | New Delhi: Old Indian Institutes of Technology are seeing more pre-placement offers and stronger demand for artificial intelligence (AI) and AI-adjacent roles, though some caution about fresher headcount ahead of their final placement season starting December 1.

Widespread AI adoption is reshaping entry-level hiring, according to campus officials and industry executives. While companies are scaling back traditional fresher roles, new opportunities are rapidly emerging in AI, data, analytics and tech-enabled functions.

"We have to live with AI, and maybe it will take one or two years for institutes to properly understand which new skills are required," a placement official at one of the old IITs said on condition of anonymity.

The seven old IITs are those established in Kharagpur, Bombay, Madras, Kanpur, Delhi, Guwahati, and Roorkee.

IIT Guwahati is seeing a rise in roles involving applied AI and AI-assisted technology, even as traditional software and services hiring declines, said John Jose, head of the institute's Centre for Career Development.

"New roles are coming that were not available last year," he said, adding that students with stronger AI skills could have an edge.

The shift is gradual rather than dramatic, but it is certainly visible as AI reshapes organisations, according to Manjesh K. Singh, chairperson of the students' placement committee at IIT Kanpur. "Companies are increasingly looking for graduates who can build, deploy and work alongside these technologies. So, beyond dedicated AI and machine learning roles, we're also seeing AI skills become part of role descriptions in software, analytics, finance and even core engineering," he said.

AI-focused companies, banking and financial services firms, and quantitative trading firms are expected to be among the prominent recruiters at IIT Kanpur.

Meanwhile, IIT Kharagpur expects hiring across technology and software, AI and data, finance, semiconductors, core engineering and other emerging technology areas.

The institute has strengthened its academic ecosystem in emerging areas, including the introduction of a four-year B Tech programme in AI, alongside programmes and micro-specialisations in areas such as AI and machine learning.

"The placement ecosystem reflects a combination of emerging AI/data-oriented opportunities and continued demand for strong fundamental areas of core engineering, quantitative, financial and managerial domains," said Sanjay Gupta, dean, career development centre, IIT Kharagpur.

Startup participation is also likely to increase. "We're seeing interest from young, fast-growing companies across technology, AI, fintech and deep-tech. Many of these are Indian startups, which we find especially encouraging," said IIT Kanpur's Singh.

Most institutes have also seen an uptick in internships, which are translating into more PPOs.

"Companies are increasingly using internships to assess students before extending PPOs, particularly in IT, data science and technology," said Jose.

SUBSTANDARD PRODUCTS WORTH ₹1.73 CR SEIZED

Maha FDA Suspends Licences of 25 Food Joints, Edible Oil & Spices Units

PTI

Mumbai: The Maharashtra Food and Drug Administration (FDA) has suspended the licences of 25 food establishments and four edible oil and spice manufacturing units as part of a statewide crackdown, officials said on Friday.

Six outlets of Domino' s Pizza were among the establishments whose licences were suspended in Pune division. The action also covered outlets in Jalna and Parbhani in Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar division, the FDA said. The FDA also seized approximately 81,330 kg of suspected substandard, adulterated or wrongly-labelled food products worth ₹1.73 crore from 37 establishments across six divisions.

In a press release, it said the seized stock included edible oil, chilli and turmeric powder, areca nut, dry fruits, sabudana, bhagar, rajgira, tea powder and sweets.

"Samples of the seized products have been sent for laboratory analysis. Further legal action will be taken under Food Safety and Standards Act after the reports are received," it added. The action against food establishments followed inspections that revealed violations of Schedule 4 of Food Safety and Standards (Licensing and Registration of Food Businesses) Regulations 2011, the FDA said.

Licences of seven establishments in Mumbai division and two in Konkan were suspended, while the figure was eight each for Pune and Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar divisions. The FDA said the action revealed several hygiene-related violations, including live cockroaches, fungal contamination, unclean utensils, improper storage and inadequate segregation of vegetarian and non-vegetarian food.

A closure notice was also issued to a sweet manufacturer in Mumbai after officials found violations relating to its manufacturing premises and hygiene.

TO IDENTIFY KEY CHALLENGES IN LOCAL MANUFACTURING

NITI Eyes Policy Support to Boost Medical, Dental Device Production

Teena Thacker



New Delhi: The NITI Aayog is exploring comprehensive policy interventions to boost domestic manufacturing of medical and dental devices in the country.

With a focus on addressing regulatory hurdles, infrastructure gaps and cost disadvantages faced by Indian manufacturers, the government's public policy think tank held a meeting on Wednesday with domestic devices and dental manufacturers, government officials from the departments of pharmaceuticals, health, science and technology, and the Indian Council of Medical Research, as well as experts from IIT Delhi and IIT Mumbai. E-commerce platforms involved in the trade of dental devices and the Association of Indian Medical Device Industry (AiMeD) also participated in the meeting.

Chaired by NITI Aayog vice chairman Ashok Lahiri, the meeting focused on identifying key challenges in domestic manufacturing and exploring regulatory, infrastructural and fiscal interventions needed to strengthen India's medical and dental device industry.

The consultation also aimed to identify opportunities for collaboration between the government and industry, and to formulate recommendations aligned with the country's healthcare priorities.

In a presentation submitted to the Aayog, the AiMeD called for a dedicated law for medical devices, simpler regulatory approvals and financial support to help domestic manufacturers compete with imported products.

The industry body said Indian manufacturers face a 10-15% cost disadvantage due to high capital and energy costs, logistics expenses, limited access to risk capital and inadequate testing and research infrastructure.

It also flagged the increasing regulatory burden, noting that setting up a manufacturing facility, which previously took about 18 months, can now take nearly four years because of multiple approvals, overlapping authorities and changing requirements.

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Japanese co, which has appointed Kazuki Sato as ED of Indian ops, sets sights on 'long-term' growth

Panasonic Reverses Stand on Indianising Top Deck, Offers Key Roles to Expats

Ratna Bhushan & Writankar Mukherjee



New Delhi | Kolkata: Panasonic has rejigged its top deck in India, appointing expats from its Japanese headquarters to key roles in a reversal of a strategy initiated five years ago to bring more operations under Indian leadership.

Kazuki Sato has been named executive director at flagship entity Panasonic Life Solutions India in the most recent leadership appointment. He will be based in Gurugram. Other recent appointments include Yoshiyuki Kato as managing director and chief executive officer, and Hirokazu Kamoda, who has been heading the AC division, as deputy managing director.

"Panasonic has been restructured as an expat-led organisation now, with the top deck being led primarily by executives from its headquarters," an executive close to the developments said.

A Panasonic Life Solutions India spokesperson, in an email response, said Sato will "focus on strengthening the company's support structure across India, laying the groundwork to enable future business expansion." The spokesperson confirmed that Kato is heading the India business and said Kamoda has been assigned additional responsibility of deputy managing director to deepen cross-functional synergy.

The Japanese appliances and consumer electronics maker's former India chairman Manish Sharma had stepped down last November after more than a decade-long stint.

Another company veteran, Sandeep Sehgal also quit as director and head of sales at Panasonic Life Solutions India. He has since joined rival Havells India as executive vice president (sales) for its Lloyd's business.

Panasonic's India unit exited the refrigerator and washing machine segments and cut headcount by over 10% to focus only on air-conditioners mid last year, citing a global restructuring aimed at exiting loss-making businesses worldwide. Both refrigerator and washing machine businesses in India failed to keep pace with aggressive competition from Indian and Korean rivals such as Voltas, Samsung and LG.

SHIFT IN FOCUS

Panasonic's India unit exited fridge & washing machine segments and cut headcount to focus only on ACs last year

"All operations have been downsized, and the company is undergoing natural attrition," the executive mentioned above said. "While there are no further layoffs right now, the staff strength has been reduced to about half."

The company spokesperson said the recent top-level appointments "reflect a deliberate strategy to combine strong business leadership with robust organisational support as the company pursues its long-term growth road map in the country."

It has also halved the size of its corporate headquarter in Gurugram in line with the reduction in headcount. Panasonic Life Solutions India in July this year said its residential air conditioner business grew 50% year-on-year in the summer. The company's FY25 sales stood at ₹11,500 crore, with a net profit of ₹1,100 crore.

Boston Consulting Group and the Confederation of Indian Industry estimated in a report last month that India's consumer durables market could touch sales of ₹3.25 lakh crore by year 2030, growing 8-10%, which it said was on the back of increased household incomes, easier financing, premiumisation and replacement demand. At the current pace of localisation, a large part of this projections could still be met through imports, the report said.

Reality Shows, Cricket Turn Advertisers' Safe Bets

Established non-fiction shows remain top draw amid ratings blackout with brands getting better deal from large networks

Javed Farooqui

Mumbai: With the ministry of information and broadcasting (MIB) barring the Broadcast Audience Research Council (BARC) from releasing TV ratings until it complies with the new guidelines, advertisers are gravitating towards established properties, with reality shows and cricket emerging as key beneficiaries, TV executives and marketers said.

Established non-fiction shows such as Bigg Boss and Kaun Banega Crorepati have continued to attract advertisers despite the blackout. Bigg Boss has roped in 95 sponsors across its language editions, while KBC has secured 25 sponsors.

At the time of the ratings blackout, some marketers had expected reality shows to be more affected. However, established non-fiction shows have continued to attract advertisers.

Cricket is also drawing advertiser interest, with India matches providing an opportunity to reach large audiences in a second half of the year largely devoid of marquee events such as the IPL or ICC tournaments. The India-West Indies series has drawn a strong response from brands, while the India-New Zealand series is also expected to see strong traction.

The MIB barred BARC from releasing viewership data from June after the ratings agency failed to comply with key provisions of the new TV Ratings Policy 2026. BARC has since increased the share of independent board members to 33% and expanded its viewership meter count to 77,596, against the stipulated target of 80,000. Cross-media measurement remains an outstanding requirement.

"During periods of uncertainty, such as a ratings blackout, brands have prioritised established properties with proven benchmarks to mitigate risk. High-impact properties such as non-fiction shows and cricket have historically commanded premium ad rates, and advertisers' reliance on these properties has increased further, particularly during the festive period," said a TV broadcasting executive.

The executive added that the absence of viewership data had complicated content planning, making it difficult for broadcasters to assess new shows' performance and demonstrate their potential to advertisers.

"In a market navigating measurement uncertainty, the long-standing equity of television channels and properties becomes an important source of confidence for advertisers," said Mahesh Shetty, head, entertainment sales, TV, JioStar.

Another executive said the blackout was disproportionately affecting smaller broadcasters, contributing to a decline in ad volumes. Larger networks, meanwhile, are offering advertisers additional inventory and other benefits to help justify their spends.

The growing integration of television and digital is also helping brands assess content performance, said a marketer. Even when BARC ratings were available, advertisers relied on multiple metrics to allocate budgets and measure returns, the marketer added. These included the brand profile of the channel and the quality of content.

However, the pressure on television advertising predates the ratings blackout. A shift in audience attention and ad spends towards digital, alongside lower FMCG advertising expenditure on television, had already weighed on the medium. TV ad volumes fell 7% in January-July 2026, according to TAM.

